

The Gospel of the Kingdom

By Jason Hayward

“And when he was demanded of the Pharisees, when the kingdom of God should come, he answered them and said, The kingdom of God cometh not with observation: neither shall they say, Lo here! or, lo there! for, behold, the kingdom of God is within you.”

Luke 17:20-21 KJV

Table of Contents

[Introduction](#)

[Kingdom in the New Testament](#)

[Matthew](#)

[Mark](#)

[Luke](#)

[John](#)

[Acts](#)

[Epistles](#)

[Kingdom in the Old Testament](#)

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Introduction

So many of us know the gospel message. God made a way through His Son Jesus Christ to save us from our sin so that we could have everlasting life as the children of God. So many of us know the messages Jesus taught regarding the kingdom of God, which functions very differently than the world we live in. His teaching on the kingdom includes the parable of the sower and the parable of the talents.

Yet, I would contend that many of us have missed the *gospel of the kingdom*. Or we haven't understood a lot of it. And this is *reality*. It's what's eternal, and it's here – the spiritual world is intertwined with the physical world we live in.

Further, Jesus said the gospel of the kingdom shall be preached in all the world as a witness to the nations, then shall the end come (Matthew 24:14).

We need to know what it is, and it should affect our daily thoughts and living.

As such, this Bible study examines the gospel of the kingdom by way of examining the scriptures that mention the kingdom. In the New Testament, the word for kingdom is *basileia* (G932). It is used 162 times in the New Testament, and we will look at most of the passages that use this word. There are two words that refer to the kingdom in the Old Testament. *Mamlakah* (H4467) is used 117 times, while *malku* (H4437) is used 57 times. We will look at some of these references. If you'd like to dig into word meanings for understanding and meditation, you should use a version of the Bible that allows for easy lookup like Kairos' Holy Bible app. The Blue Letter Bible is another good reference but the lookup isn't as fast. In this book, I include all scriptures from both of the ESV and KJV bibles, two very accurate versions that were made ~400 years apart from each other.

May our understanding of the reality of the gospel of the kingdom transform the way that we live and function as kingdom citizens, the church in the world, Christ's own body. Until we put His word into practice as disciples, we will not be transformed by it. Let's do it together!

Kingdom in the New Testament

Kingdom

G932

Transliteration: basileia

Pronunciation: bas-il-i'-ah

Thayer Lexicon:

1. Royal power, kingship, dominion, rule
 - a. Not to be confused with an actual kingdom but rather the right or authority to rule over a kingdom
 - b. Of the royal power of Jesus as the triumphant Messiah
 - c. Of the royal power and dignity conferred on Christians in the Messiah's kingdom
 2. A kingdom, the territory subject to the rule of a king
 3. Used in the New Testament to refer to the reign of the Messiah
- Also translated: kingdom of God, kingdom of heaven, Thy/thine kingdom, His kingdom

Matthew

1. John the Baptist preaching consisted of two main parts: repent, and the kingdom of heaven is at hand.
2. The devil had authority to give Jesus the kingdoms of the world when he tempted Jesus in the desert.
3. The main message Jesus preached was of two parts: repent, and the kingdom of heaven is at hand.
4. The gospel of the kingdom Jesus preached was associated with the healing of all sickness, disease, pain and oppression.
5. Kingdom living leads one down a path of righteousness like that of Jesus Christ.
6. Regular prayer is to be used to align ourselves with the nature and will of God so we can do His will. Since God's kingdom comes forth where His will is done, we cause His kingdom of heaven to come to earth when we do His will. While God's will is done in heaven, it is often not done on earth.
7. In our lives, we are to seek first the kingdom of God and His righteousness. This is to seek and to establish the government and rule of God in our lives in the world. It is also to intensely desire the fulfillment of spiritual results. We are to bring about the accomplishment of His will insofar as it depends on us. This should be the focus of our lives.
8. Those under the Lordship of Christ will be transformed in character and nature to stop sinning and do good, thereby accomplishing God's will on earth. It will be evident that their lives are under God's government and rule; this is to be in God's kingdom.
9. Faith in Jesus Christ as God's Son is required for those who are saved under God's kingdom.
10. Jesus went about teaching, preaching, and doing good, healing every sickness and disease. The gospel of the kingdom includes both open proclamation of the good news

in Christ and demonstration of the rule of God over every disease and affliction. Jesus Christ's demonstration of the kingdom follows from God's compassion.

11. Starting with Israel, Jesus included His disciples in His mission to proclaim the gospel of the kingdom and to demonstrate that the kingdom of God is at hand. The demonstration of the rule of God included signs of healing the sick, casting out devils, and raising the dead.
12. While John the Baptist was the greatest prophet until the time of Jesus, Jesus brought the kingdom of heaven near, ultimately giving the Spirit of God to live inside those who committed to God's rule in their lives. This makes them greater than John the Baptist.
13. John the Baptist began to proclaim that the rule of God was at hand, coming to the world through the ministry of Jesus Christ. There is a war between the kingdom of God and the realm of darkness. Territory is taken by force. Satan steals, kills and destroys, yet without authority as a thief. (He was allowed to kill both John and Jesus.) Christ (and Christ in you) now has the authority to forcibly expel devils and sickness, destroying the works of the devil and putting Satan under His feet, yet this authority must be enforced. The gospel must also be preached so that many will turn from darkness to light. In so doing, God's government comes into the world.
14. Casting out devils and healing are signs that demonstrate God's kingdom rule. They are accomplished by the Spirit of God, who is able to bind Satan's influence within one held captive and set them free. It is unforgivable to call the work of the Holy Spirit of God the work of Satan, or to identify Jesus Christ with Satan. Further, a kingdom divided against itself cannot stand, so Satan will not cast out devils or destroy his own work of sickness.
15. Only some are given to know the mysteries of the kingdom, or of God's government, rule, and ways.
16. The word of God is of the kingdom. It's the perfect blueprint of what the rule of God does in a life. When it grows to maturity, it yields life, rightness, and the divine nature attributes of God, as shown in the life of Jesus Christ, the word made flesh. One must think on, understand, believe, and do the word of God in order to keep it (or to make it part of their renewed mind), allowing the word of God to do what it is designed to do. The realm of darkness works actively to take away the word of God that is sown by whatever means possible in order to stop this blueprint of God's kingdom from unfolding in people (to mature them in Christ) and in the world. We are able to sow God's word by speaking it to others and by making disciples. His word in our mouth produces life.
17. The kingdom of heaven is life giving as unto a tiny mustard seed that grows up to become an enormous mustard tree.
18. The kingdom of heaven is like leaven, bringing growth, maturity, fullness and rightness to those who are joined to it. As the kingdom comes into the world, evil is also put under Christ's feet.
19. Those who become sons (heirs) of the kingdom by grace stop sinning and live righteously instead, bearing good fruit. (Fruit relates to both character and action.) This is how they may be identified both now and later at the harvest of the kingdom. Those who do unrighteousness will go to hell. The righteous shine forth as the sun, or the glory of God, in the kingdom; they are glorious, reflecting God's glory.

20. The kingdom of heaven is the greatest treasure; it cannot be received by one that already has treasure within one's old life in the world. The understanding of this treasure will bring joy. (The treasure is Christ in you. It's God's government and rule. It's where His will is done.) The cost to receive the kingdom of heaven is to completely abandon one's old life and treasure. We are only to hold fast to our righteous God and His kingdom.
21. There is a mix of the new creation and the old in those being disciplined. The old must be driven out to be replaced by the new nature that is of Christ.
22. To those having faith in Him, Jesus gave the keys of the kingdom of heaven: binding and loosing between earth and heaven. That which is evil can be told it has no legal right and be commanded to depart. Insisting on this authority, evil cannot prevail. This practice enforces Christ's victory over evil, bringing God's government and rule to earth. It causes God's will to be done on earth as it is in heaven.
23. The transfiguration was a view into the kingdom seen by Jesus' three closest disciples.
24. The greatest in the kingdom are the repentant, who become of childlike faith and humbled condition. The most important aspect of childlike faith is to favorably receive the kingdom of God's government, rule, and ways.
25. In the kingdom of heaven, all are expected to loose and forgive others repeatedly out of mercy and compassion, just as has been done by God for them.
26. The people of the kingdom are to obey God's rules for marriage or remain unmarried.
27. The kingdom of heaven is the greatest treasure; it cannot be received by one that already has treasure within one's old life in the world. As such, it is difficult for the rich to allow for God's government and rule in their life, giving themselves over to do God's will.
28. God is generous to offer to bring people into His kingdom to do His work on His terms. Our rules of fairness don't apply. God is good and will do what is right. His kingdom goes contrary to our expectations based on what we have seen in life.
29. God has structured the government in His kingdom very differently than the ways of the world. When you have the opportunity to do so, don't lord it over or exercise authority over others as is commonly done in the world. Instead, minister to and serve others as Christ Jesus showed by example, giving over your interests and will and even your life for their good. You are to be a minister and to give. Further, to take part in God's kingdom is to have both privilege and responsibility, both now and in the life to come. In God's kingdom, Jesus' first apostles will have the responsibility to sit on thrones governing the twelve tribes of Israel. The main privilege that we as sons (and daughters, really heirs) have in the kingdom is a close relationship with God; we are even now directly connected to Him. The full privileges of sonship (as co-heirs with Christ) and the responsibility we will have in His kingdom are our reward for our faithfulness to God here.
30. In the kingdom, there is belief in God and His word, repentance, and obedience to God's will. He wills that we occupy ourselves in such a way as to bear fruit that pleases Him. All are welcomed into repentance, or a change of mind and purpose to conform with that of God.

31. The kingdom of God stays only with those producing its fruits. Change in nature and character, and good works reflecting this glorious character, should follow repentance. Those who reject Christ will be destroyed.
32. In the kingdom of God, we are sent out to invite many to come in. But only those with wedding garments (those who follow Christ and produce the fruit of the Spirit, including holy living) may stay. They comprise the cherished bride of Christ. Most invited do not will to follow after Christ though, so they will not enjoy what follows only from relationship with Him.
33. The Pharisees shut the kingdom of heaven against men by not doing God's word, by their means of discipling people in the false teachings of traditions of men, and by opposing those following Christ. To enter into His kingdom, we must be careful to put God's word into practice, as spoken by Jesus, and we are to make it our focus to please God.
34. The gospel of the kingdom shall be preached in all the world as a witness to the nations, then shall the end come. This is the gospel that Jesus preached, taught and demonstrated with signs. He then gave this responsibility to all disciples.
35. The kingdom includes those who remain faithful to God and His word. Out of those intending to enter, only some choose to be connected in Christ to God's Holy Spirit and the brilliant life that follows from this connection, thereby staying ready to marry the bridegroom when He comes. Only some choose to fan into flame the gift that is within them by doing the things God loves, while others allow it to be extinguished. Only some are faithful stewards of the gift (of the Spirit) and the responsibilities (like family, finances, occupation, and ability) that God gave them. God expects us to get up, go out into the world around us, and use what He has given us, occupying ourselves by doing kingdom work. God will not allow the disconnected, irresponsible, and unfaithful to enter into life in the kingdom with Him. On the other hand, the faithful will be rewarded with more responsibility and with abundance in God's kingdom.
36. The good fruit expected from the good trees (a biblical analogy of Jesus for people, Luke 6:43) that inherit God's kingdom includes active ministry to the least of these. Their Christlike character, especially their nature of love and mercy, naturally leads to such action. They are doers of God's word, the ones to make His will happen on earth. Christ in them, they are the word of God made flesh, so to speak. Meanwhile, the bad trees excluded from God's kingdom lack this good fruit – the nature and character, and the action that naturally follows. When we do good to people, we do it to God Himself, for they are His image bearers; putting love in action to others is love for God.
37. Jesus blessed the bread representing His body that was about to be broken for their healing and gave it to the disciples to eat. It is the bread of God's children (Exodus 23:25). He gave thanks for the cup representing His blood shed for their forgiveness of sin and gave it to the disciples to drink. Communion represents what God generously gave us in through the suffering and death of His Son Jesus Christ, the Lamb of God, that unites us and gives us life and freedom from the law of sin and death. What God has joined together (by means of His own suffering and death), precious to Him, we are not to separate. Jesus won't eat the Passover meal (take communion) again until He

does it with His disciples when they are new and all (that His suffering and death was meant to do for us) has been fulfilled in our Father's kingdom.

1. John the Baptist preaching consisted of two main parts: repent, and the kingdom of heaven is at hand.

"In those days John the Baptist came preaching in the wilderness of Judea, "Repent, for the kingdom of heaven is at hand.""

Matthew 3:1-2 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.3.1-2.ESV>

"In those days came John the Baptist, preaching (kēlussō, G2784) in the wilderness of Judæa, and saying (legō, G3004), Repent ye (metanoeō, G3340): for the kingdom (basileia, G932) of heaven is at hand (eggizō, G1448)."

Matthew 3:1-2 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.3.1-2.KJV>

"Now after John was arrested, Jesus came into Galilee, proclaiming the gospel of God, and saying, "The time is fulfilled, and the kingdom of God is at hand;repent and believe in the gospel.""

Mark 1:14-15 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mrk.1.14-15.ESV>

"Now after that John was put in prison, Jesus (Iēsous, G2424) came into Galilee, preaching (kēlussō, G2784) the gospel (euaggelion, G2098) of the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God, and saying (legō, G3004), The time (kairos, G2540) is fulfilled (plēroō, G4137), and the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God is at hand (eggizō, G1448): repent ye (metanoeō, G3340), and believe (pisteuō, G4100) the gospel (euaggelion, G2098)."

Mark 1:14-15 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mrk.1.14-15.KJV>

2. The devil had authority to give Jesus the kingdoms of the world when he tempted Jesus in the desert.

"Again, the devil took him to a very high mountain and showed him all the kingdoms of the world and their glory. And he said to him, "All these I will give you, if you will fall down and worship me." Then Jesus said to him, "Be gone, Satan! For it is written, "You shall worship the Lord your God and him only shall you serve." Then the devil left him, and behold, angels came and were ministering to him."

Matthew 4:8-11 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.4.8-11.ESV>

"Again, the devil taketh him up into an exceeding high mountain, and sheweth him all the kingdoms (basileia, G932) of the world, and the glory (doxa, G1391) of them; and saith unto

him, All these things will I give thee, if thou wilt fall down and worship me. Then saith Jesus unto him, Get thee hence (hupagō, G5217), Satan: for it is written, Thou shalt worship the Lord thy God, and him only shalt thou serve. Then the devil leaveth him, and, behold, angels came and ministered unto him.”

Matthew 4:8-11 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.4.8-11.KJV>

“And the devil took him up and showed him all the kingdoms of the world in a moment of time, and said to him, “To you I will give all this authority and their glory, for it has been delivered to me, and I give it to whom I will. If you, then, will worship me, it will all be yours.” And Jesus answered him, “It is written, “You shall worship the Lord your God, and him only shall you serve.””

Luke 4:5-8 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.4.5-8.ESV>

“And the devil, taking him up into an high mountain, shewed unto him all the kingdoms of the world in a moment of time. And the devil said unto him, All this power (exousia, G1849) will I give thee, and the glory (doxa, G1391) of them: for that is delivered (paradidōmi, G3860) unto me; and to whomsoever I will (thelō, G2309) I give it. If thou therefore wilt worship me, all shall be thine. And Jesus answered and said unto him, Get thee (hupagō, G5217) behind (opisō, G3694) me, Satan: for it is written, Thou shalt worship the Lord thy God, and him only shalt thou serve.”

Luke 4:5-8 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/luk.4.5-8.KJV>

3. The main message Jesus preached was of two parts: repent, and the kingdom of heaven is at hand.

“From that time Jesus began to preach, saying, “Repent, for the kingdom of heaven is at hand.””

Matthew 4:17 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.4.17.ESV>

“From that time Jesus began to preach (kērussō, G2784), and to say (legō, G3004), Repent (metanoeō, G3340): for the kingdom (basileia, G932) of heaven is at hand (eggizō, G1448).”

Matthew 4:17 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.4.17.KJV>

4. The gospel of the kingdom Jesus preached was associated with the healing of all sickness, disease, pain and oppression.

“And he went throughout all Galilee, teaching in their synagogues and proclaiming the gospel of the kingdom and healing every disease and every affliction among the people. So his fame spread throughout all Syria, and they brought him all the sick, those afflicted with various diseases and pains, those oppressed by demons, those having seizures, and paralytics, and he

healed them. And great crowds followed him from Galilee and the Decapolis, and from Jerusalem and Judea, and from beyond the Jordan.”

Matthew 4:23-25 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.4.23-25.ESV>

“And Jesus (lēsous, G2424) went about (periagō, G4013) all Galilee, teaching (didaskō, G1321) in their synagogues, and preaching (kērussō, G2784) the gospel (euggelion, G2098) of the kingdom (basileia, G932), and healing (therapeuō, G2323) all manner of sickness (nosos, G3554) and all manner of disease (malakia, G3119) among the people. And his fame went throughout all Syria: and they brought unto him all sick (kakōs, G2560) people that were taken with divers diseases (nosos, G3554) and torments (basanos, G931), and those which were possessed with devils (daimonizomai, G1139), and those which were lunatick (selēniazomai, G4583), and those that had the palsy (paralutikos, G3885); and he healed (therapeuō, G2323) them. And there followed him great multitudes of people from Galilee, and from Decapolis, and from Jerusalem, and from Judæa, and from beyond Jordan.”

Matthew 4:23-25 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.4.23-25.KJV>

“And he came down with them and stood on a level place, with a great crowd of his disciples and a great multitude of people from all Judea and Jerusalem and the seacoast of Tyre and Sidon, who came to hear him and to be healed of their diseases. And those who were troubled with unclean spirits were cured. And all the crowd sought to touch him, for power came out from him and healed them all.”

Luke 6:17-19 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.6.17-19.ESV>

“And he came down with them, and stood in the plain, and the company of his disciples, and a great multitude of people out of all Judæa and Jerusalem, and from the sea coast of Tyre and Sidon, which came to hear him, and to be healed (iaomai, G2390) of their diseases (nosos, G3554); and they that were vexed (ochleō, G3791) with unclean (akathartos, G169) spirits: and they were healed (therapeuō, G2323). And the whole multitude sought to touch (haptomai, G680) him: for there went virtue (dunamis, G1411) out of him, and healed (iaomai, G2390) them all.”

Luke 6:17-19 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/luk.6.17-19.KJV>

5. Kingdom living leads one down a path of righteousness like that of Jesus Christ.

“Seeing the crowds, he went up on the mountain, and when he sat down, his disciples came to him. And he opened his mouth and taught them, saying: “Blessed are the poor in spirit, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven. “Blessed are those who mourn, for they shall be comforted. “Blessed are the meek, for they shall inherit the earth. “Blessed are those who hunger and thirst for righteousness, for they shall be satisfied. “Blessed are the merciful, for they shall receive mercy. “Blessed are the pure in heart, for they shall see God. “Blessed are the peacemakers, for they

shall be called sons of God. "Blessed are those who are persecuted for righteousness' sake, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven. "Blessed are you when others revile you and persecute you and utter all kinds of evil against you falsely on my account. Rejoice and be glad, for your reward is great in heaven, for so they persecuted the prophets who were before you. "You are the salt of the earth, but if salt has lost its taste, how shall its saltiness be restored? It is no longer good for anything except to be thrown out and trampled under people's feet. "You are the light of the world. A city set on a hill cannot be hidden. Nor do people light a lamp and put it under a basket, but on a stand, and it gives light to all in the house. In the same way, let your light shine before others, so that they may see your good works and give glory to your Father who is in heaven. "Do not think that I have come to abolish the Law or the Prophets; I have not come to abolish them but to fulfill them. For truly, I say to you, until heaven and earth pass away, not an iota, not a dot, will pass from the Law until all is accomplished. Therefore whoever relaxes one of the least of these commandments and teaches others to do the same will be called least in the kingdom of heaven, but whoever does them and teaches them will be called great in the kingdom of heaven. For I tell you, unless your righteousness exceeds that of the scribes and Pharisees, you will never enter the kingdom of heaven."

Matthew 5:1-20 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.5.1-20.ESV>

"And seeing the multitudes, he went up into a mountain: and when he was set, his disciples came unto him: and he opened his mouth, and taught them, saying, Blessed are the poor in spirit: for their's is the kingdom (basileia, G932) of heaven. Blessed are they that mourn: for they shall be comforted (parakaleō, G3870). Blessed are the meek: for they shall inherit the earth. Blessed are they which do hunger and thirst after righteousness (dikaiosunē, G1343): for they shall be filled. Blessed are the merciful: for they shall obtain mercy. Blessed are the pure (katharos, G2513) in heart (kardia, G2588): for they shall see God. Blessed are the peacemakers: for they shall be called the children of God. Blessed are they which are persecuted for righteousness' (dikaiosunē, G1343) sake: for their's is the kingdom (basileia, G932) of heaven. Blessed are ye, when men shall revile you, and persecute you, and shall say all manner of evil against you falsely, for my sake. Rejoice, and be exceeding glad: for great is your reward in heaven: for so persecuted they the prophets which were before you. Ye are the salt (halas, G217) of the earth: but if the salt have lost his savour, wherewith shall it be salted? it is thenceforth good (ischuō, G2480) for nothing, but to be cast out, and to be trodden under foot of men. Ye are the light (phōs, G5457) of the world. A city that is set on an hill cannot be hid. Neither do men light a candle, and put it under a bushel, but on a candlestick; and it giveth light unto all that are in the house. Let your light (phōs, G5457) so shine before men, that they may see your good (kalos, G2570) works (ergon, G2041), and glorify (doxazō, G1392) your Father which is in heaven. Think not that I am come to destroy the law, or the prophets: I am not come to destroy, but to fulfil (plēroō, G4137). For verily I say unto you, Till heaven and earth pass, one jot or one tittle shall in no wise pass from the law, till all be fulfilled. Whosoever therefore shall break one of these least commandments, and shall teach men so, he shall be called the least in the kingdom (basileia, G932) of heaven: but whosoever shall do and teach them, the same shall be called great in the kingdom (basileia, G932) of heaven. For I say unto you, That except your

righteousness shall exceed the righteousness (dikaiosunē, G1343) of the scribes and Pharisees, ye shall in no case enter into the kingdom (dikaiosunē, G1343) of heaven.”

Matthew 5:1-20 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.5.1-20.KJV>

“And he lifted up his eyes on his disciples, and said: “Blessed are you who are poor, for yours is the kingdom of God. “Blessed are you who are hungry now, for you shall be satisfied. “Blessed are you who weep now, for you shall laugh. “Blessed are you when people hate you and when they exclude you and revile you and spurn your name as evil, on account of the Son of Man! Rejoice in that day, and leap for joy, for behold, your reward is great in heaven; for so their fathers did to the prophets. “But woe to you who are rich, for you have received your consolation. “Woe to you who are full now, for you shall be hungry. “Woe to you who laugh now, for you shall mourn and weep. “Woe to you, when all people speak well of you, for so their fathers did to the false prophets. “But I say to you who hear, Love your enemies, do good to those who hate you, bless those who curse you, pray for those who abuse you. To one who strikes you on the cheek, offer the other also, and from one who takes away your cloak do not withhold your tunic either. Give to everyone who begs from you, and from one who takes away your goods do not demand them back. And as you wish that others would do to you, do so to them. “If you love those who love you, what benefit is that to you? For even sinners love those who love them. And if you do good to those who do good to you, what benefit is that to you? For even sinners do the same. And if you lend to those from whom you expect to receive, what credit is that to you? Even sinners lend to sinners, to get back the same amount. But love your enemies, and do good, and lend, expecting nothing in return, and your reward will be great, and you will be sons of the Most High, for he is kind to the ungrateful and the evil. Be merciful, even as your Father is merciful. “Judge not, and you will not be judged; condemn not, and you will not be condemned; forgive, and you will be forgiven; give, and it will be given to you. Good measure, pressed down, shaken together, running over, will be put into your lap. For with the measure you use it will be measured back to you.””

Luke 6:20-38 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.6.20-38.ESV>

“And he lifted up his eyes on his disciples, and said, Blessed be ye poor: for your's is the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God. Blessed are ye that hunger now: for ye shall be filled. Blessed are ye that weep now: for ye shall laugh. Blessed are ye, when men shall hate you, and when they shall separate you from their company, and shall reproach you, and cast out your name as evil, for the Son of man's sake. Rejoice ye in that day, and leap for joy: for, behold, your reward is great in heaven: for in the like manner did their fathers unto the prophets. But woe unto you that are rich! for ye have received your consolation. Woe unto you that are full! for ye shall hunger. Woe unto you that laugh now! for ye shall mourn and weep. Woe unto you, when all men shall speak well of you! for so did their fathers to the false prophets. But I say unto you which hear, Love (agapaō, G25) your enemies, do good (kalōs, G2573) to them which hate you, bless (eulogeō, G2127) them that curse you, and pray for them which despitefully use you. And unto him that smiteth thee on the one cheek offer also the other; and him that taketh away thy cloke forbid not to take thy coat also. Give to every man that asketh (aiteō, G154) of thee; and

of him that taketh away thy goods ask them not again. And as ye would (thelō, G2309) that men should do to you, do (poieō, G4160) ye also to them likewise. For if ye love (agapaō, G25) them which love (agapaō, G25) you, what thank (charis, G5485) have ye? for sinners also love those that love them. And if ye do good to them which do good to you, what thank (charis, G5485) have ye? for sinners also do even the same. And if ye lend to them of whom ye hope to receive, what thank (charis, G5485) have ye? for sinners also lend to sinners, to receive as much again. But love (agapaō, G25) ye your enemies, and do good (agathopoieō, G15), and lend, hoping for nothing again; and your reward shall be great, and ye shall be the children of the Highest: for he is kind (chrēstos, G5543) unto the unthankful (acharistos, G884) and to the evil (ponēros, G4190). Be ye therefore merciful, as your Father also is merciful. Judge not, and ye shall not be judged: condemn not, and ye shall not be condemned: forgive (apoluō, G630), and ye shall be forgiven (apoluō, G630): give, and it shall be given unto you; good measure, pressed down, and shaken together, and running over, shall men give into your bosom. For with the same measure that ye mete withal it shall be measured to you again.”

Luke 6:20-38 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/luk.6.20-38.KJV>

6. Regular prayer is to be used to align ourselves with the nature and will of God so we can do His will. Since God’s kingdom comes forth where His will is done, we cause His kingdom of heaven to come to earth when we do His will. While God’s will is done in heaven, it is often not done on earth. (For more on this, see [Directly Connected to the Spirit, Mind and Body of Christ.](#))

“Pray then like this: “Our Father in heaven, hallowed be your name. Your kingdom come, your will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we also have forgiven our debtors. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil.”

Matthew 6:9-13 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.6.9-13.ESV>

“After this manner therefore pray ye: Our Father which art in heaven, Hallowed be (hagiazō, G37) thy name (onoma, G3686). Thy kingdom (basileia, G932) come (erchomai, G2064). Thy will (thelēma, G2307) be done (ginomai, G1096) in earth, as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver (rhuomai, G4506) us from evil: For thine is the kingdom (basileia, G932), and the power (dunamis, G1411), and the glory (doxa, G1391), for ever. Amen.”

Matthew 6:9-13 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.6.9-13.KJV>

“And he said to them, “When you pray, say: “Father, hallowed be your name. Your kingdom come.”

Luke 11:2 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.11.2.ESV>

“And he said unto them, When ye pray, say (legō, G3004), Our Father which art in heaven, Hallowed be (hagiazō, G37) thy name (hagiazō, G37). Thy kingdom (basileia, G932) come (erchomai, G2064). Thy will (thelēma, G2307) be done (ginomai, G1096), as in heaven, so in earth.”

Luke 11:2 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/luk.11.2.KJV>

7. In our lives, we are to seek first the kingdom of God and His righteousness. This is to seek and to establish the government and rule of God in our lives in the world. It is also to intensely desire the fulfillment of spiritual results. We are to bring about the accomplishment of His will insofar as it depends on us. This should be the focus of our lives.

“But seek first the kingdom of God and his righteousness, and all these things will be added to you.”

Matthew 6:33 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.6.33.ESV>

“But seek (zēteō, G2212) ye first the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God, and his righteousness (dikaiosunē, G1343); and all these things shall be added unto you.”

Matthew 6:33 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.6.33.KJV>

“Instead, seek his kingdom, and these things will be added to you. “Fear not, little flock, for it is your Father’s good pleasure to give you the kingdom. Sell your possessions, and give to the needy. Provide yourselves with moneybags that do not grow old, with a treasure in the heavens that does not fail, where no thief approaches and no moth destroys. For where your treasure is, there will your heart be also.”

Luke 12:31-34 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.12.31-34.ESV>

“But rather seek ye (zēteō, G2212) the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God; and all these things shall be added unto you. Fear not, little flock; for it is your Father's good pleasure (eudokeō, G2106) to give (didōmi, G1325) you the kingdom (basileia, G932). Sell that ye have, and give alms (eleēmosunē, G1654); provide yourselves bags which wax not old, a treasure (thēsauros, G2344) in the heavens that faileth not, where no thief approacheth, neither moth corrupteth. For where your treasure (thēsauros, G2344) is, there will your heart (kardia, G2588) be also.”

Luke 12:31-34 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/luk.12.31-34.KJV>

8. Those under the Lordship of Christ will be transformed in character and nature to stop sinning and do good, thereby accomplishing God’s will on earth. It will be evident that their lives are under God’s government and rule; this is to be in God’s kingdom.

“So, every healthy tree bears good fruit, but the diseased tree bears bad fruit. A healthy tree cannot bear bad fruit, nor can a diseased tree bear good fruit. Every tree that does not bear good fruit is cut down and thrown into the fire. Thus you will recognize them by their fruits. “Not everyone who says to me, ‘Lord, Lord,’ will enter the kingdom of heaven, but the one who does the will of my Father who is in heaven. On that day many will say to me, ‘Lord, Lord, did we not prophesy in your name, and cast out demons in your name, and do many mighty works in your name?’ And then will I declare to them, ‘I never knew you; depart from me, you workers of lawlessness.’”

Matthew 7:17-23 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.7.17-23.ESV>

“Even so every good (agathos, G18) tree bringeth forth (poieō, G4160) good (agathos, G18) fruit (karpos, G2590); but a corrupt (saprois, G4550) tree bringeth forth (poieō, G4160) evil (ponēros, G4190) fruit. A good tree cannot bring forth (poieō, G4160) evil fruit, neither can a corrupt tree bring forth (poieō, G4160) good (kalos, G2570) fruit. Every tree that bringeth not forth (poieō, G4160) good (kalos, G2570) fruit is hewn down, and cast into the fire. Wherefore by their fruits (karpos, G2590) ye shall know them. Not every one that saith unto me, Lord (kurios, G2962), Lord, shall enter (eiserchomai, G1525) into the kingdom (basileia, G932) of heaven; but he that doeth (poieō, G4160) the will (thelēma, G2307) of my Father which is in heaven. Many will say to me in that day, Lord (kurios, G2962), Lord, have we not prophesied in thy name (onoma, G3686)? and in thy name (onoma, G3686) have cast out devils? and in thy name (onoma, G3686) done (poieō, G4160) many wonderful works (dunamis, G1411)? And then will I profess (homologeō, G3670) unto them, I never knew you: depart from me, ye that work (ergazomai, G2038) iniquity.”

Matthew 7:17-23 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.7.17-23.KJV>

9. Faith in Jesus Christ as God’s Son is required for those who are saved under God’s kingdom.

“When Jesus heard this, he marveled and said to those who followed him, “Truly, I tell you, with no one in Israel have I found such faith. I tell you, many will come from east and west and recline at table with Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob in the kingdom of heaven, while the sons of the kingdom will be thrown into the outer darkness. In that place there will be weeping and gnashing of teeth.””

Matthew 8:10-12 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.8.10-12.ESV>

“When Jesus heard it, he marvelled, and said to them that followed, Verily I say unto you, I have not found so great faith, no, not in Israel. And I say unto you, That many shall come from the east and west, and shall sit down with Abraham, and Isaac, and Jacob, in the kingdom (basileia, G932) of heaven. But the children of the kingdom (basileia, G932) shall be cast out into outer darkness: there shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth.”

Matthew 8:10-12 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.8.10-12.KJV>

10. Jesus went about teaching, preaching, and doing good, healing every sickness and disease. The gospel of the kingdom includes both open proclamation of the good news in Christ and demonstration of the rule of God over every disease and affliction. Jesus Christ's demonstration of the kingdom follows from God's compassion.

“And Jesus went throughout all the cities and villages, teaching in their synagogues and proclaiming the gospel of the kingdom and healing every disease and every affliction. When he saw the crowds, he had compassion for them, because they were harassed and helpless, like sheep without a shepherd.”

Matthew 9:35-36 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.9.35-36.ESV>

“And Jesus went about (periagō, G4013) all the cities and villages, teaching (didaskō, G1321) in their synagogues, and preaching (kērussō, G2784) the gospel (euaggelion, G2098) of the kingdom (basileia, G932), and healing (therapeuō, G2323) every sickness (nosos, G3554) and every disease (malakia, G3119) among the people. But when he saw the multitudes, he was moved with compassion (splagchnizomai, G4697) on them, because they fainted (ekluō, G1590), and were scattered abroad (rhiptō, G4496), as sheep having no shepherd.”

Matthew 9:35-36 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.9.35-36.KJV>

“Soon afterward he went on through cities and villages, proclaiming and bringing the good news of the kingdom of God. And the twelve were with him,”

Luke 8:1 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.8.1.ESV>

“And it came to pass afterward, that he went throughout every city and village, preaching (kērussō, G2784) and shewing the glad tidings (euaggelizō, G2097) of the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God: and the twelve were with him,”

Luke 8:1 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/luk.8.1.KJV>

11. Starting with Israel, Jesus included His disciples in His mission to proclaim the gospel of the kingdom and to demonstrate that the kingdom of God is at hand. The demonstration of the rule of God included signs of healing the sick, casting out devils, and raising the dead.

“These twelve Jesus sent out, instructing them, “Go nowhere among the Gentiles and enter no town of the Samaritans, but go rather to the lost sheep of the house of Israel. And proclaim as you go, saying, ‘The kingdom of heaven is at hand.’ Heal the sick, raise the dead, cleanse lepers, cast out demons. You received without paying; give without pay.”

Matthew 10:5-8 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.10.5-8.ESV>

“These twelve Jesus sent forth (apostellō, G649), and commanded (paraggellō, G3853) them, saying, Go not into the way of the Gentiles, and into any city of the Samaritans enter ye not: but go rather to the lost sheep of the house of Israel. And as ye go, preach (kērussō, G2784), saying, The kingdom (basileia, G932) of heaven is at hand (eggizō, G1448). Heal (therapeuō, G2323) the sick (astheneō, G770), cleanse (katharizō, G2511) the lepers, raise (egeirō, G1453) the dead, cast out (ekballō, G1544) devils (daimonion, G1140): freely (dōrean, G1432) ye have received (lambanō, G2983), freely (dōrean, G1432) give (didōmi, G1325).”

Matthew 10:5-8 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.10.5-8.KJV>

“And he called the twelve together and gave them power and authority over all demons and to cure diseases, and he sent them out to proclaim the kingdom of God and to heal... When the crowds learned it, they followed him, and he welcomed them and spoke to them of the kingdom of God and cured those who had need of healing.”

Luke 9:1-2, 11 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.9.1-11.ESV>

“Then he called his twelve disciples together, and gave them power (dunamis, G1411) and authority (exousia, G1849) over all devils (daimonion, G1140), and to cure (therapeuō, G2323) diseases (nosos, G3554). And he sent (apostellō, G649) them to preach (kērussō, G2784) the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God, and to heal (iaomai, G2390) the sick (astheneō, G770)... And the people, when they knew it, followed him: and he received (dechomai, G1209) them, and spake unto them of the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God, and healed (iaomai, G2390) them that had need of healing (therapeia, G2322).”

Luke 9:1-2, 11 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/luk.9.1-11.KJV>

12. While John the Baptist was the greatest prophet until the time of Jesus, Jesus brought the kingdom of heaven near, ultimately giving the Spirit of God to live inside those who committed to God's rule in their lives. This makes them greater than John the Baptist.

“Truly, I say to you, among those born of women there has arisen no one greater than John the Baptist. Yet the one who is least in the kingdom of heaven is greater than he.”

Matthew 11:11 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.11.11.ESV>

“Verily I say unto you, Among them that are born of women there hath not risen a greater than John the Baptist: notwithstanding he that is least in the kingdom (basileia, G932) of heaven is greater than he.”

Matthew 11:11 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.11.11.KJV>

“I tell you, among those born of women none is greater than John. Yet the one who is least in the kingdom of God is greater than he.””

Luke 7:28 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.7.28.ESV>

“For I say unto you, Among those that are born of women there is not a greater prophet than John the Baptist: but he that is least in the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God is greater than he.”

Luke 7:28 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/luk.7.28.KJV>

13. John the Baptist began to proclaim that the rule of God was at hand, coming to the world through the ministry of Jesus Christ. There is a war between the kingdom of God and the realm of darkness. Territory is taken by force. Satan steals, kills and destroys, yet without authority as a thief. (He was allowed to kill both John and Jesus.) Christ (and Christ in you) now has the authority to forcibly expel devils and sickness, destroying the works of the devil and putting Satan under His feet, yet this authority must be enforced. The gospel must also be preached so that many will turn from darkness to light. In so doing, God’s government comes into the world.

“From the days of John the Baptist until now the kingdom of heaven has suffered violence, and the violent take it by force.”

Matthew 11:12 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.11.12.ESV>

“And from the days of John the Baptist until now the kingdom (basileia, G932) of heaven suffereth violence (biazō, G971), and the violent (biastēs, G973) take it by force (harpazō, G726).”

Matthew 11:12 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.11.12.KJV>

““The Law and the Prophets were until John; since then the good news of the kingdom of God is preached, and everyone forces his way into it.”

Luke 16:16 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.16.16.ESV>

“The law and the prophets were until John: since that time the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God is preached (euaggelizō, G2097), and every man presseth (biazō, G971) into it.”

Luke 16:16 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/luk.16.16.KJV>

14. Casting out devils and healing are signs that demonstrate God’s kingdom rule. They are accomplished by the Spirit of God, who is able to bind Satan’s influence within one held captive and set them free. It is unforgivable to call the work of the Holy Spirit of God the work of Satan, or to identify Jesus Christ with Satan. Further, a kingdom divided against itself cannot stand, so Satan will not cast out devils or destroy his own work of sickness.

“Then a demon-oppressed man who was blind and mute was brought to him, and he healed him, so that the man spoke and saw. And all the people were amazed, and said, “Can this be the Son of David?” But when the Pharisees heard it, they said, “It is only by Beelzebul, the prince of demons, that this man casts out demons.” Knowing their thoughts, he said to them, “Every kingdom divided against itself is laid waste, and no city or house divided against itself will stand. And if Satan casts out Satan, he is divided against himself. How then will his kingdom stand? And if I cast out demons by Beelzebul, by whom do your sons cast them out? Therefore they will be your judges. But if it is by the Spirit of God that I cast out demons, then the kingdom of God has come upon you. Or how can someone enter a strong man’s house and plunder his goods, unless he first binds the strong man? Then indeed he may plunder his house. Whoever is not with me is against me, and whoever does not gather with me scatters. Therefore I tell you, every sin and blasphemy will be forgiven people, but the blasphemy against the Spirit will not be forgiven. And whoever speaks a word against the Son of Man will be forgiven, but whoever speaks against the Holy Spirit will not be forgiven, either in this age or in the age to come.”

Matthew 12:22-32 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.12.22-32.ESV>

“Then was brought unto him one possessed with a devil (daimonizomai, G1139), blind, and dumb (kōphos, G2974): and he healed (therapeuō, G2323) him, insomuch that the blind and dumb both spake and saw. And all the people were amazed, and said, Is not this the son of David? But when the Pharisees heard it, they said, This fellow doth not cast out devils (daimonion, G1140), but by Beelzebub (Beelzeboul, G954) the prince of the devils. And Jesus knew their thoughts, and said unto them, Every kingdom (basileia, G932) divided against itself is brought to desolation; and every city or house divided against itself shall not stand (histēmi, G2476): and if Satan (Satanas, G4567) cast out (ekballō, G1533) Satan, he is divided against himself; how shall then his kingdom stand? And if I by Beelzebub cast out devils, by whom do your children cast them out? therefore they shall be your judges. But if I cast out devils by the Spirit of God, then the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God is come (phthanō, G5348) unto you. Or else how can one enter into (eiserchomai, G1525) a strong man’s (ischuros, G2478) house (oikia, G3614), and spoil his goods, except he first bind (deō, G1210) the strong man? and then he will spoil his house. He that is not with me is against me; and he that gathereth (sunagō, G4863) not with me scattereth abroad (skorpizō, G4650). Wherefore I say unto you, All manner of sin and blasphemy (blasphēmia, G988) shall be forgiven unto men: but the blasphemy against the Holy Ghost shall not be forgiven unto men. And whosoever speaketh a word against the Son of man, it shall be forgiven him: but whosoever speaketh against the Holy Ghost, it shall not be forgiven him, neither in this world, neither in the world to come.”

Matthew 12:22-32 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.12.22-32.KJV>

“And the scribes who came down from Jerusalem were saying, “He is possessed by Beelzebul,” and “by the prince of demons he casts out the demons.” And he called them to him and said to them in parables, “How can Satan cast out Satan? If a kingdom is divided against itself, that kingdom cannot stand. And if a house is divided against itself, that house will not be able to stand. And if Satan has risen up against himself and is divided, he cannot stand, but is coming

to an end. But no one can enter a strong man's house and plunder his goods, unless he first binds the strong man. Then indeed he may plunder his house. "Truly, I say to you, all sins will be forgiven the children of man, and whatever blasphemies they utter, but whoever blasphemes against the Holy Spirit never has forgiveness, but is guilty of an eternal sin"—for they were saying, "He has an unclean spirit."

Mark 3:22-30 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mrk.3.22-30.ESV>

"And the scribes which came down from Jerusalem said, He hath Beelzebub (Beelzeboul, G954), and by the prince of the devils (daimonion, G1140) casteth he out (ekballō, G1544) devils. And he called them unto him, and said unto them in parables, How can Satan (Satanas, G4567) cast out Satan? And if a kingdom (basileia, G932) be divided against itself, that kingdom cannot stand (histēmi, G2476). And if a house (oikia, G3614) be divided against itself, that house cannot stand. And if Satan rise up against himself, and be divided, he cannot stand, but hath an end. No man can enter into (eiserchomai, G1525) a strong man's (ischuros, G2478) house, and spoil (diarpazō, G1283) his goods (skeuos, G4632), except he will first bind (deō, G1210) the strong man; and then he will spoil his house. Verily I say unto you, All sins shall be forgiven unto the sons of men, and blasphemies wherewith soever they shall blaspheme: but he that shall blaspheme (blasphēmēō, G987) against the Holy (hagios, G40) Ghost hath never forgiveness, but is in danger of eternal damnation: because they said, He hath an unclean (akathartos, G169) spirit."

Mark 3:22-30 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mrk.3.22-30.KJV>

"Now he was casting out a demon that was mute. When the demon had gone out, the mute man spoke, and the people marveled. But some of them said, "He casts out demons by Beelzebul, the prince of demons," while others, to test him, kept seeking from him a sign from heaven. But he, knowing their thoughts, said to them, "Every kingdom divided against itself is laid waste, and a divided household falls. And if Satan also is divided against himself, how will his kingdom stand? For you say that I cast out demons by Beelzebul. And if I cast out demons by Beelzebul, by whom do your sons cast them out? Therefore they will be your judges. But if it is by the finger of God that I cast out demons, then the kingdom of God has come upon you. When a strong man, fully armed, guards his own palace, his goods are safe; but when one stronger than he attacks him and overcomes him, he takes away his armor in which he trusted and divides his spoil."

Luke 11:14-22 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.11.14-22.ESV>

"And he was casting out (ekballō, G1544) a devil (daimonion, G1140), and it was dumb (kōphos, G2974). And it came to pass (ginomai, G1096), when the devil was gone out (exerchomai, G1831), the dumb spake; and the people wondered. But some of them said, He casteth out (ekballō, G1544) devils through Beelzebub (Beelzeboul, G954) the chief of the devils. And others, tempting him, sought of him a sign (sēmeion, G4592) from heaven. But he, knowing their thoughts, said unto them, Every kingdom (basileia, G932) divided against (diamerizō,

G1266) itself is brought to desolation; and a house (oikos, G3624) divided against an house falleth. If Satan (Satanas, G4567) also be divided against himself, how shall his kingdom (basileia, G932) stand? because ye say that I cast out devils through Beelzebub. And if I by Beelzebub cast out devils, by whom do your sons cast them out? therefore shall they be your judges. But if I with the finger of God cast out (ekballō, G1544) devils, no doubt the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God is come upon (phthanō, G5348) you. When a strong man (ischuros, G2478) armed (kathoplizō, G2528) keepeth his palace, his goods are in peace: but when a stronger than he shall come upon him, and overcome (nikaō, G3528) him, he taketh (airō, G142) from him all his armour wherein he trusted, and divideth his spoils.”

Luke 11:14-22 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/luk.11.14-22.KJV>

15. Only some are given to know the mysteries of the kingdom, or of God’s government, rule, and ways.

“Then the disciples came and said to him, “Why do you speak to them in parables?” And he answered them, “To you it has been given to know the secrets of the kingdom of heaven, but to them it has not been given. For to the one who has, more will be given, and he will have an abundance, but from the one who has not, even what he has will be taken away. This is why I speak to them in parables, because seeing they do not see, and hearing they do not hear, nor do they understand. Indeed, in their case the prophecy of Isaiah is fulfilled that says: ““You will indeed hear but never understand, and you will indeed see but never perceive.” For this people’s heart has grown dull, and with their ears they can barely hear, and their eyes they have closed, lest they should see with their eyes and hear with their ears and understand with their heart and turn, and I would heal them.”

Matthew 13:10-15 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.13.10-15.ESV>

“And the disciples came, and said unto him, Why speakest thou unto them in parables? He answered and said unto them, Because it is given unto you to know the mysteries (mustērion, G3466) of the kingdom (basileia, G932) of heaven, but to them it is not given. For whosoever hath, to him shall be given, and he shall have more abundance: but whosoever hath not, from him shall be taken away even that he hath. Therefore speak I to them in parables: because they seeing see not; and hearing they hear not, neither do they understand. And in them is fulfilled the prophecy of Esaias, which saith, By hearing ye shall hear, and shall not understand; And seeing ye shall see, and shall not perceive: For this people’s heart is waxed gross, And their ears are dull of hearing, And their eyes they have closed; Lest at any time they should see with their eyes, And hear with their ears, And should understand with their heart, And should be converted (epistrephō, G1994), and I should heal (iaomai, G2390) them.”

Matthew 13:10-15 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.13.10-15.KJV>

“And when he was alone, those around him with the twelve asked him about the parables. And he said to them, “To you has been given the secret of the kingdom of God, but for those outside

everything is in parables, so that “they may indeed see but not perceive, and may indeed hear but not understand, lest they should turn and be forgiven.””

Mark 4:10-12 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mrk.4.10-12.ESV>

“And when he was alone, they that were about him with the twelve asked of him the parable. And he said unto them, Unto you it is given to know the mystery (mustērion, G3466) of the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God: but unto them that are without, all these things are done in parables: that seeing they may see, and not perceive; and hearing they may hear, and not understand; lest at any time they should be converted (epistrephō, G1994), and their sins should be forgiven (aphiēmi, G863) them.”

Mark 4:10-12 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mrk.4.10-12.KJV>

“And when his disciples asked him what this parable meant, he said, “To you it has been given to know the secrets of the kingdom of God, but for others they are in parables, so that ‘seeing they may not see, and hearing they may not understand.’”

Luke 8:9-10 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.8.9-10.ESV>

“And his disciples asked him, saying, What might this parable be? And he said, Unto you it is given to know the mysteries (mustērion, G3466) of the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God: but to others in parables; that seeing they might not see, and hearing they might not understand.”

Luke 8:9-10 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/luk.8.9-10.KJV>

16. The word of God is of the kingdom. It's the perfect blueprint of what the rule of God does in a life. When it grows to maturity, it yields life, rightness, and the divine nature attributes of God, as shown in the life of Jesus Christ, the word made flesh. One must think on, understand, believe, and do the word of God in order to keep it (or to make it part of their renewed mind), allowing the word of God to do what it is designed to do. The realm of darkness works actively to take away the word of God that is sown by whatever means possible in order to stop this blueprint of God's kingdom from unfolding in people (to mature them in Christ) and in the world. We are able to sow God's word by speaking it to others and by making disciples. His word in our mouth produces life.

““Hear then the parable of the sower: When anyone hears the word of the kingdom and does not understand it, the evil one comes and snatches away what has been sown in his heart. This is what was sown along the path. As for what was sown on rocky ground, this is the one who hears the word and immediately receives it with joy, yet he has no root in himself, but endures for a while, and when tribulation or persecution arises on account of the word, immediately he falls away. As for what was sown among thorns, this is the one who hears the word, but the cares of the world and the deceitfulness of riches choke the word, and it proves unfruitful. As for what was sown on good soil, this is the one who hears the word and understands it. He indeed

bears fruit and yields, in one case a hundredfold, in another sixty, and in another thirty.” He put another parable before them, saying, “The kingdom of heaven may be compared to a man who sowed good seed in his field, but while his men were sleeping, his enemy came and sowed weeds among the wheat and went away. So when the plants came up and bore grain, then the weeds appeared also. And the servants of the master of the house came and said to him, ‘Master, did you not sow good seed in your field? How then does it have weeds?’ He said to them, ‘An enemy has done this.’ So the servants said to him, ‘Then do you want us to go and gather them?’ But he said, ‘No, lest in gathering the weeds you root up the wheat along with them. Let both grow together until the harvest, and at harvest time I will tell the reapers, “Gather the weeds first and bind them in bundles to be burned, but gather the wheat into my barn.”’”

Matthew 13:18-30 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.13.18-30.ESV>

“Hear ye therefore the parable of the sower. When any one heareth the word (logos, G3056) of the kingdom (basileia, G932), and understandeth (suniēmi, G4920) it not, then cometh the wicked (ponēros, G4190) one, and catcheth away (harpazō, G726) that which was sown in his heart (kardia, G2588). This is he which received seed by the way side. But he that received the seed into stony places, the same is he that heareth the word, and anon with joy receiveth (lambanō, G2983) it; yet hath he not root in himself, but dureth for a while: for when tribulation or persecution ariseth because of the word, by and by he is offended (skandalizō, G4624). He also that received seed among the thorns is he that heareth the word; and the care (merimna, G3308) of this world, and the deceitfulness of riches (ploutos, G4149), choke (sumpnigō, G4846) the word, and he becometh unfruitful (akarpōs, G175). But he that received seed into the good (kalos, G2570) ground is he that heareth the word, and understandeth (suniēmi, G4920) it; which also beareth fruit (karpophoreō, G2592), and bringeth forth (poieō, G4160), some an hundredfold, some sixty, some thirty. Another parable put he forth unto them, saying, The kingdom (basileia, G932) of heaven is likened unto a man which sowed good (kalos, G2570) seed in his field: but while men slept (katheudō, G2518), his enemy came and sowed tares among the wheat, and went his way. But when the blade was sprung up, and brought forth fruit, then appeared the tares also. So the servants of the householder came and said unto him, Sir, didst not thou sow good (kalos, G2570) seed in thy field? from whence then hath it tares? He said unto them, An enemy hath done this. The servants said unto him, Wilt thou then that we go and gather them up? But he said, Nay; lest while ye gather up the tares, ye root up also the wheat with them. Let both grow together until the harvest: and in the time of harvest I will say to the reapers, Gather ye together first the tares, and bind (deō, G1210) them in bundles to burn them: but gather (sunagō, G4863) the wheat into my barn.”

Matthew 13:18-30 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.13.18-30.KJV>

“And he was teaching them many things in parables, and in his teaching he said to them: “Listen! Behold, a sower went out to sow. And as he sowed, some seed fell along the path, and the birds came and devoured it. Other seed fell on rocky ground, where it did not have much soil, and immediately it sprang up, since it had no depth of soil. And when the sun rose, it was scorched, and since it had no root, it withered away. Other seed fell among thorns, and the

thorns grew up and choked it, and it yielded no grain. And other seeds fell into good soil and produced grain, growing up and increasing and yielding thirtyfold and sixtyfold and a hundredfold." And he said, "He who has ears to hear, let him hear." And when he was alone, those around him with the twelve asked him about the parables. And he said to them, "To you has been given the secret of the kingdom of God, but for those outside everything is in parables, so that "they may indeed see but not perceive, and may indeed hear but not understand, lest they should turn and be forgiven." And he said to them, "Do you not understand this parable? How then will you understand all the parables? The sower sows the word. And these are the ones along the path, where the word is sown: when they hear, Satan immediately comes and takes away the word that is sown in them. And these are the ones sown on rocky ground: the ones who, when they hear the word, immediately receive it with joy. And they have no root in themselves, but endure for a while; then, when tribulation or persecution arises on account of the word, immediately they fall away. And others are the ones sown among thorns. They are those who hear the word, but the cares of the world and the deceitfulness of riches and the desires for other things enter in and choke the word, and it proves unfruitful. But those that were sown on the good soil are the ones who hear the word and accept it and bear fruit, thirtyfold and sixtyfold and a hundredfold." ...And he said, "The kingdom of God is as if a man should scatter seed on the ground. He sleeps and rises night and day, and the seed sprouts and grows; he knows not how. The earth produces by itself, first the blade, then the ear, then the full grain in the ear. But when the grain is ripe, at once he puts in the sickle, because the harvest has come.""

Mark 4:2-20, 26-29 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mrk.4.2-29.ESV>

"And he taught them many things by parables, and said unto them in his doctrine, Hearken; Behold, there went out a sower to sow: and it came to pass, as he sowed, some fell by the way side, and the fowls of the air came and devoured it up. And some fell on stony ground, where it had not much earth; and immediately it sprang up, because it had no depth of earth: but when the sun was up, it was scorched; and because it had no root, it withered away. And some fell among thorns, and the thorns grew up, and choked it, and it yielded no fruit. And other fell on good (kalos, G2570) ground, and did yield fruit that sprang up and increased (auxanō, G837); and brought forth, some thirty, and some sixty, and some an hundred. And he said unto them, He that hath ears to hear, let him hear. And when he was alone, they that were about him with the twelve asked of him the parable. And he said unto them, Unto you it is given to know the mystery (mustērion, G3466) of the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God: but unto them that are without, all these things are done in parables: that seeing they may see, and not perceive; and hearing they may hear, and not understand; lest at any time they should be converted (epistrephō, G1994), and their sins should be forgiven (aphiēmi, G963) them. And he said unto them, Know ye not this parable? and how then will ye know all parables? The sower soweth the word (logos, G3056). And these are they by the way side, where the word is sown; but when they have heard, Satan cometh immediately, and taketh away the word that was sown in their hearts (kardia, G2588). And these are they likewise which are sown on stony ground; who, when they have heard the word, immediately receive (lambanō, G2983) it with gladness; and have no root in themselves, and so endure but for a time: afterward, when affliction or

persecution ariseth for the word's sake, immediately they are offended (skandalizō, G4624). And these are they which are sown among thorns; such as hear the word, and the cares (merimna, G3308) of this world, and the deceitfulness of riches (ploutos, G4149), and the lusts (epithumia, G1939) of other things entering in, choke (sumpnigō, G4846) the word, and it becometh unfruitful (akarpōs, G175). And these are they which are sown on good (kalos, G2570) ground; such as hear the word, and receive (paradechomai, G3858) it, and bring forth fruit (karpophoreō, G2592), some thirtyfold, some sixty, and some an hundred... And he said, So is the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God, as if a man should cast seed into the ground; and should sleep, and rise night and day, and the seed should spring (blastanō, G985) and grow up (mēkunō, G3373), he knoweth not how. For the earth bringeth forth fruit of herself; first the blade, then the ear, after that the full (plērēs, G4134) corn in the ear. But when the fruit is brought forth, immediately he putteth in the sickle, because the harvest is come."

Mark 4:2-20, 26-29 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mrk.4.2-29.KJV>

17. The kingdom of heaven is life giving as unto a tiny mustard seed that grows up to become an enormous mustard tree.

"He put another parable before them, saying, "The kingdom of heaven is like a grain of mustard seed that a man took and sowed in his field. It is the smallest of all seeds, but when it has grown it is larger than all the garden plants and becomes a tree, so that the birds of the air come and make nests in its branches."

Matthew 13:31-32 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.13.31-32.ESV>

"Another parable put he forth unto them, saying, The kingdom (basileia, G932) of heaven is like to a grain of mustard seed (sinapi, G4615), which a man took, and sowed in his field: which indeed is the least of all seeds: but when it is grown (auxanō, G837), it is the greatest among herbs, and becometh a tree, so that the birds of the air come and lodge in the branches thereof."

Matthew 13:31-32 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.13.31-32.KJV>

"And he said, "With what can we compare the kingdom of God, or what parable shall we use for it? It is like a grain of mustard seed, which, when sown on the ground, is the smallest of all the seeds on earth, yet when it is sown it grows up and becomes larger than all the garden plants and puts out large branches, so that the birds of the air can make nests in its shade."

Mark 4:30-32 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mrk.4.30-32.ESV>

"And he said, Whereunto shall we liken the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God? or with what comparison shall we compare it? It is like a grain of mustard seed (sinapi, G4615), which, when it is sown in the earth, is less than all the seeds that be in the earth: but when it is sown, it

groweth up, and becometh greater than all herbs, and shooteth out great branches; so that the fowls of the air may lodge under the shadow of it.”

Mark 4:30-32 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mrk.4.30-32.KJV>

”He said therefore, “What is the kingdom of God like? And to what shall I compare it? It is like a grain of mustard seed that a man took and sowed in his garden, and it grew and became a tree, and the birds of the air made nests in its branches.”“

Luke 13:18-19 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.13.18-19.ESV>

”Then said he, Unto what is the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God like? and whereunto shall I resemble it? It is like a grain of mustard seed (sinapi, G4615), which a man took, and cast into his garden; and it grew (auxanō, G837), and waxed a great tree; and the fowls of the air lodged in the branches of it.”

Luke 13:18-19 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/luk.13.18-19.KJV>

18. The kingdom of heaven is like leaven, bringing growth, maturity, fullness and rightness to those who are joined to it. As the kingdom comes into the world, evil is also put under Christ’s feet.

”He told them another parable. “The kingdom of heaven is like leaven that a woman took and hid in three measures of flour, till it was all leavened.”“

Matthew 13:33 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.13.33.ESV>

”Another parable spake he unto them; The kingdom (basileia, G932) of heaven is like unto leaven, which a woman took, and hid in three measures of meal, till the whole was leavened.”

Matthew 13:33 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.13.33.KJV>

”And again he said, “To what shall I compare the kingdom of God? It is like leaven that a woman took and hid in three measures of flour, until it was all leavened.”“

Luke 13:20-21 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.13.20-21.ESV>

”And again he said, Whereunto shall I liken the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God? It is like leaven, which a woman took and hid in three measures of meal, till the whole was leavened.”

Luke 13:20-21 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/luk.13.20-21.KJV>

19. Those who become sons (heirs) of the kingdom by grace stop sinning and live righteously instead, bearing good fruit. (Fruit relates to both character and action.) This is how they may be

identified both now and later at the harvest of the kingdom. Those who do unrighteousness will go to hell. The righteous shine forth as the sun, or the glory of God, in the kingdom; they are glorious, reflecting God's glory.

"Then he left the crowds and went into the house. And his disciples came to him, saying, "Explain to us the parable of the weeds of the field." He answered, "The one who sows the good seed is the Son of Man. The field is the world, and the good seed is the sons of the kingdom. The weeds are the sons of the evil one, and the enemy who sowed them is the devil. The harvest is the end of the age, and the reapers are angels. Just as the weeds are gathered and burned with fire, so will it be at the end of the age. The Son of Man will send his angels, and they will gather out of his kingdom all causes of sin and all law-breakers, and throw them into the fiery furnace. In that place there will be weeping and gnashing of teeth. Then the righteous will shine like the sun in the kingdom of their Father. He who has ears, let him hear."

Matthew 13:36-43 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.13.36-43.ESV>

"Then Jesus sent the multitude away, and went into the house: and his disciples came unto him, saying, Declare unto us the parable of the tares of the field. He answered and said unto them, He that soweth the good (kalos, G2570) seed is the Son of man; the field is the world; the good (kalos, G2570) seed are the children (uihos, G5207) of the kingdom (basileia, G932); but the tares are the children of the wicked one; the enemy that sowed them is the devil; the harvest is the end of the world; and the reapers are the angels. As therefore the tares are gathered and burned in the fire; so shall it be in the end of this world. The Son of man shall send forth his angels, and they shall gather out of his kingdom (basileia, G932) all things that offend (skandalon, G4625), and them which do iniquity (anomia, G458); and shall cast them into a furnace of fire: there shall be wailing and gnashing of teeth. Then shall the righteous (dikaioi, G1342) shine forth (eklampō, G1584) as the sun in the kingdom (basileia, G932) of their Father. Who hath ears to hear, let him hear."

Matthew 13:36-43 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.13.36-43.KJV>

"Again, the kingdom of heaven is like a net that was thrown into the sea and gathered fish of every kind. When it was full, men drew it ashore and sat down and sorted the good into containers but threw away the bad. So it will be at the end of the age. The angels will come out and separate the evil from the righteous and throw them into the fiery furnace. In that place there will be weeping and gnashing of teeth."

Matthew 13:47-50 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.13.47-50.ESV>

"Again, the kingdom (basileia, G932) of heaven is like unto a net, that was cast into the sea, and gathered (sunagō, G4863) of every kind: which, when it was full (plēroō, G4137), they drew to shore, and sat down, and gathered the good (kalos, G2570) into vessels, but cast the bad (saproi, G4550) away. So shall it be at the end of the world: the angels shall come forth, and

sever the wicked (ponēros, G4190) from among the just (dikaios, G1342), and shall cast them into the furnace of fire: there shall be wailing and gnashing of teeth.“

Matthew 13:47-50 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.13.47-50.KJV>

20. The kingdom of heaven is the greatest treasure; it cannot be received by one that already has treasure within one's old life in the world. The understanding of this treasure will bring joy. (The treasure is Christ in you. It's God's government and rule. It's where His will is done.) The cost to receive the kingdom of heaven is to completely abandon one's old life and treasure. We are only to hold fast to our righteous God and His kingdom.

”“The kingdom of heaven is like treasure hidden in a field, which a man found and covered up. Then in his joy he goes and sells all that he has and buys that field. “Again, the kingdom of heaven is like a merchant in search of fine pearls, who, on finding one pearl of great value, went and sold all that he had and bought it.“

Matthew 13:44-46 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.13.44-46.ESV>

”Again, the kingdom (basileia, G932) of heaven is like unto treasure (thēsauros, G2344) hid in a field; the which when a man hath found, he hideth, and for joy thereof goeth and selleth all that he hath (echō, G2192), and buyeth that field. Again, the kingdom (basileia, G932) of heaven is like unto a merchant man, seeking goodly (kalos, G2570) pearls: who, when he had found one pearl of great price, went and sold all that he had (echō, G2192), and bought it.“

Matthew 13:44-46 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.13.44-46.KJV>

21. There is a mix of the new creation and the old in those being disciplined. The old must be driven out to be replaced by the new nature that is of Christ.

”And he said to them, “Therefore every scribe who has been trained for the kingdom of heaven is like a master of a house, who brings out of his treasure what is new and what is old.”“

Matthew 13:52 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.13.52.ESV>

”Then said he unto them, Therefore every scribe which is instructed (mathēteuō, G3100) unto the kingdom (basileia, G932) of heaven is like unto a man that is an householder, which bringeth forth (ekballō, G1544) out of his treasure (thēsauros, G2344) things new (kainos, G2537) and old (palaios, G3820).“

Matthew 13:52 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.13.52.KJV>

22. To those having faith in Him, Jesus gave the keys of the kingdom of heaven: binding and loosing between earth and heaven. That which is evil can be told it has no legal right and be commanded to depart. Insisting on this authority, evil cannot prevail. This practice enforces

Christ's victory over evil, bringing God's government and rule to earth. It causes God's will to be done on earth as it is in heaven.

"And I tell you, you are Peter, and on this rock I will build my church, and the gates of hell shall not prevail against it. I will give you the keys of the kingdom of heaven, and whatever you bind on earth shall be bound in heaven, and whatever you loose on earth shall be loosed in heaven.""

Matthew 16:18-19 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.16.18-19.ESV>

"And I say also unto thee, That thou art Peter (Petros, G4074), and upon this rock (petra, G4073) I will build (oikodomeō, G3618) my church (ekklēsia, G1577); and the gates (pulē, G4439) of hell shall not prevail against (katischuō, G2729) it. And I will give (didōmi, G1325) unto thee the keys (kleis, G2807) of the kingdom (basileia, G932) of heaven: and whatsoever thou shalt bind (deō, G1210) on earth shall be bound (deō, G1210) in heaven: and whatsoever thou shalt loose (luō, G3089) on earth shall be loosed (luō, G3089) in heaven."

Matthew 16:18-19 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.16.18-19.KJV>

23. The transfiguration was a view into the kingdom seen by Jesus' three closest disciples.

"Truly, I say to you, there are some standing here who will not taste death until they see the Son of Man coming in his kingdom."

Matthew 16:28 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.16.28.ESV>

"Verily I say unto you, There be some standing here, which shall not taste of death, till they see the Son of man coming (erchomai, G2064) in his kingdom (basileia, G932)."

Matthew 16:28 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.16.28.KJV>

"And he said to them, "Truly, I say to you, there are some standing here who will not taste death until they see the kingdom of God after it has come with power."

Mark 9:1 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mrk.9.1.ESV>

"And he said unto them, Verily I say unto you, That there be some of them that stand here, which shall not taste of death, till they have seen the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God come (erchomai, G2064) with power (dunamis, G1411)."

Mark 9:1 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mrk.9.1.KJV>

"But I tell you truly, there are some standing here who will not taste death until they see the kingdom of God."

Luke 9:27 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.9.27.ESV>

"But I tell you of a truth, there be some standing here, which shall not taste of death, till they see the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God."

Luke 9:27 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/luk.9.27.KJV>

24. The greatest in the kingdom are the repentant, who become of childlike faith and humbled condition. The most important aspect of childlike faith is to favorably receive the kingdom of God's government, rule, and ways.

"At that time the disciples came to Jesus, saying, "Who is the greatest in the kingdom of heaven?" And calling to him a child, he put him in the midst of them and said, "Truly, I say to you, unless you turn and become like children, you will never enter the kingdom of heaven. Whoever humbles himself like this child is the greatest in the kingdom of heaven."

Matthew 18:1-4 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.18.1-4.ESV>

"At the same time came the disciples unto Jesus, saying, Who is the greatest in the kingdom (basileia, G932) of heaven? And Jesus called a little child unto him, and set him in the midst of them, and said, Verily I say unto you, Except ye be converted (strephō, G4762), and become as little children, ye shall not enter (eiserchomai, G1525) into the kingdom (basileia, G932) of heaven. Whosoever therefore shall humble (tapeinoō, G5013) himself as this little child, the same is greatest in the kingdom (basileia, G932) of heaven."

Matthew 18:1-4 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.18.1-4.KJV>

"Then children were brought to him that he might lay his hands on them and pray. The disciples rebuked the people, but Jesus said, "Let the little children come to me and do not hinder them, for to such belongs the kingdom of heaven." And he laid his hands on them and went away."

Matthew 19:13-15 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.19.13-15.ESV>

"Then were there brought unto him little children, that he should put his hands (cheir, G5495) on them, and pray: and the disciples rebuked them. But Jesus said, Suffer little children, and forbid (kōluō, G2967) them not, to come (erchomai, G2064) unto me: for of such is the kingdom (basileia, G932) of heaven. And he laid his hands (cheir, G5495) on them, and departed thence."

Matthew 19:13-15 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.19.13-15.KJV>

"And they were bringing children to him that he might touch them, and the disciples rebuked them. But when Jesus saw it, he was indignant and said to them, "Let the children come to me;

do not hinder them, for to such belongs the kingdom of God. Truly, I say to you, whoever does not receive the kingdom of God like a child shall not enter it.” And he took them in his arms and blessed them, laying his hands on them.“

Mark 10:13-16 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mrk.10.13-16.ESV>

”And they brought young children to him, that he should touch (haptomai, G680) them: and his disciples rebuked those that brought them. But when Jesus saw it, he was much displeased, and said unto them, Suffer the little children to come (erchomai, G2064) unto me, and forbid (kōluō, G2967) them not: for of such is the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God. Verily I say unto you, Whosoever shall not receive (dechomai, G1209) the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God as a little child, he shall not enter (eiserchomai, G1525) therein. And he took them up in his arms (enagkalizomai, G1723), put his hands (cheir, G5495) upon them, and blessed (eulogeō, G2127) them.“

Mark 10:13-16 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mrk.10.13-16.KJV>

”Now they were bringing even infants to him that he might touch them. And when the disciples saw it, they rebuked them. But Jesus called them to him, saying, “Let the children come to me, and do not hinder them, for to such belongs the kingdom of God. Truly, I say to you, whoever does not receive the kingdom of God like a child shall not enter it.”“

Luke 18:15-17 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.18.15-17.ESV>

”And they brought unto him also infants, that he would touch (haptomai, G680) them: but when his disciples saw it, they rebuked them. But Jesus called them unto him, and said, Suffer little children to come (erchomai, G2064) unto me, and forbid (kōluō, G2967) them not: for of such is the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God. Verily I say unto you, Whosoever shall not receive (dechomai, G1209) the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God as a little child shall in no wise enter (eiserchomai, G1525) therein.“

Luke 18:15-17 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/luk.18.15-17.KJV>

25. In the kingdom of heaven, all are expected to loose and forgive others repeatedly out of mercy and compassion, just as has been done by God for them.

”Then Peter came up and said to him, “Lord, how often will my brother sin against me, and I forgive him? As many as seven times?” Jesus said to him, “I do not say to you seven times, but seventy-seven times. “Therefore the kingdom of heaven may be compared to a king who wished to settle accounts with his servants. When he began to settle, one was brought to him who owed him ten thousand talents. And since he could not pay, his master ordered him to be sold, with his wife and children and all that he had, and payment to be made. So the servant fell on his knees, imploring him, ‘Have patience with me, and I will pay you everything.’ And out of pity for him, the master of that servant released him and forgave him the debt. But when that

same servant went out, he found one of his fellow servants who owed him a hundred denarii, and seizing him, he began to choke him, saying, 'Pay what you owe.' So his fellow servant fell down and pleaded with him, 'Have patience with me, and I will pay you.' He refused and went and put him in prison until he should pay the debt. When his fellow servants saw what had taken place, they were greatly distressed, and they went and reported to their master all that had taken place. Then his master summoned him and said to him, 'You wicked servant! I forgave you all that debt because you pleaded with me. And should not you have had mercy on your fellow servant, as I had mercy on you?' And in anger his master delivered him to the jailers, until he should pay all his debt. So also my heavenly Father will do to every one of you, if you do not forgive your brother from your heart.'"

Matthew 18:21-35 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.18.23-35.ESV>

"Then came Peter to him, and said, Lord (kurios, G2962), how oft shall my brother (adelphos, G80) sin against me, and I forgive (aphiēmi, G863) him? till seven times? Jesus saith unto him, I say not unto thee, Until seven times: but, Until seventy times seven (hebdomēkontakis, G1441). Therefore is the kingdom (basileia, G932) of heaven likened unto a certain king, which would take account of his servants (doulos, G1401). And when he had begun to reckon, one was brought unto him, which owed him ten thousand talents. But forasmuch as he had not to pay, his Lord commanded him to be sold (pipraskō, G4097), and his wife, and children, and all that he had (echō, G2192), and payment to be made. The servant therefore fell down, and worshipped (proskuneō, G4352) him, saying, Lord (kurios, G2962), have patience (makrothumeō, G3114) with me, and I will pay thee all. Then the Lord of that servant was moved with compassion (splanchnizomai, G4697), and loosed (apoluō, G630) him, and forgave (aphiēmi, G863) him the debt. But the same servant went out, and found one of his fellowservants, which owed him an hundred pence: and he laid hands on him, and took him by the throat, saying, Pay me that thou owest. And his fellowservant fell down at his feet, and besought him, saying, Have patience (makrothumeō, G3114) with me, and I will pay thee all. And he would not: but went and cast him into prison, till he should pay the debt. So when his fellowservants saw what was done, they were very sorry, and came and told unto their Lord all that was done. Then his Lord, after that he had called him, said unto him, O thou wicked (ponēros, G4190) servant, I forgave (aphiēmi, G863) thee all that debt, because thou desiredst (parakaleō, G3870) me: shouldst not thou also have had compassion (eleeō, G1653) on thy fellowservant, even as I had pity (eleeō, G1653) on thee? And his Lord was wroth, and delivered him to the tormentors (basanistēs, G930), till he should pay all that was due unto him. So likewise shall my heavenly Father do also unto you, if ye from your hearts (kardia, G2588) forgive (aphiēmi, G863) not every one his brother their trespasses."

Matthew 18:21-35 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.18.21-35.KJV>

26. The people of the kingdom are to obey God's rules for marriage or remain unmarried.

"And I say to you: whoever divorces his wife, except for sexual immorality, and marries another, commits adultery." The disciples said to him, "If such is the case of a man with his wife, it is

better not to marry.” But he said to them, “Not everyone can receive this saying, but only those to whom it is given. For there are eunuchs who have been so from birth, and there are eunuchs who have been made eunuchs by men, and there are eunuchs who have made themselves eunuchs for the sake of the kingdom of heaven. Let the one who is able to receive this receive it.”“

Matthew 19:9-12 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.19.9-12.ESV>

”And I say unto you, Whosoever shall put away (apoluō, G630) his wife, except it be for fornication (porneia, G4202), and shall marry another, committeth adultery: and whoso marrieth her which is put away doth commit adultery. His disciples say unto him, If the case of the man be so with his wife, it is not good (sumpherō, G4851) to marry. But he said unto them, All men cannot receive (chōreō, G5562) this saying, save they to whom it is given. For there are some eunuchs (eunouchos, G2135), which were so born from their mother's womb: and there are some eunuchs (eunouchos, G2135), which were made eunuchs (eunouchos, G2135) of men: and there be eunuchs (eunouchos, G2135), which have made themselves eunuchs (eunouchizō, G2134) for the kingdom (basileia, G932) of heaven's sake. He that is able to receive (chōreō, G5562) it, let him receive (chōreō, G5562) it.“

Matthew 19:9-12 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.19.9-12.KJV>

27. The kingdom of heaven is the greatest treasure; it cannot be received by one that already has treasure within one's old life in the world. As such, it is difficult for the rich to allow for God's government and rule in their life, giving themselves over to do God's will.

”Jesus said to him, “If you would be perfect, go, sell what you possess and give to the poor, and you will have treasure in heaven; and come, follow me.” When the young man heard this he went away sorrowful, for he had great possessions. And Jesus said to his disciples, “Truly, I say to you, only with difficulty will a rich person enter the kingdom of heaven. Again I tell you, it is easier for a camel to go through the eye of a needle than for a rich person to enter the kingdom of God.”“

Matthew 19:21-24 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.19.21-24.ESV>

”Jesus said unto him, If thou wilt (thelō, G2309) be perfect (teleios, G5046), go and sell that thou hast (huparchonta, G5224), and give to the poor, and thou shalt have (echō, G2192) treasure (thēsauros, G2344) in heaven: and come and follow (akoloutheō, G190) me. But when the young man heard that saying, he went away sorrowful: for he had great possessions (ktēma, G2933). Then said Jesus unto his disciples, Verily I say unto you, That a rich man shall hardly (duskolōs, G1423) enter (eiserchomai, G1525) into the kingdom (basileia, G932) of heaven. And again I say unto you, It is easier for a camel to go through the eye of a needle, than for a rich man to enter (eiserchomai, G1525) into the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God.“

Matthew 19:21-24 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.19.21-24.KJV>

"And Jesus, looking at him, loved him, and said to him, "You lack one thing: go, sell all that you have and give to the poor, and you will have treasure in heaven; and come, follow me."

Disheartened by the saying, he went away sorrowful, for he had great possessions. And Jesus looked around and said to his disciples, "How difficult it will be for those who have wealth to enter the kingdom of God!" And the disciples were amazed at his words. But Jesus said to them again, "Children, how difficult it is to enter the kingdom of God! It is easier for a camel to go through the eye of a needle than for a rich person to enter the kingdom of God."

Mark 10:21-25 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mrk.10.21-25.ESV>

"Then Jesus beholding him loved (agapaō, G25) him, and said unto him, One thing thou lackest: go thy way, sell whatsoever thou hast (echō, G2192), and give to the poor, and thou shalt have (echō, G2192) treasure in heaven: and come, take up the cross (stauros, G4716), and follow (akoloutheō, G190) me. And he was sad at that saying, and went away grieved (lupeō, G3076): for he had great possessions (ktēma, G2933). And Jesus looked round about, and saith unto his disciples, How hardly (duskolōs, G1423) shall they that have riches enter (eiserchomai, G1525) into the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God! And the disciples were astonished at his words. But Jesus answereth again, and saith unto them, Children, how hard (duskolos, G1423) is it for them that trust (peithō, G3982) in riches to enter (eiserchomai, G1525) into the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God! It is easier for a camel to go through the eye of a needle, than for a rich man to enter (eiserchomai, G1525) into the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God."

Mark 10:21-25 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mrk.10.21-25.KJV>

"When Jesus heard this, he said to him, "One thing you still lack. Sell all that you have and distribute to the poor, and you will have treasure in heaven; and come, follow me." But when he heard these things, he became very sad, for he was extremely rich. Jesus, seeing that he had become sad, said, "How difficult it is for those who have wealth to enter the kingdom of God! For it is easier for a camel to go through the eye of a needle than for a rich person to enter the kingdom of God."

Luke 18:22-25 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.18.22-25.ESV>

"Now when Jesus heard these things, he said unto him, Yet lackest thou one thing: sell all that thou hast (echō, G2192), and distribute unto the poor, and thou shalt have (echō, G2192) treasure (thēsauros, G2344) in heaven: and come, follow (akoloutheō, G190) me. And when he heard this, he was very sorrowful (perilupos, G4036): for he was very rich. And when Jesus saw that he was very sorrowful, he said, How hardly (duskolōs, G1423) shall they that have (echō, G2192) riches enter (eiserchomai, G1525) into the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God! For it is easier for a camel to go through a needle's eye, than for a rich man to enter (eiserchomai, G1525) into the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God."

Luke 18:22-25 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/luk.18.22-25.KJV>

28. God is generous to offer to bring people into His kingdom to do His work on His terms. Our rules of fairness don't apply. God is good and will do what is right. His kingdom goes contrary to our expectations based on what we have seen in life.

”“For the kingdom of heaven is like a master of a house who went out early in the morning to hire laborers for his vineyard. After agreeing with the laborers for a denarius a day, he sent them into his vineyard. And going out about the third hour he saw others standing idle in the marketplace, and to them he said, ‘You go into the vineyard too, and whatever is right I will give you.’ So they went. Going out again about the sixth hour and the ninth hour, he did the same. And about the eleventh hour he went out and found others standing. And he said to them, ‘Why do you stand here idle all day?’ They said to him, ‘Because no one has hired us.’ He said to them, ‘You go into the vineyard too.’ And when evening came, the owner of the vineyard said to his foreman, ‘Call the laborers and pay them their wages, beginning with the last, up to the first.’ And when those hired about the eleventh hour came, each of them received a denarius. Now when those hired first came, they thought they would receive more, but each of them also received a denarius. And on receiving it they grumbled at the master of the house, saying, ‘These last worked only one hour, and you have made them equal to us who have borne the burden of the day and the scorching heat.’ But he replied to one of them, ‘Friend, I am doing you no wrong. Did you not agree with me for a denarius? Take what belongs to you and go. I choose to give to this last worker as I give to you. Am I not allowed to do what I choose with what belongs to me? Or do you begrudge my generosity?’ So the last will be first, and the first last.”“
Matthew 20:1-16 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.20.1-16.ESV>

”For the kingdom (basileia, G932) of heaven is like unto a man that is an householder, which went out early in the morning to hire labourers into his vineyard. And when he had agreed with the labourers for a penny a day, he sent them into his vineyard. And he went out about the third hour, and saw others standing idle in the marketplace, and said unto them; Go ye also into the vineyard, and whatsoever is right (dikaios, G1342) I will give you. And they went their way. Again he went out about the sixth and ninth hour, and did likewise. And about the eleventh hour he went out, and found others standing idle, and saith unto them, Why stand ye here all the day idle? They say unto him, Because no man hath hired us. He saith unto them, Go ye also into the vineyard; and whatsoever is right (dikaios, G1342), that shall ye receive (lambano, G2983). And when they came that were hired about the eleventh hour, they received every man a penny. But when the first came, they supposed that they should have received more; and they likewise received every man a penny. And when they had received it, they murmured against the goodman of the house, saying, These last have wrought but one hour, and thou hast made them equal unto us, which have borne the burden and heat of the day. But he answered one of them, and said, Friend, I do thee no wrong: didst not thou agree with me for a penny? Take that thine is, and go thy way: I will give unto this last, even as unto thee. Is it not lawful (exesti, G1832) for me to do what I will (thelō, G2309) with mine own? Is thine eye (ophthalmos, G3788) evil (ponēros, G4190), because I am good (agathos, G18)? So the last shall be first, and the first last: for many be called (klētos, G2822), but few chosen (eklektos, G1588).“

Matthew 20:1-7, 9-16 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.20.1-16.KJV>

29. God has structured the government in His kingdom very differently than the ways of the world. When you have the opportunity to do so, don't lord it over or exercise authority over others as is commonly done in the world. Instead, minister to and serve others as Christ Jesus showed by example, giving over your interests and will and even your life for their good. You are to be a minister and to give. Further, to take part in God's kingdom is to have both privilege and responsibility, both now and in the life to come. In God's kingdom, Jesus' first apostles will have the responsibility to sit on thrones governing the twelve tribes of Israel. The main privilege that we as sons (and daughters, really heirs) have in the kingdom is a close relationship with God; we are even now directly connected to Him. The full privileges of sonship (as co-heirs with Christ) and the responsibility we will have in His kingdom are our reward for our faithfulness to God here.

"Then the mother of the sons of Zebedee came up to him with her sons, and kneeling before him she asked him for something. And he said to her, "What do you want?" She said to him, "Say that these two sons of mine are to sit, one at your right hand and one at your left, in your kingdom." Jesus answered, "You do not know what you are asking. Are you able to drink the cup that I am to drink?" They said to him, "We are able." He said to them, "You will drink my cup, but to sit at my right hand and at my left is not mine to grant, but it is for those for whom it has been prepared by my Father." And when the ten heard it, they were indignant at the two brothers. But Jesus called them to him and said, "You know that the rulers of the Gentiles Lord it over them, and their great ones exercise authority over them. It shall not be so among you. But whoever would be great among you must be your servant, and whoever would be first among you must be your slave, even as the Son of Man came not to be served but to serve, and to give his life as a ransom for many.""

Matthew 20:20-28 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.20.20-28.ESV>

"Then came to him the mother of Zebedee's children with her sons, worshipping him, and desiring (aiteō, G154) a certain thing of him. And he said unto her, What wilt thou (thelō, G2309)? She saith unto him, Grant that these my two sons may sit, the one on thy right hand, and the other on the left, in thy kingdom (basileia, G932). But Jesus answered and said, Ye know (eidō, G1492) not what ye ask (aiteō, G154). Are ye able to drink of the cup (potērion, G4221) that I shall drink of, and to be baptized (baptizō, G907) with the baptism (baptisma, G908) that I am baptized with (baptizō, G907)? They say unto him, We are able. And he saith unto them, Ye shall drink indeed of my cup (potērion, G4221), and be baptized (baptizō, G907) with the baptism (baptisma, G908) that I am baptized with (baptizō, G907): but to sit on my right hand, and on my left, is not mine to give, but it shall be given to them for whom it is prepared of my Father. And when the ten heard it, they were moved with indignation against the two brethren. But Jesus called them unto him, and said, Ye know that the princes of the Gentiles exercise dominion over (katakuriēuō, G2634) them, and they that are great exercise authority upon (katexousiazō, G2715) them. But it shall not be so among you: but whosoever will (thelō,

G2309) be great among you, let him be your minister (diakonos, G1249); and whosoever will be chief among you, let him be your servant (doulos, G1401): even as the Son of man came not to be ministered unto (diakoneō, G1247), but to minister (diakoneō, G1247), and to give (didōmi, G1325) his life (psuchē, G5590) a ransom (lutron, G3083) for many.”

Matthew 20:20-28 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.20.20-28.KJV>

”A dispute also arose among them, as to which of them was to be regarded as the greatest. And he said to them, “The kings of the Gentiles exercise Lordship over them, and those in authority over them are called benefactors. But not so with you. Rather, let the greatest among you become as the youngest, and the leader as one who serves. For who is the greater, one who reclines at table or one who serves? Is it not the one who reclines at table? But I am among you as the one who serves. “You are those who have stayed with me in my trials, and I assign to you, as my Father assigned to me, a kingdom, that you may eat and drink at my table in my kingdom and sit on thrones judging the twelve tribes of Israel.”

Luke 22:24-30 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.22.24-30.ESV>

”And there was also a strife (philoneikia, G5349) among them, which of them should be accounted (dokeō, G1380) the greatest. And he said unto them, The kings (basileus, G935) of the Gentiles exercise Lordship over (kurieuō, G2961) them; and they that exercise authority upon (exousiazō, G1850) them are called benefactors (euergetēs, G2110). But ye shall not be so: but he that is greatest among you, let him be as the younger (neos, G3501); and he that is chief (hēgeomai, G2233), as he that doth serve (diakoneō, G1247). For whether is greater, he that sitteth at meat, or he that serveth (diakoneō, G1247)? is not he that sitteth at meat? but I am among you as he that serveth (diakoneō, G1247). Ye are they which have continued (diamenō, G1265) with me in my temptations (periasmos, G3986). And I appoint (diatithemai, G1303) unto you a kingdom (basileia, G932), as my Father hath appointed (diatithemai, G1303) unto me; that ye may eat and drink at my table in my kingdom (basileia, G932), and sit on thrones (thrones, G2362) judging (krinō, G2919) the twelve tribes of Israel.”

Luke 22:24-30 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/luk.22.24-30.KJV>

30. In the kingdom, there is belief in God and His word, repentance, and obedience to God’s will. He wills that we occupy ourselves in such a way as to bear fruit that pleases Him. All are welcomed into repentance, or a change of mind and purpose to conform with that of God.

”“What do you think? A man had two sons. And he went to the first and said, ‘Son, go and work in the vineyard today.’ And he answered, ‘I will not,’ but afterward he changed his mind and went. And he went to the other son and said the same. And he answered, ‘I go, sir,’ but did not go. Which of the two did the will of his father?” They said, “The first.” Jesus said to them, “Truly, I say to you, the tax collectors and the prostitutes go into the kingdom of God before you. For John came to you in the way of righteousness, and you did not believe him, but the tax

collectors and the prostitutes believed him. And even when you saw it, you did not afterward change your minds and believe him.”

Matthew 21:28-32 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.21.28-32.ESV>

”But what think ye? A certain man had two sons; and he came to the first, and said, Son, go work (ergazomai, G2038) to day in my vineyard. He answered and said, I will (thelō, G2309) not: but afterward he repented (metamellomai, G3338), and went. And he came to the second, and said likewise. And he answered and said, I go, sir (kurios, G2962): and went not. Whether of them twain did the will (thelēma, G2307) of his father? They say unto him, The first. Jesus saith unto them, Verily I say unto you, That the publicans and the harlots go (proagō, G4254) into the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God before you. For John came unto you in the way (hodos, G3598) of righteousness (dikaïosunē, G1343), and ye believed (pisteuō, G4100) him not: but the publicans and the harlots believed (pisteuō, G4100) him: and ye, when ye had seen it, repented (metamellomai, G3338) not afterward, that ye might believe (pisteuō, G4100) him.”

Matthew 21:28-32 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.21.28-32.KJV>

31. The kingdom of God stays only with those producing its fruits. Change in nature and character, and good works reflecting this glorious character, should follow repentance. Those who reject Christ will be destroyed.

”“Hear another parable. There was a master of a house who planted a vineyard and put a fence around it and dug a winepress in it and built a tower and leased it to tenants, and went into another country. When the season for fruit drew near, he sent his servants to the tenants to get his fruit. And the tenants took his servants and beat one, killed another, and stoned another. Again he sent other servants, more than the first. And they did the same to them. Finally he sent his son to them, saying, ‘They will respect my son.’ But when the tenants saw the son, they said to themselves, ‘This is the heir. Come, let us kill him and have his inheritance.’ And they took him and threw him out of the vineyard and killed him. When therefore the owner of the vineyard comes, what will he do to those tenants?” They said to him, “He will put those wretches to a miserable death and let out the vineyard to other tenants who will give him the fruits in their seasons.” Jesus said to them, “Have you never read in the Scriptures: “‘The stone that the builders rejected has become the cornerstone; this was the Lord’s doing, and it is marvelous in our eyes’? Therefore I tell you, the kingdom of God will be taken away from you and given to a people producing its fruits. And the one who falls on this stone will be broken to pieces; and when it falls on anyone, it will crush him.” When the chief priests and the Pharisees heard his parables, they perceived that he was speaking about them.”

Matthew 21:33-45 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.21.33-45.ESV>

”Hear another parable: There was a certain householder, which planted a vineyard, and hedged it round about, and digged a winepress in it, and built a tower, and let it out to husbandmen, and went into a far country: and when the time of the fruit drew near, he sent his servants to the

husbandmen, that they might receive the fruits of it. And the husbandmen took his servants, and beat one, and killed another, and stoned another. Again, he sent other servants more than the first: and they did unto them likewise. But last of all he sent unto them his son, saying, They will reverence (entrepō, G1788) my son. But when the husbandmen saw the son, they said among themselves, This is the heir; come, let us kill him, and let us seize on his inheritance. And they caught him, and cast him out (ekballō, G1544) of the vineyard, and slew him. When the Lord (kurios, G2962) therefore of the vineyard cometh, what will he do unto those husbandmen? They say unto him, He will miserably (kakōs, G2560) destroy those wicked men (kakos, G2556), and will let out his vineyard unto other husbandmen, which shall render (apodidōmi, G591) him the fruits (karpos, G2590) in their seasons (kairos, G2540). Jesus saith unto them, Did ye never read in the scriptures, The stone which the builders rejected, The same is become the head of the corner: This is the Lord's (kurios, G2962) doing, And it is marvellous in our eyes? Therefore say I unto you, The kingdom (basileia, G932) of God shall be taken from you, and given to a nation bringing forth (poieō, G4160) the fruits (karpos, G2590) thereof. And whosoever shall fall on this stone shall be broken: but on whomsoever it shall fall, it will grind him to powder. And when the chief priests and Pharisees had heard his parables, they perceived that he spake of them."

Matthew 21:33-45 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.21.33-45.KJV>

32. In the kingdom of God, we are sent out to invite many to come in. But only those with wedding garments (those who follow Christ and produce the fruit of the Spirit, including holy living) may stay. They comprise the cherished bride of Christ. Most invited do not will to follow after Christ though, so they will not enjoy what follows only from relationship with Him.

"And again Jesus spoke to them in parables, saying, "The kingdom of heaven may be compared to a king who gave a wedding feast for his son, and sent his servants to call those who were invited to the wedding feast, but they would not come. Again he sent other servants, saying, 'Tell those who are invited, "See, I have prepared my dinner, my oxen and my fat calves have been slaughtered, and everything is ready. Come to the wedding feast."' But they paid no attention and went off, one to his farm, another to his business, while the rest seized his servants, treated them shamefully, and killed them. The king was angry, and he sent his troops and destroyed those murderers and burned their city. Then he said to his servants, 'The wedding feast is ready, but those invited were not worthy. Go therefore to the main roads and invite to the wedding feast as many as you find.' And those servants went out into the roads and gathered all whom they found, both bad and good. So the wedding hall was filled with guests. "But when the king came in to look at the guests, he saw there a man who had no wedding garment. And he said to him, 'Friend, how did you get in here without a wedding garment?' And he was speechless. Then the king said to the attendants, 'Bind him hand and foot and cast him into the outer darkness. In that place there will be weeping and gnashing of teeth.' For many are called, but few are chosen."

Matthew 22:1-14 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.22.1-14.ESV>

"And Jesus answered and spake unto them again by parables, and said, The kingdom (basileia, G932) of heaven is like unto a certain king, which made a marriage (gamos, G1062) for his son, and sent forth (apostellō, G649) his servants (doulos, G1401) to call (kaleō, G2564) them that were bidden to the wedding (gamos, G1062): and they would (thelō, G2302) not come. Again, he sent forth (apostellō, G649) other servants (doulos, G1401), saying, Tell them which are bidden, Behold, I have prepared my dinner: my oxen and my fatlings are killed, and all things are ready: come unto the marriage (gamos, G1062). But they made light of it, and went their ways, one to his farm, another to his merchandise: and the remnant took his servants (doulos, G1401), and entreated them spitefully (hubrizō, G1541), and slew them. But when the king heard thereof, he was wroth: and he sent forth his armies, and destroyed those murderers, and burned up their city. Then saith he to his servants, The wedding is ready, but they which were bidden were not worthy (axios, G514). Go ye therefore into the highways, and as many as ye shall find, bid (kaleō, G2564) to the marriage (gamos, G1062). So those servants went out into the highways, and gathered together all as many as they found, both bad (ponēros, G4190) and good (agathos, G18): and the wedding (gamos, G1062) was furnished with guests. And when the king came in to see the guests, he saw there a man which had not on a wedding garment: and he saith unto him, Friend, how camest thou in hither not having (echō, G2192) a wedding garment? And he was speechless. Then said the king to the servants (diakonos, G1249), Bind (deō, G1210) him hand and foot, and take him away, and cast him into outer darkness (skotos, G4655); there shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth. For many are called (klētos, G2822), but few are chosen (eklektos, G1588)."

Matthew 22:1-14 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.22.1-14.KJV>

33. The Pharisees shut the kingdom of heaven against men by not doing God's word, by their means of discipling people in the false teachings of traditions of men, and by opposing those following Christ. To enter into His kingdom, we must be careful to put God's word into practice, as spoken by Jesus, and we are to make it our focus to please God.

"But woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! For you shut the kingdom of heaven in people's faces. For you neither enter yourselves nor allow those who would enter to go in."

Matthew 23:13 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.23.13.ESV>

"But woe unto you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites (hupokritēs, G5273)! for ye shut up (kleiō, G2818) the kingdom (basileia, G932) of heaven against men: for ye neither go in (eiserchomai, G1525) yourselves, neither suffer ye them that are entering to go in."

Matthew 23:13 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.23.13.KJV>

34. The gospel of the kingdom shall be preached in all the world as a witness to the nations, then shall the end come. This is the gospel that Jesus preached, taught and demonstrated with signs. He then gave this responsibility to all disciples.

"And this gospel of the kingdom will be proclaimed throughout the whole world as a testimony to all nations, and then the end will come."

Matthew 24:14 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.24.14.ESV>

"And this gospel (euaggelion, G2098) of the kingdom (basileia, G932) shall be preached (kērussō, G2784) in all the world for a witness unto all nations; and then shall the end come."

Matthew 24:14 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.24.14.KJV>

35. The kingdom includes those who remain faithful to God and His word. Out of those intending to enter, only some choose to be connected in Christ to God's Holy Spirit and the brilliant life that follows from this connection, thereby staying ready to marry the bridegroom when He comes. Only some choose to fan into flame the gift that is within them by doing the things God loves, while others allow it to be extinguished. Only some are faithful stewards of the gift (of the Spirit) and the responsibilities (like family, finances, occupation, and ability) that God gave them. God expects us to get up, go out into the world around us, and use what He has given us, occupying ourselves by doing kingdom work. God will not allow the disconnected, irresponsible, and unfaithful to enter into life in the kingdom with Him. On the other hand, the faithful will be rewarded with more responsibility and with abundance in God's kingdom.

"Then the kingdom of heaven will be like ten virgins who took their lamps and went to meet the bridegroom. Five of them were foolish, and five were wise. For when the foolish took their lamps, they took no oil with them, but the wise took flasks of oil with their lamps. As the bridegroom was delayed, they all became drowsy and slept. But at midnight there was a cry, 'Here is the bridegroom! Come out to meet him.' Then all those virgins rose and trimmed their lamps. And the foolish said to the wise, 'Give us some of your oil, for our lamps are going out.' But the wise answered, saying, 'Since there will not be enough for us and for you, go rather to the dealers and buy for yourselves.' And while they were going to buy, the bridegroom came, and those who were ready went in with him to the marriage feast, and the door was shut. Afterward the other virgins came also, saying, 'Lord, Lord, open to us.' But he answered, 'Truly, I say to you, I do not know you.' Watch therefore, for you know neither the day nor the hour. "For it will be like a man going on a journey, who called his servants and entrusted to them his property. To one he gave five talents, to another two, to another one, to each according to his ability. Then he went away. He who had received the five talents went at once and traded with them, and he made five talents more. So also he who had the two talents made two talents more. But he who had received the one talent went and dug in the ground and hid his master's money. Now after a long time the master of those servants came and settled accounts with them. And he who had received the five talents came forward, bringing five talents more, saying, 'Master, you delivered to me five talents; here, I have made five talents more.' His master said to him, 'Well done, good and faithful servant. You have been faithful over a little; I will set you over much. Enter into the joy of your master.' And he also who had the two talents came forward, saying, 'Master, you delivered to me two talents; here, I have made two talents more.' His master said to him, 'Well done, good and faithful servant. You have been faithful over

a little; I will set you over much. Enter into the joy of your master.' He also who had received the one talent came forward, saying, 'Master, I knew you to be a hard man, reaping where you did not sow, and gathering where you scattered no seed, so I was afraid, and I went and hid your talent in the ground. Here, you have what is yours.' But his master answered him, 'You wicked and slothful servant! You knew that I reap where I have not sown and gather where I scattered no seed? Then you ought to have invested my money with the bankers, and at my coming I should have received what was my own with interest. So take the talent from him and give it to him who has the ten talents. For to everyone who has will more be given, and he will have an abundance. But from the one who has not, even what he has will be taken away. And cast the worthless servant into the outer darkness (skotos, G4655). In that place there will be weeping and gnashing of teeth.'"

Matthew 25:1-30 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.25.1-30.ESV>

"Then shall the kingdom (basileia, G932) of heaven be likened unto ten virgins (parthenos, G3933), which took their lamps (lampas, G2985), and went forth to meet the bridegroom. And five of them were wise (phronimos, G5429), and five were foolish. They that were foolish took their lamps, and took no oil (elaion, G1637) with them: but the wise (phronimos, G5429) took oil (elaion, G1637) in their vessels with their lamps (lampas, G2985). While the bridegroom tarried, they all slumbered and slept. And at midnight there was a cry made, Behold, the bridegroom cometh; go ye out to meet him. Then all those virgins arose, and trimmed their lamps. And the foolish said unto the wise, Give us of your oil; for our lamps are gone out (sbennumi, G4570). But the wise answered, saying, Not so; lest there be not enough for us and you: but go ye rather to them that sell, and buy for yourselves. And while they went to buy, the bridegroom came; and they that were ready (hetoimos, G2092) went in with him to the marriage (gamos, G1062): and the door (thura, G2374) was shut (kleiō, G2808). Afterward came also the other virgins, saying, Lord (kurios, G2962), Lord, open to us. But he answered and said, Verily I say unto you, I know you not. Watch (grēgoreuō, G1127) therefore, for ye know neither the day nor the hour wherein the Son of man cometh. For the kingdom of heaven is as a man travelling into a far country, who called (kaleō, G2564) his own servants (doulos, G1401), and delivered (paradidōmi, G3860) unto them his goods (huparchonta, G5224). And unto one he gave five talents (talanton, G5007), to another two, and to another one; to every man according to his several ability (dunamis, G1411); and straightway took his journey (apodēmeō, G589). Then he that had received (lambanō, G2983) the five talents went and traded (ergazomai, G2038) with the same, and made (poieō, G4160) them other five talents. And likewise he that had received two, he also gained (kerdainō, G2770) other two. But he that had received one went and digged in the earth, and hid (apokruptō, G613) his Lord's money. After a long time the Lord (kurios, G2962) of those servants (doulos, G1401) cometh, and reckoneth (sunairō, G4868) with them. And so he that had received five talents came and brought other five talents, saying, Lord, thou deliveredst unto me five talents: behold, I have gained (kerdainō, G2770) beside them five talents more. His Lord said unto him, Well done (eu, G2095), thou good (agathos, G18) and faithful (pistos, G4103) servant (doulos, G1401): thou hast been faithful (pistos, G4103) over a few things, I will make thee ruler (kathistēmi, G2525) over many things: enter thou (eiserchomai, G1525) into the joy (chara, G5479) of thy Lord (kurios, G2962). He also that had received (lambanō, G2983) two

talents came and said, Lord (kurios, G2962), thou deliveredst unto me two talents: behold, I have gained two other talents beside them. His Lord said unto him, Well done, good and faithful servant; thou hast been faithful over a few things, I will make thee ruler over many things: enter thou into the joy of thy Lord. Then he which had received the one talent came and said, Lord, I knew thee that thou art an hard (sklēros, G4642) man, reaping where thou hast not sown, and gathering where thou hast not strawed: and I was afraid, and went and hid (kruptō, G2928) thy talent in the earth: lo, there thou hast that is thine. His Lord answered and said unto him, Thou wicked (ponēros, G4190) and slothful (oknēros, G3636) servant, thou knewest that I reap where I sowed not, and gather where I have not strawed: thou oughtest therefore to have put my money to the exchangers, and then at my coming I should have received mine own with usury. Take therefore the talent from him, and give it unto him which hath ten talents. For unto every one that hath shall be given, and he shall have abundance (perisseuō, G4052): but from him that hath (echō, G2192) not shall be taken away even that which he hath. And cast ye (ekballō, G1544) the unprofitable (achreios, G888) servant into outer darkness: there shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth.“

Matthew 25:1-30 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.25.1-30.KJV>

36. The good fruit expected from the good trees (a biblical analogy of Jesus for people, Luke 6:43) that inherit God's kingdom includes active ministry to the least of these. Their Christlike character, especially their nature of love and mercy, naturally leads to such action. They are doers of God's word, the ones to make His will happen on earth. Christ in them, they are the word of God made flesh, so to speak. Meanwhile, the bad trees excluded from God's kingdom lack this good fruit – the nature and character, and the action that naturally follows. When we do good to people, we do it to God Himself, for they are His image bearers; putting love in action to others is love for God.

”“When the Son of Man comes in his glory, and all the angels with him, then he will sit on his glorious throne. Before him will be gathered all the nations, and he will separate people one from another as a shepherd separates the sheep from the goats. And he will place the sheep on his right, but the goats on the left. Then the King will say to those on his right, ‘Come, you who are blessed by my Father, inherit the kingdom prepared for you from the foundation of the world. For I was hungry and you gave me food, I was thirsty and you gave me drink, I was a stranger and you welcomed me, I was naked and you clothed me, I was sick and you visited me, I was in prison and you came to me.’ Then the righteous will answer him, saying, ‘Lord, when did we see you hungry and feed you, or thirsty and give you drink? And when did we see you a stranger and welcome you, or naked and clothe you? And when did we see you sick or in prison and visit you?’ And the King will answer them, ‘Truly, I say to you, as you did it to one of the least of these my brothers, you did it to me.’ “Then he will say to those on his left, ‘Depart from me, you cursed, into the eternal fire prepared for the devil and his angels. For I was hungry and you gave me no food, I was thirsty and you gave me no drink, I was a stranger and you did not welcome me, naked and you did not clothe me, sick and in prison and you did not visit me.’ Then they also will answer, saying, ‘Lord, when did we see you hungry or thirsty or a stranger or naked or sick or in prison, and did not minister to you?’ Then he will answer them, saying, ‘Truly,

I say to you, as you did not do it to one of the least of these, you did not do it to me.' And these will go away into eternal punishment, but the righteous into eternal life.”“

Matthew 25:31-46 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.25.31-46.ESV>

”When the Son of man shall come in his glory (doxa, G1391), and all the holy angels with him, then shall he sit upon the throne (thronos, G2362) of his glory (doxa, G1391): and before him shall be gathered all nations: and he shall separate them one from another, as a shepherd (poimēn, G4166) divideth his sheep from the goats: and he shall set the sheep on his right hand (dexteros, G1188), but the goats on the left. Then shall the King (basileus, G935) say unto them on his right hand, Come, ye blessed (eulogeō, G2127) of my Father, inherit (klēronomeō, G2816) the kingdom (basileia, G932) prepared for you from the foundation of the world: for I was an hungred (peinaō, G3983), and ye gave me meat: I was thirsty, and ye gave me drink (potizō, G4222): I was a stranger (xenos, G3581), and ye took (sunagō, G4863) me in: naked, and ye clothed me: I was sick (astheneō, G770), and ye visited (episkeptomai, G1980) me: I was in prison, and ye came unto me. Then shall the righteous (dikaios, G1342) answer him, saying, Lord (kurios, G2962), when saw we thee an hungred, and fed thee? or thirsty, and gave thee drink? When saw we thee a stranger, and took thee in? or naked, and clothed thee? Or when saw we thee sick, or in prison, and came unto thee? And the King shall answer and say unto them, Verily I say unto you, Inasmuch as ye have done (poieō, G4160) it unto one of the least of these my brethren (adelphos, G80), ye have done (poieō, G4160) it unto me. Then shall he say also unto them on the left hand, Depart from me, ye cursed (kataraomai, G2672), into everlasting fire, prepared for the devil (diabolos, G1228) and his angels: for I was an hungred, and ye gave me no meat: I was thirsty, and ye gave me no drink: I was a stranger, and ye took me not in: naked, and ye clothed me not: sick, and in prison, and ye visited me not. Then shall they also answer him, saying, Lord (kurios, G2962), when saw we thee an hungred, or athirst, or a stranger, or naked, or sick, or in prison, and did not minister (diakoneō, G1247) unto thee? Then shall he answer them, saying, Verily I say unto you, Inasmuch as ye did it not to one of the least of these, ye did it not to me. And these shall go away into everlasting punishment (kolasis, G2851): but the righteous (dikaios, G1342) into life (zōē, G2222) eternal.”

Matthew 25:31-46 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.25.31-46.KJV>

37. Jesus blessed the bread representing His body that was about to be broken for their healing and gave it to the disciples to eat. It is the bread of God's children (Exodus 23:25). He gave thanks for the cup representing His blood shed for their forgiveness of sin and gave it to the disciples to drink. Communion represents what God generously gave us in through the suffering and death of His Son Jesus Christ, the Lamb of God, that unites us and gives us life and freedom from the law of sin and death. What God has joined together (by means of His own suffering and death), precious to Him, we are not to separate. Jesus won't eat the Passover meal (take communion) again until He does it with His disciples when they are new and all (that His suffering and death was meant to do for us) has been fulfilled in our Father's kingdom.

"Now as they were eating, Jesus took bread, and after blessing it broke it and gave it to the disciples, and said, "Take, eat; this is my body." And he took a cup, and when he had given thanks he gave it to them, saying, "Drink of it, all of you, for this is my blood of the covenant, which is poured out for many for the forgiveness of sins. I tell you I will not drink again of this fruit of the vine until that day when I drink it new with you in my Father's kingdom.""

Matthew 26:26-29 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.26.26-29.ESV>

"And as they were eating, Jesus took bread, and blessed (eulogeō, G2127) it, and brake it, and gave (didōmi, G1325) it to the disciples, and said, Take, eat; this is my body (sōma, G4983). And he took the cup (potērion, G4221), and gave thanks (eucharisteō, G2168), and gave (didōmi, G1325) it to them, saying, Drink ye all of it; for this is my blood (aima, G129) of the new testament (diathēkē, G1242), which is shed (ekcheō, G1632) for many for the remission (aphesis, G859) of sins. But I say unto you, I will not drink henceforth of this fruit of the vine, until that day when I drink it new (kainos, G2537) with you in my Father's kingdom (basileia)."

Matthew 26:26-29 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.26.26-29.KJV>

"And as they were eating, he took bread, and after blessing it broke it and gave it to them, and said, "Take; this is my body." And he took a cup, and when he had given thanks he gave it to them, and they all drank of it. And he said to them, "This is my blood of the covenant, which is poured out for many. Truly, I say to you, I will not drink again of the fruit of the vine until that day when I drink it new in the kingdom of God.""

Mark 14:22-25 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mrk.14.22-25.ESV>

"And as they did eat, Jesus took bread, and blessed (eulogeō, G2127), and brake it, and gave to them, and said, Take, eat: this is my body (sōma, G4983). And he took the cup, and when he had given thanks (eucharisteō, G2168), he gave it to them: and they all drank of it. And he said unto them, This is my blood of the new testament, which is shed for many. Verily I say unto you, I will drink no more of the fruit of the vine, until that day that I drink it new in the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God."

Mark 14:22-25 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mrk.14.22-25.KJV>

"And when the hour came, he reclined at table, and the apostles with him. And he said to them, "I have earnestly desired to eat this Passover (pascha, G3957) with you before I suffer. For I tell you I will not eat it until it is fulfilled in the kingdom of God." And he took a cup, and when he had given thanks he said, "Take this, and divide it among yourselves. For I tell you that from now on I will not drink of the fruit of the vine until the kingdom of God comes." And he took bread, and when he had given thanks, he broke it and gave it to them, saying, "This is my body, which is given for you. Do this in remembrance of me." And likewise the cup after they had eaten, saying, "This cup that is poured out for you is the new covenant in my blood."

Luke 22:14-20 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.22.14-20.ESV>

"And when the hour was come, he sat down, and the twelve apostles with him. And he said unto them, With desire I have desired to eat this passover with you before I suffer: for I say unto you, I will not any more eat thereof, until it be fulfilled (plēroō, G4137) in the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God. And he took the cup, and gave thanks (eucharisteō, G2168), and said, Take this, and divide (diamerizō, G1266) it among yourselves: for I say unto you, I will not drink of the fruit of the vine, until the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God shall come (erchomai, G2064). And he took bread, and gave thanks (eucharisteō, G2168), and brake it, and gave unto them, saying, This is my body (sōma, G4983) which is given (didōmi, G1325) for you: this do in remembrance of me. Likewise also the cup after supper, saying, This cup is the new testament (diathēkē, G1242) in my blood (aima, G129), which is shed for you."

Luke 22:14-20 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/luk.22.14-20.KJV>

Mark

38. We are to cut off sin in our lives by any means necessary and not draw others to sin or separate themselves from God so that we and others do not miss out on life in God's kingdom.
39. In the kingdom of God, Christ directed (and expected) that God's sons and daughters speak with authority by the faith living in them and expect to have what they say, and it will come to pass. In particular, His disciples are to speak to any obstacles to God's kingdom work, telling them forcefully to go; expect them to obey; and they shall. This is the way of government and rule in His kingdom; it's how things on earth are brought into alignment with those in heaven by the sons and daughters of the King. This is how we are to have faith in God to cooperate with us to accomplish His will. (It's also a demonstration of the reality of the kingdom of God.) It presumes that as Christ's disciples, we have first aligned ourselves with God's will, which is made evident in God's word. It presumes we have been made single-minded in unity with God's indwelling Spirit. Nothing can stand in the way of the accomplishment of God's kingdom work.
40. Jesus said the scribe who asked and agreed with him about the most important commandments wasn't far from the kingdom. The kingdom of God includes God's rule and reign in our own lives such that we choose to daily do His will. What God wants is for us to love Him as He commands us to love Him, which includes love in action toward His image bearers. We are to hold nothing of ourselves back in our love for God.
41. Genuine believers are those who expect the fulfillment of the promises associated with the kingdom of God, and they are willing to take action on their beliefs. Joseph of Arimathea (or Arimethaea), who saw that Jesus was entombed, was such a man.

38. We are to cut off sin in our lives by any means necessary and not draw others to sin or separate themselves from God so that we and others do not miss out on life in God's kingdom.

"Whoever causes one of these little ones who believe in me to sin, it would be better for him if a great millstone were hung around his neck and he were thrown into the sea. And if your hand causes you to sin, cut it off. It is better for you to enter life crippled than with two hands to go to hell, to the unquenchable fire. And if your foot causes you to sin, cut it off. It is better for you to enter life lame than with two feet to be thrown into hell. And if your eye causes you to sin, tear it out. It is better for you to enter the kingdom of God with one eye than with two eyes to be thrown into hell, 'where their worm does not die and the fire is not quenched.' For everyone will be salted with fire."

Mark 9:42-43, 45, 47-49 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mrk.9.42-49.ESV>

"And whosoever shall offend (skandalizō, G4624) one of these little ones that believe (pisteuō, G4100) in me, it is better for him that a millstone were hanged about his neck, and he were cast into the sea. And if thy hand offend (skandalizō, G4624) thee, cut it off: it is better for thee to enter into life (zōē, G2222) maimed, than having two hands to go into hell, into the fire that never shall be quenched: where their worm dieth not, and the fire is not quenched. And if thy

foot offend (skandalizō, G4624) thee, cut it off: it is better for thee to enter halt into life (zōē, G2222), than having two feet to be cast into hell, into the fire that never shall be quenched: where their worm dieth not, and the fire is not quenched. And if thine eye (ophthalmos, G3788) offend (skandalizō, G4624) thee, pluck it out: it is better for thee to enter (eiserchomai, G1525) into the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God with one eye, than having two eyes to be cast into hell fire: where their worm dieth not, and the fire is not quenched. For every one shall be salted with fire, and every sacrifice shall be salted with salt.“

Mark 9:42-49 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mrk.9.42-49.KJV>

39. In the kingdom of God, Christ directed (and expected) that God's sons and daughters speak with authority by the faith living in them and expect to have what they say, and it will come to pass. In particular, His disciples are to speak to any obstacles to God's kingdom work, telling them forcefully to go; expect them to obey; and they shall. This is the way of government and rule in His kingdom; it's how things on earth are brought into alignment with those in heaven by the sons and daughters of the King. This is how we are to have faith in God to cooperate with us to accomplish His will. (It's also a demonstration of the reality of the kingdom of God.) It presumes that as Christ's disciples, we have first aligned ourselves with God's will, which is made evident in God's word. It presumes we have been made single-minded in unity with God's indwelling Spirit. Nothing can stand in the way of the accomplishment of God's kingdom work.

”As they passed by in the morning, they saw the fig tree withered away to its roots. And Peter remembered and said to him, “Rabbi, look! The fig tree that you cursed has withered.” And Jesus answered them, “Have faith in God. Truly, I say to you, whoever says to this mountain, ‘Be taken up and thrown into the sea,’ and does not doubt in his heart, but believes that what he says will come to pass, it will be done for him. Therefore I tell you, whatever you ask in prayer, believe that you have received it, and it will be yours.“

Mark 11:20-24 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mrk.11.20-24.ESV>

”And in the morning, as they passed by, they saw the fig tree dried up (xērainō, G3583) from the roots. And Peter calling to remembrance saith unto him, Master, behold, the fig tree which thou cursedst (kataraomai, G2672) is withered away (xērainō, G3583). And Jesus answering saith unto them, Have (echō, G2192) faith (pistis, G4102) in God. For verily (amēn, G281) I say (legō, G3004) unto you, That whosoever shall say (epō, G2036) unto this mountain, Be thou removed (airō, G142), and be thou cast into the sea; and shall not doubt (diakrinō, G1252) in his heart (kardia, G2588), but shall believe (pisteuō, G4100) that those things which he saith (legō, G3004) shall come to pass (ginomai, G1096); he shall have whatsoever he saith (epō, G2036). Therefore I say unto you, What things soever ye desire (aiteō, G154), when ye pray (proseuchomai, G4336), believe (pisteuō, G4100) that ye receive (lambanō, G2983) them, and ye shall have (esomai, G2071) them.“

Mark 11:20-24 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mrk.11.20-24.KJV>

"And when they came to the crowd, a man came up to him and, kneeling before him, said, "Lord, have mercy on my son, for he has seizures and he suffers terribly. For often he falls into the fire, and often into the water. And I brought him to your disciples, and they could not heal him." And Jesus answered, "O faithless and twisted generation, how long am I to be with you? How long am I to bear with you? Bring him here to me." And Jesus rebuked the demon, and it came out of him, and the boy was healed instantly. Then the disciples came to Jesus privately and said, "Why could we not cast it out?" He said to them, "Because of your little faith. For truly, I say to you, if you have faith like a grain of mustard seed, you will say to this mountain, 'Move from here to there,' and it will move, and nothing will be impossible for you.'"

Matthew 17:14-20 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.17.14-20.ESV>

"And when they were come to the multitude, there came to him a certain man, kneeling down to him, and saying, Lord, have mercy (eleeō, G1653) on my son: for he is lunatick (selēniazomai, G4583), and sore (kakōs, G2560) vexed: for oftentimes he falleth into the fire, and oft into the water. And I brought him to thy disciples, and they could not cure (therapeuō, G2323) him. Then Jesus answered and said, O faithless (apistos, G571) and perverse (diastrephō, G1294) generation, how long shall I be with you? how long shall I suffer (anechomai, G430) you? bring him hither to me. And Jesus rebuked (epitmaō, G2008) the devil (daimonion, G1140); and he departed (exerchomai, G1831) out of him: and the child was cured (therapeuō, G2323) from that very hour. Then came the disciples to Jesus apart, and said, Why could (dunamai, G1410) not we cast him out (ekballō, G1544)? And Jesus said unto them, Because of your unbelief (apistia, G570): for verily (amēn, G281) I say unto you, If ye have faith (pistis, G4102) as a grain of mustard seed (sinapi, G4615), ye shall say (ereō, G2046) unto this mountain, Remove (metabainō, G3327) hence to yonder place; and it shall remove (metabainō, G3327); and nothing shall be impossible (adunateō, G101) unto you."

Matthew 17:14-20 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.17.14-20.KJV>

"In the morning, as he was returning to the city, he became hungry. And seeing a fig tree by the wayside, he went to it and found nothing on it but only leaves. And he said to it, "May no fruit ever come from you again!" And the fig tree withered at once. When the disciples saw it, they marveled, saying, "How did the fig tree wither at once?" And Jesus answered them, "Truly, I say to you, if you have faith and do not doubt, you will not only do what has been done to the fig tree, but even if you say to this mountain, 'Be taken up and thrown into the sea,' it will happen. And whatever you ask in prayer, you will receive, if you have faith.'"

Matthew 21:18-22 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.21.18-22.ESV>

"Now in the morning as he returned into the city, he hungered. And when he saw a fig tree in the way, he came to it, and found nothing thereon, but leaves only, and said unto it, Let (ginomai, G1096) no fruit grow on thee henceforward for ever. And presently the fig tree withered away (xērainō, G3583). And when the disciples saw it, they marvelled, saying, How soon is the fig tree withered away! Jesus answered and said unto them, Verily (amēn, G281) I say unto you, If

ye have (echō, G2192) faith (pistis, G4102), and doubt (diakrinō, G1252) not, ye shall not only do this which is done to the fig tree, but also if ye shall say (epō, G2036) unto this mountain, Be thou removed (airō, G142), and be thou cast into the sea; it shall be done (ginomai, G1096). And all things, whatsoever ye shall ask (aiteō, G154) in prayer (proseuchē, G4335), believing (pisteuō, G4100), ye shall receive (lambanō, G2983).“

Matthew 21:18-22 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.21.18-22.KJV>

”The apostles said to the Lord, “Increase our faith!” And the Lord said, “If you had faith like a grain of mustard seed, you could say to this mulberry tree, ‘Be uprooted and planted in the sea,’ and it would obey you.”

Luke 17:5-6 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.17.5-6.ESV>

”And the apostles (apostolos, G652) said unto the Lord (kurios, G2962), Increase (prostithēmi, G4369) our faith (pistis, G4102). And the Lord said, If ye had (echō, G2192) faith (pistis, G4102) as a grain of mustard seed (sinapi, G4615), ye might say (legō, G3004) unto this sycamine tree, Be thou plucked up by the root (ekrizō, G1610), and be thou planted in the sea; and it should obey (hupakouō, G5219) you.”

Luke 17:5-6 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/luk.17.5-6.KJV>

40. Jesus said the scribe who asked and agreed with him about the most important commandments wasn't far from the kingdom. The kingdom of God includes God's rule and reign in our own lives such that we choose to daily do His will. What God wants is for us to love Him as He commands us to love Him, which includes love in action toward His image bearers. We are to hold nothing of ourselves back in our love for God.

”And one of the scribes came up and heard them disputing with one another, and seeing that he answered them well, asked him, “Which commandment is the most important of all?” Jesus answered, “The most important is, ‘Hear, O Israel: The Lord our God, the Lord is one. And you shall love the Lord your God with all your heart and with all your soul and with all your mind and with all your strength.’ The second is this: ‘You shall love your neighbor as yourself.’ There is no other commandment greater than these.” And the scribe said to him, “You are right, Teacher. You have truly said that he is one, and there is no other besides him. And to love him with all the heart and with all the understanding and with all the strength, and to love one's neighbor as oneself, is much more than all whole burnt offerings and sacrifices.” And when Jesus saw that he answered wisely, he said to him, “You are not far from the kingdom of God.” And after that no one dared to ask him any more questions.”

Mark 12:28-34 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mrk.12.28-34.ESV>

”And one of the scribes came, and having heard them reasoning together, and perceiving that he had answered them well, asked him, Which is the first commandment of all? And Jesus

answered him, The first of all the commandments is, Hear, O Israel; The Lord (kurios, G2962) our God is one Lord: and thou shalt love (agapaō, G25) the Lord thy God with all thy heart (kardia, G2588), and with all thy soul (psuchē, G5590), and with all thy mind (dianoia, G1271), and with all thy strength (ischus, G2479): this is the first commandment. And the second is like (homoios, G3664), namely this, Thou shalt love (agapaō, G25) thy neighbour (plēsion, G4139) as thyself. There is none other commandment greater than these. And the scribe said unto him, Well, Master, thou hast said the truth: for there is one God; and there is none other but he: and to love him with all the heart, and with all the understanding (sunesis, G4907), and with all the soul, and with all the strength, and to love his neighbour as himself, is more than all whole burnt offerings and sacrifices. And when Jesus saw that he answered discreetly, he said unto him, Thou art not far from the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God. And no man after that durst ask him any question.“

Mark 12:28-34 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mrk.12.28-34.KJV>

41. Genuine believers are those who expect the fulfillment of the promises associated with the kingdom of God, and they are willing to take action on their beliefs. Joseph of Arimathea (or Arimethaea), who saw that Jesus was entombed, was such a man.

”And when evening had come, since it was the day of Preparation, that is, the day before the Sabbath, Joseph of Arimathea, a respected member of the council, who was also himself looking for the kingdom of God, took courage and went to Pilate and asked for the body of Jesus.“

Mark 15:42-43 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mrk.15.42-43.ESV>

”And now when the even was come, because it was the preparation, that is, the day before the sabbath, Joseph of Arimathæa, an honourable counsellor (bouleutēs, G1010), which also waited (prosdechomai, G4327) for the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God, came, and went in boldly (tolmaō, G5111) unto Pilate, and craved the body (sōma, G4983) of Jesus (Iēsous, G2424).“

Mark 15:42-43 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mrk.15.42-43.KJV>

”Now there was a man named Joseph, from the Jewish town of Arimathea. He was a member of the council, a good and righteous man, who had not consented to their decision and action; and he was looking for the kingdom of God. This man went to Pilate and asked for the body of Jesus.“

Luke 23:50-52 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.23.50-52.ESV>

”And, behold, there was a man named Joseph, a counsellor; and he was a good (agathos, G18) man, and a just (dikaios, G1342): (the same had not consented to the counsel and deed of them;) he was of Arimathæa, a city of the Jews: who also himself waited for (prosdechomai,

G4327) the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God. This man went unto Pilate, and begged (aiteō, G154) the body of Jesus.“

Luke 23:50-52 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/luk.23.50-52.KJV>

Luke

42. Jesus reigns over the house of Jacob forever, and of His kingdom there shall be no end.
43. In Capernaum, Jesus got away by saying He was sent to other cities also to preach (declare and show) the kingdom of God, and He must do it. His preaching in the synagogue, the place people assembled, was accompanied by the healing and casting out of demons of many, even on the Sabbath, in order to demonstrate the kingdom (rule and government) of God over evil. The people were astonished that His word possessed authority and power over devils. He also healed everyone who needed it by way of laying hands on them, so the crowd tried to keep Him there. Anointed with the Holy Spirit and with power, He went about doing good and healing all who were oppressed by the devil, for God was with Him.
44. Jesus asked all who would be saved to follow Him. He instructed those who would follow Him to focus, leave their old lives behind, and to go preach the kingdom of God everywhere. Christ's lordship requires single-mindedness toward God's rule over our lives and single-mindedness to carry out His will while dying to our own will.
45. Jesus instructed His disciples to minister in His place: to heal all the sick and say the kingdom of God has come near (through their presence). Healing, accomplished in cooperation with God's indwelling Spirit, is a sign of God's kingdom rule that is to accompany the preaching of God's kingdom. God's will is to bring freedom to the sick, who are oppressed by the devil.
46. Jesus taught that not many will be saved, for not many have actually made Christ Lord, striving to follow Him along the narrow path He walked, ever realigning themselves according to God's government, rule and will. He leads us in a path of righteousness. We must love God on His terms rather than ours.
47. God invites all into His kingdom. We are sent out to invite all to join God's kingdom, but it is an invitation to follow Jesus and submit to His government in our lives, forsaking all else (rather than make excuses about why we cannot). It is His will that we work to meet the needs of the world, starting with those around us.
48. The kingdom of God isn't visible, but rather it's within you. It's His government and rule in your life by the way of your direct connection to God. It's your cooperation with His indwelling Spirit that causes His will to be done on earth as it is in heaven, both inside of you and through your action to bring about good and rightness in the world.
49. Those with Jesus thought the kingdom of God should immediately appear. Yet, He brought the kingdom, His government, rule, and will, into the world, in ways they did not expect – by saving them and giving them His own Spirit. His servants are to occupy (carry on His business as their occupation) until He comes. Those who are faithful will be given more responsibility and authority in the kingdom. Those who will not submit to Christ's lordship over them will be destroyed.
50. One criminal who hung on a cross beside Jesus, believing Jesus was King, asked Him to be remembered when He came into His kingdom. Jesus said it would happen that day. Those who God allows entrance into His kingdom must take a posture of repentance and genuinely believe in Christ's lordship enough that they would *or they do* live in a way that demonstrates this belief and repentance.

42. Jesus reigns over the house of Jacob forever, and of His kingdom there shall be no end.

"And the angel said to her, "Do not be afraid, Mary, for you have found favor with God. And behold, you will conceive in your womb and bear a son, and you shall call his name Jesus. He will be great and will be called the Son of the Most High. And the Lord God will give to him the throne of his father David, and he will reign over the house of Jacob forever, and of his kingdom there will be no end."

Luke 1:30-33 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.1.30-33.ESV>

"And the angel said unto her, Fear not, Mary: for thou hast found favour (charis, G5485) with God. And, behold, thou shalt conceive in thy womb, and bring forth a son, and shalt call his name JESUS (Iêsous, G2424). He shall be great, and shall be called the Son of the Highest (hupsistos, G5310): and the Lord God shall give unto him the throne (thronos, G2362) of his father David: and he shall reign (basileuō, G936) over the house of Jacob for ever; and of his kingdom (basileia, G932) there shall be no end."

Luke 1:30-33 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/luk.1.30-33.KJV>

43. In Capernaum, Jesus got away by saying He was sent to other cities also to preach (declare and show) the kingdom of God, and He must do it. His preaching in the synagogue, the place people assembled, was accompanied by the healing and casting out of demons of many, even on the Sabbath, in order to demonstrate the kingdom (rule and government) of God over evil. The people were astonished that His word possessed authority and power over devils. He also healed everyone who needed it by way of laying hands on them, so the crowd tried to keep Him there. Anointed with the Holy Spirit and with power, He went about doing good and healing all who were oppressed by the devil, for God was with Him.

"And he went down to Capernaum, a city of Galilee. And he was teaching them on the Sabbath, and they were astonished at his teaching, for his word possessed authority. And in the synagogue there was a man who had the spirit of an unclean demon, and he cried out with a loud voice, "Ha! What have you to do with us, Jesus of Nazareth? Have you come to destroy us? I know who you are—the Holy One of God." But Jesus rebuked him, saying, "Be silent and come out of him!" And when the demon had thrown him down in their midst, he came out of him, having done him no harm. And they were all amazed and said to one another, "What is this word? For with authority and power he commands the unclean spirits, and they come out!" And reports about him went out into every place in the surrounding region. And he arose and left the synagogue and entered Simon's house. Now Simon's mother-in-law was ill with a high fever, and they appealed to him on her behalf. And he stood over her and rebuked the fever, and it left her, and immediately she rose and began to serve them. Now when the sun was setting, all those who had any who were sick with various diseases brought them to him, and he laid his hands on every one of them and healed them. And demons also came out of many, crying, "You are the Son of God!" But he rebuked them and would not allow them to speak, because they

knew that he was the Christ. And when it was day, he departed and went into a desolate place. And the people sought him and came to him, and would have kept him from leaving them, but he said to them, "I must preach the good news of the kingdom of God to the other towns as well; for I was sent for this purpose." And he was preaching in the synagogues of Judea."

Luke 4:31-44 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.4.31-44.ESV>

"and came down to Capernaum, a city of Galilee, and taught (didaskō, G1321) them on the sabbath days. And they were astonished at his doctrine (didachē, G1322): for his word (logos, G3056) was with power (exousia, G1849). And in the synagogue (sunagōgē, G4864) there was a man, which had (echō, G2192) a spirit of an unclean (akathartos, G169) devil (daimonion, G1140), and cried out with a loud voice, saying, Let us alone; what have we to do with thee, thou Jesus (Iēsous, G2424) of Nazareth? art thou come to destroy (apollumi, G622) us? I know thee who thou art; the Holy One (hagios, G40) of God. And Jesus rebuked (epitimaō, G2008) him, saying, Hold thy peace (phimoō, G5392), and come out (exerchomai, G1831) of him. And when the devil had thrown him in the midst, he came out (exerchomai, G1831) of him, and hurt him not. And they were all amazed (thambos, G2285), and spake among themselves, saying, What a word is this! for with authority (exousia, G1849) and power (dunamis, G1411) he commandeth (epitassō, G2004) the unclean (akathartos, G169) spirits, and they come out (exerchomai, G1831). And the fame (ēchos, G2279) of him went out into every place of the country round about. And he arose out of the synagogue, and entered into Simon's house. And Simon's wife's mother was taken with (sunechō, G4912) a great fever; and they besought him for her. And he stood over her, and rebuked (epitimaō, G2008) the fever; and it left (aphiēmi, G863) her: and immediately she arose and ministered (diakoneō, G1247) unto them. Now when the sun was setting, all they that had (echō, G2192) any sick with divers diseases (nosos, G3554) brought them unto him; and he laid his hands (cheir, G5495) on every one of them, and healed (therapeuō, G2323) them. And devils (daimonion, G1140) also came (exerchomai, G1831) out of many, crying out, and saying, Thou art Christ (Christos, G5547) the Son of God. And he rebuking (epitimaō, G2008) them suffered (eaō, G1439) them not to speak: for they knew that he was Christ (Christos, G5547). And when it was day, he departed and went into a desert (erēmos, G2048) place: and the people sought him, and came unto him, and stayed him, that he should not depart from them. And he said unto them, I must (dei, G1163) preach (euaggelizō, G2097) the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God to other cities also: for therefore am I sent (apostellō, G649)."

Luke 4:31-43 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/luk.4.31-43.KJV>

44. Jesus asked all who would be saved to follow Him. He instructed those who would follow Him to focus, leave their old lives behind, and to go preach the kingdom of God everywhere. Christ's lordship requires single-mindedness toward God's rule over our lives and single-mindedness to carry out His will while dying to our own will.

"As they were going along the road, someone said to him, "I will follow you wherever you go." And Jesus said to him, "Foxes have holes, and birds of the air have nests, but the Son of Man

has nowhere to lay his head.” To another he said, “Follow me.” But he said, “Lord, let me first go and bury my father.” And Jesus said to him, “Leave the dead to bury their own dead. But as for you, go and proclaim the kingdom of God.” Yet another said, “I will follow you, Lord, but let me first say farewell to those at my home.” Jesus said to him, “No one who puts his hand to the plow and looks back is fit for the kingdom of God.”“

Luke 9:57-62 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.9.57-62.ESV>

”And it came to pass, that, as they went in the way, a certain man said unto him, Lord (kurios, G2962), I will follow thee whithersoever thou goest. And Jesus said unto him, Foxes have holes, and birds of the air have nests; but the Son of man hath not where to lay his head. And he said unto another, Follow me. But he said, Lord, suffer me first to go and bury my father. Jesus said unto him, Let the dead (nekros, G3498) bury their dead (nekros, G3498): but go thou and preach (diaggellō, G1229) the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God. And another also said, Lord, I will follow thee; but let me first go bid them farewell, which are at home at my house. And Jesus said unto him, No man, having put his hand to the plough, and looking back, is fit (euthetos, G2111) for the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God.“

Luke 9:57-62 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/luk.9.57-62.KJV>

45. Jesus instructed His disciples to minister in His place: to heal all the sick and say the kingdom of God has come near (through their presence). Healing, accomplished in cooperation with God’s indwelling Spirit, is a sign of God’s kingdom rule that is to accompany the preaching of God’s kingdom. God’s will is to bring freedom to the sick, who are oppressed by the devil.

”Whenever you enter a town and they receive you, eat what is set before you. Heal the sick in it and say to them, ‘The kingdom of God has come near to you.’ But whenever you enter a town and they do not receive you, go into its streets and say, ‘Even the dust of your town that clings to our feet we wipe off against you. Nevertheless know this, that the kingdom of God has come near.’“

Luke 10:8-11 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.10.8-11.ESV>

”And into whatsoever city ye enter, and they receive you, eat such things as are set before you: and heal (therapeuō, G2323) the sick (asthenēs, G772) that are therein, and say unto them, The kingdom (basileia, G932) of God is come nigh (eggizō, G1448) unto you. But into whatsoever city ye enter, and they receive you not, go your ways out into the streets of the same, and say, Even the very dust of your city, which cleaveth on us, we do wipe off against you: notwithstanding be ye sure of this, that the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God is come nigh (eggizō, G1448) unto you.“

Luke 10:8-11 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/luk.10.8-11.KJV>

46. Jesus taught that not many will be saved, for not many have actually made Christ Lord, striving to follow Him along the narrow path He walked, ever realigning themselves according to God's government, rule and will. He leads us in a path of righteousness. We must love God on His terms rather than ours.

"And someone said to him, "Lord, will those who are saved be few?" And he said to them, "Strive to enter through the narrow door. For many, I tell you, will seek to enter and will not be able. When once the master of the house has risen and shut the door, and you begin to stand outside and to knock at the door, saying, 'Lord, open to us,' then he will answer you, 'I do not know where you come from.' Then you will begin to say, 'We ate and drank in your presence, and you taught in our streets.' But he will say, 'I tell you, I do not know where you come from. Depart from me, all you workers of evil!' In that place there will be weeping and gnashing of teeth, when you see Abraham and Isaac and Jacob and all the prophets in the kingdom of God but you yourselves cast out. And people will come from east and west, and from north and south, and recline at table in the kingdom of God. And behold, some are last who will be first, and some are first who will be last.""

Luke 13:23-30 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.13.23-30.ESV>

"Then said one unto him, Lord (kurios, G2962), are there few that be saved (sōzō, G4982)? And he said unto them, Strive (angōnizomai, G75) to enter in (eiserchomai, G1525) at the strait (stenos, G4728) gate (pulē, G4439): for many, I say unto you, will seek to enter in, and shall not be able (ischuō, G2480). When once the master of the house is risen up, and hath shut to the door, and ye begin to stand without, and to knock at the door, saying, Lord (kurios, G2962), Lord, open unto us; and he shall answer and say unto you, I know you not whence ye are: then shall ye begin to say, We have eaten and drunk in thy presence, and thou hast taught in our streets. But he shall say, I tell you, I know you not whence ye are; depart from me, all ye workers of iniquity (adikia, G93). There shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth, when ye shall see Abraham, and Isaac, and Jacob, and all the prophets, in the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God, and you yourselves thrust out. And they shall come from the east, and from the west, and from the north, and from the south, and shall sit down in the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God. And, behold, there are last which shall be first, and there are first which shall be last."

Luke 13:23-30 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/luk.13.23-30.KJV>

47. God invites all into His kingdom. We are sent out to invite all to join God's kingdom, but it is an invitation to follow Jesus and submit to His government in our lives, forsaking all else (rather than make excuses about why we cannot). It is His will that we work to meet the needs of the world, starting with those around us.

"He said also to the man who had invited him, "When you give a dinner or a banquet, do not invite your friends or your brothers or your relatives or rich neighbors, lest they also invite you in return and you be repaid. But when you give a feast, invite the poor, the crippled, the lame, the blind, and you will be blessed, because they cannot repay you. For you will be repaid at the

resurrection of the just.” When one of those who reclined at table with him heard these things, he said to him, “Blessed is everyone who will eat bread in the kingdom of God!” But he said to him, “A man once gave a great banquet and invited many. And at the time for the banquet he sent his servant to say to those who had been invited, ‘Come, for everything is now ready.’ But they all alike began to make excuses. The first said to him, ‘I have bought a field, and I must go out and see it. Please have me excused.’ And another said, ‘I have bought five yoke of oxen, and I go to examine them. Please have me excused.’ And another said, ‘I have married a wife, and therefore I cannot come.’ So the servant came and reported these things to his master. Then the master of the house became angry and said to his servant, ‘Go out quickly to the streets and lanes of the city, and bring in the poor and crippled and blind and lame.’ And the servant said, ‘Sir, what you commanded has been done, and still there is room.’ And the master said to the servant, ‘Go out to the highways and hedges and compel people to come in, that my house may be filled. For I tell you, none of those men who were invited shall taste my banquet.’” Now great crowds accompanied him, and he turned and said to them, “If anyone comes to me and does not hate his own father and mother and wife and children and brothers and sisters, yes, and even his own life, he cannot be my disciple. Whoever does not bear his own cross and come after me cannot be my disciple. For which of you, desiring to build a tower, does not first sit down and count the cost, whether he has enough to complete it? Otherwise, when he has laid a foundation and is not able to finish, all who see it begin to mock him, saying, ‘This man began to build and was not able to finish.’ Or what king, going out to encounter another king in war, will not sit down first and deliberate whether he is able with ten thousand to meet him who comes against him with twenty thousand? And if not, while the other is yet a great way off, he sends a delegation and asks for terms of peace. So therefore, any one of you who does not renounce all that he has cannot be my disciple.”

Luke 14:12-33 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.14.12-33.ESV>

”Then said he also to him that bade him, When thou makest a dinner or a supper, call not thy friends, nor thy brethren, neither thy kinsmen, nor thy rich neighbours; lest they also bid thee again, and a recompence be made thee. But when thou makest a feast, call the poor, the maimed, the lame, the blind: and thou shalt be blessed (makarios, G3107); for they cannot recompense thee: for thou shalt be recompensed at the resurrection of the just (dikaios, G1342). And when one of them that sat at meat with him heard these things, he said unto him, Blessed (makarios, G3107) is he that shall eat bread in the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God. Then said he unto him, A certain man made a great supper, and bade (kaleō, G2564) many: and sent his servant (apostellō, G649) at supper time to say to them that were bidden, Come; for all things are now ready. And they all with one consent began to make excuse (paraiteomai, G3868). The first said unto him, I have bought a piece of ground, and I must needs go and see it: I pray thee have me excused (paraiteomai, G3868). And another said, I have bought five yoke of oxen, and I go to prove them: I pray thee have me excused (paraiteomai, G3868). And another said, I have married a wife, and therefore I cannot come. So that servant (doulos, G1401) came, and shewed his Lord (kurios, G2962) these things. Then the master of the house being angry said to his servant, Go out quickly into the streets and lanes of the city, and bring in hither the poor, and the maimed, and the halt, and the blind. And the servant said, Lord, it is

done as thou hast commanded, and yet there is room. And the Lord said unto the servant, Go out into the highways and hedges, and compel (anagkazō, G315) them to come in, that my house may be filled. For I say unto you, That none of those men which were bidden (kaleō, G2564) shall taste of my supper. And there went great multitudes with him: and he turned, and said unto them, If any man come to me, and hate (miseō, G3404) not his father, and mother, and wife, and children, and brethren, and sisters, yea, and his own life (psuchē, G5590) also, he cannot be my disciple. And whosoever doth not bear his cross (stauros, G4716), and come after me, cannot be my disciple. For which of you, intending to build (oikodomeō, G3618) a tower, sitteth not down first, and counteth the cost, whether he have sufficient to finish it? Lest haply, after he hath laid the foundation, and is not able to finish it, all that behold it begin to mock him, saying, This man began to build, and was not able to finish. Or what king, going to make war against another king, sitteth not down first, and consulteth whether he be able with ten thousand to meet him that cometh against him with twenty thousand? Or else, while the other is yet a great way off, he sendeth an ambassage, and desireth conditions of peace. So likewise, whosoever he be of you that forsaketh (apotassomai, G657) not all that he hath (huparchonta, G5224), he cannot be my disciple."

Luke 14:12-33 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/luk.14.12-33.KJV>

48. The kingdom of God isn't visible, but rather it's within you. It's His government and rule in your life by the way of your direct connection to God. It's your cooperation with His indwelling Spirit that causes His will to be done on earth as it is in heaven, both inside of you and through your action to bring about good and rightness in the world.

"Being asked by the Pharisees when the kingdom of God would come, he answered them, "The kingdom of God is not coming in ways that can be observed, nor will they say, 'Look, here it is!' or 'There!' for behold, the kingdom of God is in the midst of you."

Luke 17:20-21 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.17.20-21.ESV>

"And when he was demanded of the Pharisees, when the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God should come, he answered them and said, The kingdom (basileia, G932) of God cometh not with observation: neither shall they say, Lo here! or, lo there! for, behold, the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God is within (entos, G1787) you."

Luke 17:20-21 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/luk.17.20-21.KJV>

49. Those with Jesus thought the kingdom of God should immediately appear. Yet, He brought the kingdom, His government, rule, and will, into the world, in ways they did not expect – by saving them and giving them His own Spirit. His servants are to occupy (carry on His business as their occupation) until He comes. Those who are faithful will be given more responsibility and authority in the kingdom. Those who will not submit to Christ's lordship over them will be destroyed.

"As they heard these things, he proceeded to tell a parable, because he was near to Jerusalem, and because they supposed that the kingdom of God was to appear immediately. He said therefore, "A nobleman went into a far country to receive for himself a kingdom and then return. Calling ten of his servants, he gave them ten minas, and said to them, 'Engage in business until I come.' But his citizens hated him and sent a delegation after him, saying, 'We do not want this man to reign over us.' When he returned, having received the kingdom, he ordered these servants to whom he had given the money to be called to him, that he might know what they had gained by doing business. The first came before him, saying, 'Lord, your mina has made ten minas more.' And he said to him, 'Well done, good servant! Because you have been faithful in a very little, you shall have authority over ten cities.' And the second came, saying, 'Lord, your mina has made five minas.' And he said to him, 'And you are to be over five cities.' Then another came, saying, 'Lord, here is your mina, which I kept laid away in a handkerchief; for I was afraid of you, because you are a severe man. You take what you did not deposit, and reap what you did not sow.' He said to him, 'I will condemn you with your own words, you wicked servant! You knew that I was a severe man, taking what I did not deposit and reaping what I did not sow? Why then did you not put my money in the bank, and at my coming I might have collected it with interest?' And he said to those who stood by, 'Take the mina from him, and give it to the one who has the ten minas.' And they said to him, 'Lord, he has ten minas!' 'I tell you that to everyone who has, more will be given, but from the one who has not, even what he has will be taken away. But as for these enemies of mine, who did not want me to reign over them, bring them here and slaughter them before me.'"

Luke 19:11-27 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.19.11-27.ESV>

"And as they heard these things, he added and spake a parable, because he was nigh to Jerusalem, and because they thought that the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God should immediately appear (anaphainō, G398). He said therefore, A certain nobleman went into a far country to receive (lambanō, G2983) for himself a kingdom (basileia, G932), and to return. And he called his ten servants (doulos, G1401), and delivered them ten pounds, and said unto them, Occupy (pragmateuomai, G4231) till I come (erchomai, G2064). But his citizens hated (miseō, G3404) him, and sent a message after him, saying, We will not have this man to reign (basileuō, G936) over us. And it came to pass, that when he was returned, having received (lambanō, G2983) the kingdom (basileia, G932), then he commanded these servants to be called unto him, to whom he had given the money, that he might know how much every man had gained by trading. Then came the first, saying, Lord, thy pound hath gained ten pounds. And he said unto him, Well (eu, G2095), thou good (agathos, G18) servant (doulos, G1401): because thou hast been faithful (pistos, G4103) in a very little, have thou authority (exousia, G1849) over ten cities. And the second came, saying, Lord (kurios, G2962), thy pound hath gained five pounds. And he said likewise to him, Be thou also over five cities. And another came, saying, Lord, behold, here is thy pound, which I have kept laid up in a napkin: for I feared thee, because thou art an austere man: thou takest up that thou layedst not down, and reapest that thou didst not sow. And he saith unto him, Out of thine own mouth (stoma, G4750) will I judge thee, thou wicked (ponēros, G4190) servant. Thou knewest that I was an austere man, taking up that I laid not down, and reaping that I did not sow: wherefore then gavest not thou my money into the bank,

that at my coming I might have required mine own with usury? And he said unto them that stood by, Take from him the pound, and give it to him that hath ten pounds. (And they said unto him, Lord, he hath ten pounds.) For I say unto you, That unto every one which hath shall be given; and from him that hath not, even that he hath shall be taken away from him. But those mine enemies, which would not that I should reign (basileuō, G936) over them, bring hither, and slay them before me.“

Luke 19:11-27 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/luk.19.11-27.KJV>

50. One criminal who hung on a cross beside Jesus, believing Jesus was King, asked Him to be remembered when He came into His kingdom. Jesus said it would happen that day. Those who God allows entrance into His kingdom must take a posture of repentance and genuinely believe in Christ's lordship enough that they would *or they do* live in a way that demonstrates this belief and repentance.

“There was also an inscription over him, “This is the King of the Jews.” One of the criminals who were hanged railed at him, saying, “Are you not the Christ? Save yourself and us!” But the other rebuked him, saying, “Do you not fear God, since you are under the same sentence of condemnation? And we indeed justly, for we are receiving the due reward of our deeds; but this man has done nothing wrong.” And he said, “Jesus, remember me when you come into your kingdom.” And he said to him, “Truly, I say to you, today you will be with me in paradise.”“

Luke 23:38-43 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.23.38-43.ESV>

“And a superscription also was written over him in letters of Greek, and Latin, and Hebrew, THIS IS THE KING (basileus, G935) OF THE JEWS. And one of the malefactors which were hanged railed (blasphēmō, G987) on him, saying, If thou be Christ (Christos, G5547), save (sōzō, G4982) thyself and us. But the other answering rebuked (epitimaō, G2008) him, saying, Dost not thou fear (phobeō, G5399) God, seeing thou art in the same condemnation? And we indeed justly (dikaiōs, G1346); for we receive the due reward of our deeds (prassō, G4238): but this man hath done nothing amiss. And he said unto Jesus, Lord (kurios, G2962), remember me when thou comest into thy kingdom (basileia, G932). And Jesus said unto him, Verily I say unto thee, To day shalt thou be with me in paradise.“

Luke 23:38-43 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/luk.23.38-43.KJV>

John

51. One cannot see nor enter into the kingdom of God unless born again of water and the Spirit. This comes through faith in Jesus Christ and His saving work. It comes through receipt of the new birth in His Spirit. It comes to those who commit themselves to repentance, submitted to Christ's government and rule.
52. Christ, the Son of God, is coming into the world through His kingdom, which is His government and rule. It's where His will is done on earth as it is in heaven. God's will was to raise Lazarus from the dead as a sign that He was with Jesus, confirming His message. When we enter God's kingdom through belief in Jesus Christ, we never die. His Spirit dwelling in us is life.
53. Jesus said that His kingdom is not of this world, but as a King, He came to bear witness to truth. This truth is the reality of the everlasting kingdom of God and the way it operates. In the kingdom, the fight is not against people but against the underlying evil that opposes God's governance and the execution of His good will in the world. The sons and daughters of the Kingdom recognize God's voice in Christ's words and obey it.

51. One cannot see nor enter into the kingdom of God unless born again of water and the Spirit. This comes through faith in Jesus Christ and His saving work. It comes through receipt of the new birth in His Spirit. It comes to those who commit themselves to repentance, submitted to Christ's government and rule.

"Now there was a man of the Pharisees named Nicodemus, a ruler of the Jews. This man came to Jesus by night and said to him, "Rabbi, we know that you are a teacher come from God, for no one can do these signs that you do unless God is with him." Jesus answered him, "Truly, truly, I say to you, unless one is born again he cannot see the kingdom of God." Nicodemus said to him, "How can a man be born when he is old? Can he enter a second time into his mother's womb and be born?" Jesus answered, "Truly, truly, I say to you, unless one is born of water and the Spirit, he cannot enter the kingdom of God. That which is born of the flesh is flesh, and that which is born of the Spirit is spirit."

John 3:1-6 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/jhn.3.1-6.ESV>

"There was a man of the Pharisees, named Nicodemus, a ruler of the Jews: the same came to Jesus by night, and said unto him, Rabbi, we know that thou art a teacher come from God: for no man can do these miracles (sēmeion, G4592) that thou doest, except God be with him. Jesus answered and said unto him, Verily, verily, I say unto thee, Except a man be born (gennaō, G1080) again (anōthen, G509), he cannot see (eidō, G1492) the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God. Nicodemus saith unto him, How can a man be born when he is old? can he enter the second time into his mother's womb, and be born? Jesus answered, Verily, verily, I say unto thee, Except a man be born of water and of the Spirit, he cannot enter into (eiserchomai, G1524) the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God. That which is born of the flesh (sarx, G4561) is flesh; and that which is born of the Spirit is spirit."

John 3:1-6 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/jhn.3.1-6.KJV>

52. Christ, the Son of God, is coming into the world through His kingdom, which is His government and rule. It's where His will is done on earth as it is in heaven. God's will was to raise Lazarus from the dead as a sign that He was with Jesus, confirming His message. When we enter God's kingdom through belief in Jesus Christ, we never die. His Spirit dwelling in us is life.

"Martha said to Jesus, "Lord, if you had been here, my brother would not have died. But even now I know that whatever you ask from God, God will give you." Jesus said to her, "Your brother will rise again." Martha said to him, "I know that he will rise again in the resurrection on the last day." Jesus said to her, "I am the resurrection and the life. Whoever believes in me, though he die, yet shall he live, and everyone who lives and believes in me shall never die. Do you believe this?" She said to him, "Yes, Lord; I believe that you are the Christ, the Son of God, who is coming into the world."

John 11:21-27 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/jhn.11.21-27.ESV>

"Then said Martha unto Jesus, Lord (kurios, G2962), if thou hadst been here, my brother had not died. But I know, that even now, whatsoever thou wilt ask (aiteō, G154) of God, God will give it thee. Jesus saith unto her, Thy brother shall rise again. Martha saith unto him, I know that he shall rise again in the resurrection at the last day. Jesus said unto her, I am the resurrection (anastasis, G386), and the life (zōē, G2222): he that believeth (pisteuō, G4100) in me, though he were dead, yet shall he live (zaō, G2198): and whosoever liveth (zaō, G2198) and believeth (pisteuō, G4100) in me shall never die. Believest thou (pisteuō, G4100) this? She saith unto him, Yea, Lord (kurios, G2962): I believe (pisteuō, G4100) that thou art the Christ (Christos, G5547), the Son of God, which should come (erchomai, G2064) into the world (kosmos, G2889)."

John 11:21-27 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/jhn.11.21-27.KJV>

53. Jesus said that His kingdom is not of this world, but as a King, He came to bear witness to truth. This truth is the reality of the everlasting kingdom of God and the way it operates. In the kingdom, the fight is not against people but against the underlying evil that opposes God's governance and the execution of His good will in the world. The sons and daughters of the Kingdom recognize God's voice in Christ's words and obey it.

"So Pilate entered his headquarters again and called Jesus and said to him, "Are you the King of the Jews?" Jesus answered, "Do you say this of your own accord, or did others say it to you about me?" Pilate answered, "Am I a Jew? Your own nation and the chief priests have delivered you over to me. What have you done?" Jesus answered, "My kingdom is not of this world. If my kingdom were of this world, my servants would have been fighting, that I might not be delivered over to the Jews. But my kingdom is not from the world." Then Pilate said to him, "So you are a king?" Jesus answered, "You say that I am a king. For this purpose I was born and for this

purpose I have come into the world—to bear witness to the truth. Everyone who is of the truth listens to my voice.”“

John 18:33-37 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/jhn.18.33-37.ESV>

”Then Pilate entered into the judgment hall again, and called Jesus, and said unto him, Art thou the King (basileus, G935) of the Jews? Jesus answered him, Sayest thou this thing of thyself, or did others tell it thee of me? Pilate answered, Am I a Jew? Thine own nation and the chief priests have delivered thee unto me: what hast thou done? Jesus answered, My kingdom (basileia, G932) is not of this world (kosmos, G2889): if my kingdom (basileia, G932) were of this world (kosmos, G2889), then would my servants (hupēretēs, G5257) fight (agōnizomai, G75), that I should not be delivered to the Jews: but now is my kingdom (basileia, G932) not from hence. Pilate therefore said unto him, Art thou a king (basileus, G935) then? Jesus answered, Thou sayest that I am a king (basileus, G935). To this end was I born (gennaō, G1080), and for this cause came I into the world (kosmos, G2889), that I should bear witness (martureō, G3140) unto the truth (alētheia, G225). Every one that is of the truth (alētheia, G225) heareth (akouō, G191) my voice.“

John 18:33-37 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/jhn.18.33-37.KJV>

Acts

54. Jesus spoke to His apostles of things pertaining to the kingdom of God after His resurrection, and He told them to stay in Jerusalem to wait for the promise of the Father, the baptism and the overtaking of them by the Holy Spirit with power that would confirm their preaching of the gospel of the kingdom to all nations.
55. Philip preached the gospel of the kingdom in Samaria, which included confirming signs and great miracles done in Jesus' name, and baptized new believers in Jesus' name. Peter and John came and laid hands on them, praying for them to receive the Holy Spirit, and they did.
56. Disciples can expect tribulation as they enter into the kingdom of God. This tribulation comes from Satan's influence on the will of others that oppose God's purposes in the world, so they also oppose those aligned with God's will. The Apostle Paul was stoned to death, raised from the dead, and healed at Lystra, then went right back to ministry in Lystra and the nearby areas, focused on kingdom work. We are to be single-minded in the purpose of God as well.
57. Paul spoke boldly, disputing and persuading, about all things concerning the kingdom of God for over two years in Ephesus, after baptizing believers in the name of Jesus and laying hands on some of them so the Holy Spirit came on them. He did extraordinary miracles while there, where even the life that went into cloths taken from near his skin set people free from the oppression of sickness. The miraculous, showing His kingdom is at hand, is meant to catalyze the making and growing up of disciples of Christ, as Paul did at Ephesus, as God's family is dear to Him.
58. Paul boldly testified to the kingdom of God for two years in Rome, trying to convince them about the truth of Jesus, welcoming all who came. This is an example of what it looks like to have God's Spirit governing and ruling all of your life, such that His will is done to make things right on earth for those willing to hear and attend to God's word.

54. Jesus spoke to His apostles of things pertaining to the kingdom of God after His resurrection, and He told them to stay in Jerusalem to wait for the promise of the Father, the baptism and the overtaking of them by the Holy Spirit with power that would confirm their preaching of the gospel of the kingdom to all nations.

"In the first book, O Theophilus, I have dealt with all that Jesus began to do and teach, until the day when he was taken up, after he had given commands through the Holy Spirit to the apostles whom he had chosen. He presented himself alive to them after his suffering by many proofs, appearing to them during forty days and speaking about the kingdom of God. And while staying with them he ordered them not to depart from Jerusalem, but to wait for the promise of the Father, which, he said, "you heard from me; for John baptized with water, but you will be baptized with the Holy Spirit not many days from now." So when they had come together, they asked him, "Lord, will you at this time restore the kingdom to Israel?" He said to them, "It is not for you to know times or seasons that the Father has fixed by his own authority. But you will receive power when the Holy Spirit has come upon you, and you will be my witnesses in Jerusalem and in all Judea and Samaria, and to the end of the earth.""

Acts 1:1-8 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/act.1.1-8.ESV>

"The former treatise have I made, O Theophilus, of all that Jesus began both to do (poieō, G4160) and teach, until the day in which he was taken up, after that he through the Holy (hagios, G40) Ghost had given commandments (entellomai, G1781) unto the apostles (apostolos, G652) whom he had chosen: to whom also he shewed himself alive (zaō, G2198) after his passion (paschō, G3958) by many infallible proofs (tekmērion, G5039), being seen of them forty days, and speaking of the things pertaining to the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God: and, being assembled together with them, commanded (paraggellō, G3853) them that they should not depart from Jerusalem, but wait for (perimenō, G4037) the promise (epaggelia, G1860) of the Father, which, saith he, ye have heard of me. For John truly baptized with water; but ye shall be baptized (baptizō, G907) with the Holy (hagios, G40) Ghost not many days hence. When they therefore were come together, they asked of him, saying, Lord (kurios, G2962), wilt thou at this time restore again (apokathistēmi, G600) the kingdom (basileia, G932) to Israel? And he said unto them, It is not for you to know the times or the seasons (kairos, G2540), which the Father hath put in his own power (exousia, G1849). But ye shall receive (lambanō, G2983) power (dunamis, G1411), after that the Holy (hagios, G40) Ghost is come upon (eperchomai, G1904) you: and ye shall be witnesses (martus, G3144) unto me both in Jerusalem, and in all Judæa, and in Samaria, and unto the uttermost part (eschatos, G2078) of the earth."

Acts 1:1-8 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/act.1.1-8.KJV>

55. Philip preached the gospel of the kingdom in Samaria, which included confirming signs and great miracles done in Jesus' name, and baptized new believers in Jesus' name. Peter and John came and laid hands on them, praying for them to receive the Holy Spirit, and they did.

"But when they believed Philip as he preached good news about the kingdom of God and the name of Jesus Christ, they were baptized, both men and women. Even Simon himself believed, and after being baptized he continued with Philip. And seeing signs and great miracles performed, he was amazed. Now when the apostles at Jerusalem heard that Samaria had received the word of God, they sent to them Peter and John, who came down and prayed for them that they might receive the Holy Spirit, for he had not yet fallen on any of them, but they had only been baptized in the name of the Lord Jesus. Then they laid their hands on them and they received the Holy Spirit."

Acts 8:12-17 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/act.8.12-17.ESV>

"But when they believed Philip preaching (euaggelizō, G2097) the things concerning the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God, and the name (onoma, G3686) of Jesus Iēsous, G2424) Christ (Christos, G5547), they were baptized, both men and women. Then Simon himself believed also: and when he was baptized, he continued with Philip, and wondered (existēmi, G1839), beholding the miracles (dunamis, G1411) and signs (megas sēmeion, G4592+G3173)

which were done. Now when the apostles (apostolos, G652) which were at Jerusalem heard that Samaria had received (dechomai, G1209) the word (logos, G3056) of God, they sent unto them Peter and John: who, when they were come down, prayed for them, that they might receive (lambanō, G2983) the Holy (hagios, G40) Ghost: (for as yet he was fallen (epiptō, G1968) upon none of them: only they were baptized in the name of the Lord Jesus.) Then laid they their hands (cheir, G5495) on them, and they received the Holy Ghost.“

Acts 8:12-17 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/act.8.12-17.KJV>

56. Disciples can expect tribulation as they enter into the kingdom of God. This tribulation comes from Satan's influence on the will of others that oppose God's purposes in the world, so they also oppose those aligned with God's will. The Apostle Paul was stoned to death, raised from the dead, and healed at Lystra, then went right back to ministry in Lystra and the nearby areas, focused on kingdom work. We are to be single-minded in the purpose of God as well.

”But Jews came from Antioch and Iconium, and having persuaded the crowds, they stoned Paul and dragged him out of the city, supposing that he was dead. But when the disciples gathered about him, he rose up and entered the city, and on the next day he went on with Barnabas to Derbe. When they had preached the gospel to that city and had made many disciples, they returned to Lystra and to Iconium and to Antioch, strengthening the souls of the disciples, encouraging them to continue in the faith, and saying that through many tribulations we must enter the kingdom of God.“

Acts 14:19-22 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/act.14.19-22.ESV>

”And there came thither certain Jews from Antioch and Iconium, who persuaded the people, and, having stoned Paul, drew him out of the city, supposing he had been dead. Howbeit, as the disciples stood round about (kuklō, G2944) him, he rose up, and came into the city: and the next day he departed with Barnabas to Derbe. And when they had preached the gospel (euangelizō, G2097) to that city, and had taught (mathēteuō, G3100) many, they returned again to Lystra, and to Iconium, and Antioch, confirming (epistērizō, G1991) the souls (psuchē, G5590) of the disciples, and exhorting (parakaleō, G3870) them to continue (emmenō, G1696) in the faith (pistis, G4102), and that we must through much tribulation (thlipsis, G2347) enter into (eiserchomai, G1535) the kingdom (basileia, G1525) of God.“

Acts 14:19-22 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/act.14.19-22.KJV>

57. Paul spoke boldly, disputing and persuading, about all things concerning the kingdom of God for over two years in Ephesus, after baptizing believers in the name of Jesus and laying hands on some of them so the Holy Spirit came on them. He did extraordinary miracles while there, where even the life that went into cloths taken from near his skin set people free from the oppression of sickness. The miraculous, showing His kingdom is at hand, is meant to catalyze the making and growing up of disciples of Christ, as Paul did at Ephesus, as God's family is dear to Him.

"And it happened that while Apollos was at Corinth, Paul passed through the inland country and came to Ephesus. There he found some disciples. And he said to them, "Did you receive the Holy Spirit when you believed?" And they said, "No, we have not even heard that there is a Holy Spirit." And he said, "Into what then were you baptized?" They said, "Into John's baptism." And Paul said, "John baptized with the baptism of repentance, telling the people to believe in the one who was to come after him, that is, Jesus." On hearing this, they were baptized in the name of the Lord Jesus. And when Paul had laid his hands on them, the Holy Spirit came on them, and they began speaking in tongues and prophesying. There were about twelve men in all. And he entered the synagogue and for three months spoke boldly, reasoning and persuading them about the kingdom of God. But when some became stubborn and continued in unbelief, speaking evil of the Way before the congregation, he withdrew from them and took the disciples with him, reasoning daily in the hall of Tyrannus. This continued for two years, so that all the residents of Asia heard the word of the Lord, both Jews and Greeks. And God was doing extraordinary miracles by the hands of Paul, so that even handkerchiefs or aprons that had touched his skin were carried away to the sick, and their diseases left them and the evil spirits came out of them."

Acts 19:1-12 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/act.19.1-12.ESV>

"And it came to pass, that, while Apollos was at Corinth, Paul having passed through the upper coasts came to Ephesus: and finding certain disciples, he said unto them, Have ye received (Iambanō, G2983) the Holy (hagios, G40) Ghost since ye believed (pisteuō, G4100)? And they said unto him, We have not so much as heard whether there be any Holy Ghost. And he said unto them, Unto what then were ye baptized? And they said, Unto John's baptism. Then said Paul, John verily baptized with the baptism of repentance (metanoia, G3341), saying unto the people, that they should believe on him which should come after him, that is, on Christ (Christos, G5547) Jesus (Iēsous, G2424) When they heard this, they were baptized in the name (onoma, G3686) of the Lord (kurios, G2962) Jesus. And when Paul had laid his hands (cheir, G5495) upon them, the Holy Ghost came (erchomai, G2064) on them; and they spake with tongues, and prophesied (prophēteuō, G4395). And all the men were about twelve. And he went into the synagogue, and spake boldly (parrhēsiazomai, G3955) for the space of three months, disputing (dialegomai, G1256) and persuading (peithō, G3982) the things concerning the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God. But when divers were hardened, and believed not, but spake evil of that way (hodos, G3598) before the multitude, he departed from them, and separated the disciples, disputing daily in the school of one Tyrannus. And this continued by the space of two years; so that all they which dwelt in Asia heard the word of the Lord Jesus, both Jews and Greeks. And God wrought (poieō, G4160) special miracles (dunamis, G1411) by the hands (cheir, G5495) of Paul: so that from his body (chrōs, G5559) were brought unto the sick (astheneō, G770) handkerchiefs (soudarion, G4676) or aprons (simikinthion, G4612), and the diseases (nosos, G3554) departed (apallassō, G525) from them, and the evil (ponēros, G4190) spirits went out (exerchomai, G1831) of them."

Acts 19:1-12 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/act.19.1-12.KJV>

"And now, behold, I know that none of you among whom I have gone about proclaiming the kingdom will see my face again. Therefore I testify to you this day that I am innocent of the blood of all, for I did not shrink from declaring to you the whole counsel of God. Pay careful attention to yourselves and to all the flock, in which the Holy Spirit has made you overseers, to care for the church of God, which he obtained with his own blood."

Acts 20:25-28 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/act.20.25-28.ESV>

"And now, behold, I know that ye all, among whom I have gone preaching (kēussō, G2784) the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God, shall see my face no more. Wherefore I take you to record this day, that I am pure from the blood of all men. For I have not shunned to declare (anaggellō, G312) unto you all the counsel (boulē, G1012) of God. Take heed (prosechō, G4337) therefore unto yourselves, and to all the flock, over the which the Holy Ghost hath made you overseers, to feed (poimainō, G4165) the church (ekklēsia, G1577) of God, which he hath purchased (peripoieomai, G4046) with his own blood."

Acts 20:25-28 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/act.20.25-28.KJV>

58. Paul boldly testified to the kingdom of God for two years in Rome, trying to convince them about the truth of Jesus, welcoming all who came. This is an example of what it looks like to have God's Spirit governing and ruling all of your life, such that His will is done to make things right on earth for those willing to hear and attend to God's word.

"When they had appointed a day for him, they came to him at his lodging in greater numbers. From morning till evening he expounded to them, testifying to the kingdom of God and trying to convince them about Jesus both from the Law of Moses and from the Prophets... He lived there two whole years at his own expense, and welcomed all who came to him, proclaiming the kingdom of God and teaching about the Lord Jesus Christ with all boldness and without hindrance."

Acts 28:23, 30-31 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/act.28.23-31.ESV>

"And when they had appointed him a day, there came many to him into his lodging; to whom he expounded (ektithēmi, G1620) and testified (diamarturomai, G1263) the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God, persuading (peithō, G932) them concerning Jesus, both out of the law of Moses, and out of the prophets, from morning till evening... And Paul dwelt two whole years in his own hired house, and received all that came in unto him, preaching (kēussō, G2784) the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God, and teaching those things which concern the Lord (kurios, G2962) Jesus Christ, with all confidence (parrhēsia, G3954), no man forbidding (akōlutōs, G209) him."

Acts 28:23, 30-31 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/act.28.23-31.KJV>

Epistles

59. The life and rule of the Holy Spirit in a person and in a community is characterized by rightness, peace and joy. The kingdom of God brings heaven to earth.
60. The life and rule of the Holy Spirit in a person (and in a community) is characterized not by proud talk but by the humble love of God that acts with power to demonstrate the nearness of the kingdom of God.
61. The unrighteous, who bear bad fruit as a lifestyle, shall not inherit the kingdom of God, neither in this life nor in the one to come. The kingdom is for those made righteous in Christ who, having died to their old life, keep themselves right as a lifestyle; those joined to the Lord as one spirit; those who are known by the fruit of the Spirit; those who are led by the Spirit to be doers of God's word. Fruit has to do both with one's character and associated thinking that proceeds to one's speech and actions.
62. Jesus's current reign will put down all the rule, authority and power of enemies under His feet, death included, then deliver the kingdom (with all associated rule, authority and power) to the Father, that the Father may be all in all.
63. We will bear the image of the heavenly, putting on incorruption and immortality, when we inherit God's kingdom. For now, we are to be steadfast and abound in the work of the Lord.
64. Those who follow Jesus Christ have been delivered from the domain, authority and power of darkness. They have been translated into the kingdom (rule and government) of the benevolent, beloved Son of God, wherein they have been made saints of light and partakers of the inheritance of the Son. This inheritance includes the nature and character of the Spirit of God that enables them to know God's will, walk as Christ walked, and continue His ministry of overcoming the darkness.
65. Obedient followers of Jesus Christ are our fellow workers in God's kingdom's work. They are to be thought of, prayed for, and treated as beloved brothers and sisters. In this life, we are to come alongside God's co-workers to help them to stand mature and complete in all the will of God.
66. We should walk in a manner worthy of God who called us unto His kingdom and glory. We are to live righteously and proclaim the gospel.
67. We can expect to suffer persecution for the sake of God's kingdom due to the opposition we will experience from those aligned with the realm of darkness. Jesus said that those who are persecuted for righteousness' sake are blessed, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven.
68. Since Jesus Christ shall judge the living and the dead at His appearing and His kingdom, be ready and get others ready for kingdom citizenship by way of the indwelling word and Spirit.
69. The Lord, standing with Paul as he did God's word, delivered him every evil work, working out salvation in and for him unto the heavenly kingdom. We can expect this strengthening, delivering, and salvation too so long as we are willing to serve Him with our lives.
70. One of the main characteristics of God's kingdom is righteousness. The Lord Jesus Christ is the righteousness of God; He is elevated as high priest above all else in God's

kingdom; and He has canceled Satan's dominion over death, comprising all the miseries of sin. Everything in heaven, on earth and under the earth will be put in submission to Him. The salvation given to His kingdom citizens is great, and God joins together with its citizens to bear witness to it, by way of miracles including healing and deliverance, and by way of gifts of His Spirit, or the sharing of His own supernatural nature, including gifts of revelation, power and inspiration. Further, God holds His kingdom citizens in such honor that He has put us in dominion over all the works of His hands. We have great authority and responsibility.

71. The eternal kingdom of God cannot be moved, unlike other things that have been made, including those which cause distraction and agitation, which will pass away. We are joined to that eternal kingdom when we receive it as intended, and in it we serve and please God with reverence and godly fear, for He is worthy of utmost respect.
72. God has chosen many who are poor and those without position in worldly affairs to be abounding in faithfulness to God and heirs of the kingdom, which is for those who love Him on His terms. One cannot pursue both God and the world. The choice to follow Christ requires everything of us.
73. Christlike character and nature that manifest themselves in action make one's calling, election, and entrance into the kingdom sure, for His divine power has given those who are His all things that pertain to life and godliness.
74. Jesus Christ has made us kings and priests unto God in His kingdom. Priests are servants to all men on behalf of God. As kings, we will be given some measure of responsibility and authority in His kingdom as a reward for our faithfulness to God, His word, and His kingdom work. As priests and kings, we are subject to the great high priest and the King of kings, our Lord Jesus Christ.
75. At the judgment, the kingdoms of this world will become the kingdoms of our Lord, He will take back all power, and he shall reign forever. He will reward the faithful and destroy the unfaithful.
76. Satan's schemes include deception and accusation. He speaks out of his own character as the father of lies. Satan takes every possible advantage of God's legal system. Satan also deceives in order to take any advantage possible to defame God or to lead people willingly away from the narrow path of following Christ. In Christ's victory at the cross, Satan and his angels were defeated and cast out of heaven to earth. They have no authority anymore over those who belong to Christ. Christ's victory at the cross was Satan's defeat, bringing salvation, strength, the kingdom (rule, dominion, government) of God, and the power of Christ. In Christ, the kingdom of God is now at hand. Christ came to destroy the works of the devil. Christ is now Lord over everything that has a name in heaven, on earth and under the earth; all authority is His. Christ's followers overcome Satan by the blood of the Lamb, for His blood has set them free from the law of sin and death, including sin and all of its miseries. Christ's followers overcome Satan by their direct connection to God in Christ and by their faith. Christ's followers overcome Satan and his works by the word of their testimony, for the words spoken in faith by God's children are powerful. In Christ, they have been given dominion on earth by way of their words spoken in faith; the gates of hell shall not prevail against them. Further, Christ's followers gain victory by dying to themselves to live for Christ and the accomplishment of

all of God's will; there will be victory in this. They often give their lives throughout the world as martyrs as well. Nevertheless, Satan and devils still have ability on earth until the time of the judgment. His realm expresses wrath all of the time toward God's image bearers (all of mankind), seeking ways to steal (because they have no authority), kill and destroy. His realm persecutes obedient Christ followers, i.e., those who obey God's word and openly testify to the finished work of Jesus Christ. They persecute by working through the will of men and women under their influence, the children of disobedience who carry out Satan's desires. Those who have put Christ's words into practice (i.e., disciples) are the ones that actively threaten Satan's realm and its ability to steal, kill, and destroy.

77. God will judge all men according to their works, as recorded by Him. Those who belong to God have their names written in the book of life. The others will be cast into a lake of fire. Death will also be destroyed.

78. The eternal kingdom for the body of Christ, the righteous whose names are written in the Lamb's book of life, is the new heaven and earth, having the new Jerusalem within it. His people will be with God there, and all corruption of the good creation in the present world that was brought about by the law of sin and death will be gone. The nearness of His kingdom makes things now on earth as they are to be in heaven, for He freely gives of the fountain of the water of life.

59. The life and rule of the Holy Spirit in a person and in a community is characterized by rightness, peace and joy. The kingdom of God brings heaven to earth.

"Therefore let us not pass judgment on one another any longer, but rather decide never to put a stumbling block or hindrance in the way of a brother. I know and am persuaded in the Lord Jesus that nothing is unclean in itself, but it is unclean for anyone who thinks it unclean. For if your brother is grieved by what you eat, you are no longer walking in love. By what you eat, do not destroy the one for whom Christ died. So do not let what you regard as good be spoken of as evil. For the kingdom of God is not a matter of eating and drinking but of righteousness and peace and joy in the Holy Spirit. Whoever thus serves Christ is acceptable to God and approved by men. So then let us pursue what makes for peace and for mutual upbuilding."

Romans 14:13-19 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/rom.14.13-19.ESV>

"Let us not therefore judge one another any more: but judge this rather, that no man put a stumblingblock or an occasion to fall in his brother's way. I know, and am persuaded by the Lord Jesus, that there is nothing unclean of itself: but to him that esteemeth any thing to be unclean, to him it is unclean. But if thy brother be grieved with thy meat, now walkest thou not charitably. Destroy not him with thy meat, for whom Christ died. Let not then your good be evil spoken of: for the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God is not meat and drink; but righteousness (dikaiosunē, G1343), and peace (eirēnē, G1515), and joy (chara, G5479) in the Holy (hagios, G40) Ghost. For he that in these things serveth (douleō, G1398) Christ is acceptable (euarestos, G2101) to God, and approved of men. Let us therefore follow after (diōkō, G1377) the things which make for peace (eirēnē, G1515), and things wherewith one may edify (oikodomē, G3619) another."

Romans 14:13-19 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/rom.14.13-19.KJV>

60. The life and rule of the Holy Spirit in a person (and in a community) is characterized not by proud talk but by the humble love of God that acts with power to demonstrate the nearness of the kingdom of God.

"I urge you, then, be imitators of me. That is why I sent you Timothy, my beloved and faithful child in the Lord, to remind you of my ways in Christ, as I teach them everywhere in every church. Some are arrogant, as though I were not coming to you. But I will come to you soon, if the Lord wills, and I will find out not the talk of these arrogant people but their power. For the kingdom of God does not consist in talk but in power. What do you wish? Shall I come to you with a rod, or with love in a spirit of gentleness?"

1 Corinthians 4:16-21 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/1co.4.16-21.ESV>

"Wherefore I beseech (parakaleō, G3670) you, be ye followers (mimētēs, G3402) of me. For this cause have I sent unto you Timotheus, who is my beloved (agapētos, G27) son, and faithful (pistos, G4103) in the Lord (kurios, G2962), who shall bring you into remembrance of my ways (hodos, G3598) which be in Christ (Christos, G5547), as I teach every where in every church. Now some are puffed up, as though I would not come to you. But I will come to you shortly, if the Lord will (thelō, G2309), and will know, not the speech of them which are puffed up, but the power (dunamis, G1411). For the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God is not in word (logos, G3056), but in power (dunamis, G1411). What will ye? shall I come unto you with a rod (rhabdos, G4464), or in love (agapē, G26), and in the spirit of meekness (praotēs, G4236)?"

1 Corinthians 4:16-21 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/1co.4.16-21.KJV>

61. The unrighteous, who bear bad fruit as a lifestyle, shall not inherit the kingdom of God, neither in this life nor in the one to come. The kingdom is for those made righteous in Christ who, having died to their old life, keep themselves right as a lifestyle; those joined to the Lord as one spirit; those who are known by the fruit of the Spirit; those who are led by the Spirit to be doers of God's word. Fruit has to do both with one's character and associated thinking that proceeds to one's speech and actions.

"Or do you not know that the unrighteous will not inherit the kingdom of God? Do not be deceived: neither the sexually immoral, nor idolaters, nor adulterers, nor men who practice homosexuality, nor thieves, nor the greedy, nor drunkards, nor revilers, nor swindlers will inherit the kingdom of God. And such were some of you. But you were washed, you were sanctified, you were justified in the name of the Lord Jesus Christ and by the Spirit of our God. "All things are lawful for me," but not all things are helpful. "All things are lawful for me," but I will not be dominated by anything. "Food is meant for the stomach and the stomach for food"—and God will destroy both one and the other. The body is not meant for sexual immorality, but for the Lord, and the Lord for the body. And God raised the Lord and will also raise us up by his power.

Do you not know that your bodies are members of Christ? Shall I then take the members of Christ and make them members of a prostitute? Never! Or do you not know that he who is joined to a prostitute becomes one body with her? For, as it is written, "The two will become one flesh." But he who is joined to the Lord becomes one spirit with him. Flee from sexual immorality. Every other sin a person commits is outside the body, but the sexually immoral person sins against his own body. Or do you not know that your body is a temple of the Holy Spirit within you, whom you have from God? You are not your own, for you were bought with a price. So glorify God in your body."

1 Corinthians 6:9-20 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/1co.6.9-20.ESV>

"Know ye not that the unrighteous (adikos, G94) shall not inherit (klēronomeō, G2816) the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God? Be not deceived: neither fornicators (pornos, G4205), nor idolaters, nor adulterers (moichos, G3432), nor effeminate (malakos, G3120), nor abusers of themselves with mankind (arsenokoitēs, G733), nor thieves, nor covetous, nor drunkards, nor revilers, nor extortioners, shall inherit the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God. And such were some of you: but ye are washed (apolouō, G628), but ye are sanctified (hagiazō, G37), but ye are justified (dikaioō, G1344) in the name (onoma, G1344) of the Lord (kurios, G2962) Jesus (Iēsous, G2424), and by the Spirit of our God. All things are lawful unto me, but all things are not expedient: all things are lawful for me, but I will not be brought under the power (exousiazō, G1850) of any. Meats for the belly, and the belly for meats: but God shall destroy both it and them. Now the body is not for fornication (porneia, G4202), but for the Lord (kurios, G2962); and the Lord for the body. And God hath both raised up the Lord, and will also raise up us by his own power (dunamis, G1411). Know ye not that your bodies are the members (melos, G3196) of Christ (Christos, G5547)? shall I then take the members of Christ, and make them the members of an harlot (pornē, G4204)? God forbid. What? know ye not that he which is joined (kollaō, G2853) to an harlot is one body? for two, saith he, shall be one flesh. But he that is joined (kollaō, G2853) unto the Lord (kurios, G2962) is one spirit. Flee (pheugō, G5343) fornication (porneia, G4202). Every sin that a man doeth (poieō, G4160) is without the body; but he that committeth fornication (porneuō, G4203) sinneth against his own body. What? know ye not that your body is the temple (naos, G3485) of the Holy (hagios, G40) Ghost which is in you, which ye have (echō, G2192) of God, and ye are not your own? For ye are bought with a price: therefore glorify (doxazō, G1392) God in your body, and in your spirit, which are God's."

1 Corinthians 6:9-20 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/1co.6.9-20.KJV>

"But I say, walk by the Spirit, and you will not gratify the desires of the flesh. For the desires of the flesh are against the Spirit, and the desires of the Spirit are against the flesh, for these are opposed to each other, to keep you from doing the things you want to do. But if you are led by the Spirit, you are not under the law. Now the works of the flesh are evident: sexual immorality, impurity, sensuality, idolatry, sorcery, enmity, strife, jealousy, fits of anger, rivalries, dissensions, divisions, envy, drunkenness, orgies, and things like these. I warn you, as I warned you before, that those who do such things will not inherit the kingdom of God. But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, self-control; against

such things there is no law. And those who belong to Christ Jesus have crucified the flesh with its passions and desires. If we live by the Spirit, let us also keep in step with the Spirit. Let us not become conceited, provoking one another, envying one another.“

Galatians 5:16-26 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/gal.5.16-26.ESV>

”This I say then, Walk (peripateō, G4043) in the Spirit, and ye shall not fulfil (teleō, G5055) the lust (epithumia, G1939) of the flesh (sarx, G4561). For the flesh lusteth against the Spirit, and the Spirit against the flesh: and these are contrary the one to the other: so that ye cannot do the things that ye would (thelō, G2309). But if ye be led (agō, G71) of the Spirit, ye are not under the law. Now the works (ergon, G2041) of the flesh are manifest, which are these; Adultery, fornication (porneia, G4202), uncleanness, lasciviousness, idolatry, witchcraft (pharmakeia, G5331), hatred (echthra, G2189), variance (eris, G2054), emulations (zēlos, G2205), wrath, strife (eritheia, G2052), seditions (dichostasia, G1370), heresies (hairesis, G139), envyings, murders, drunkenness, revellings (kōmos, G2970), and such like: of the which I tell you before, as I have also told you in time past, that they which do (prassō, G4238) such things shall not inherit (klēronomeō, G2816) the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God. But the fruit (karpos, G2590) of the Spirit is love (agapē, G26), joy, peace (eirēnē, G1515), longsuffering (makrothumia, G3115), gentleness (chrēstotēs, G5544), goodness (ahathōsunē, G19), faith (pistis, G4102), meekness (praotēs, G4236), temperance (egkrateia, G1466): against such there is no law. And they that are Christ's (Christos, G5547) have crucified (stauroō, G4717) the flesh (sarx, G4561) with the affections (pathēma, G3804) and lusts (epithumia, G1939). If we live (zaō, G2198) in the Spirit, let us also walk (stoicheō, G4748) in the Spirit. Let us not be desirous of vain glory (kenodoxos, G2755), provoking (prokaleomai, G4292) one another, envying one another.“

Galatians 5:16-26 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/gal.5.16-26.KJV>

”Therefore be imitators of God, as beloved children. And walk in love, as Christ loved us and gave himself up for us, a fragrant offering and sacrifice to God. But sexual immorality and all impurity or covetousness must not even be named among you, as is proper among saints. Let there be no filthiness nor foolish talk nor crude joking, which are out of place, but instead let there be thanksgiving. For you may be sure of this, that everyone who is sexually immoral or impure, or who is covetous (that is, an idolater), has no inheritance in the kingdom of Christ and God. Let no one deceive you with empty words, for because of these things the wrath of God comes upon the sons of disobedience. Therefore do not become partners with them; for at one time you were darkness, but now you are light in the Lord. Walk as children of light (for the fruit of light is found in all that is good and right and true), and try to discern what is pleasing to the Lord. Take no part in the unfruitful works of darkness, but instead expose them. For it is shameful even to speak of the things that they do in secret. But when anything is exposed by the light, it becomes visible, for anything that becomes visible is light. Therefore it says, “Awake, O sleeper, and arise from the dead, and Christ will shine on you.” Look carefully then how you walk, not as unwise but as wise, making the best use of the time, because the days are evil. Therefore do not be foolish, but understand what the will of the Lord is. And do not get drunk with wine, for that is debauchery, but be filled with the Spirit, addressing one another in psalms

and hymns and spiritual songs, singing and making melody to the Lord with your heart, giving thanks always and for everything to God the Father in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ, submitting to one another out of reverence for Christ.”

Ephesians 5:1-21 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/eph.5.1-21.ESV>

”Be ye therefore followers (mimētēs, G3402) of God, as dear (agapētos, G27) children; and walk (peripateō, G4043) in love, as Christ (Christos, G5547) also hath loved (agapaō, G25) us, and hath given himself for us an offering (prosphora, G4376) and a sacrifice to God for a sweetsmelling (euōdia, G2175) savour. But fornication (porneia, G4202), and all uncleanness, or covetousness, let it not be once named among you, as becometh saints (hagios, G40); neither filthiness, nor foolish talking (mōrologia, G3473), nor jesting (eutrapelia, G2160), which are not convenient: but rather giving of thanks (eucharistia, G2169). For this ye know, that no whoremonger (pornos, G4205), nor unclean person (akathartos, G169), nor covetous man, who is an idolater, hath any inheritance (klēronomia, G2817) in the kingdom (basileia, G932) of Christ (Christos, G5547) and of God. Let no man deceive you with vain words: for because of these things cometh the wrath (orgē, G3709) of God upon the children of disobedience (apeitheia, G543). Be not ye therefore partakers (summetochos, G4830) with them. For ye were sometimes darkness (skotos, G4655), but now are ye light (phōs, G5457) in the Lord (kurios, G2962): walk (peripateō, G4043) as children of light (phōs, G5457): (for the fruit (karpos, G2590) of the Spirit is in all goodness (agathōsunē, G19) and righteousness (dikaiosunē, G1343) and truth (alētheia, G225);) proving (dokimazō, G1381) what is acceptable (euairestos, G2101) unto the Lord. And have no fellowship (sugkoinōneō, G4790) with the unfruitful (akarpōs, G175) works (ergon, G2041) of darkness (skotos, G4655), but rather reprove (elegchō, G1651) them. For it is a shame even to speak of those things which are done of them in secret. But all things that are reprov’d (elegchō, G1651) are made manifest (phaneroō, G5319) by the light (phōs, G5457): for whatsoever doth make manifest (phaneroō, G5319) is light (phōs, G5457). Wherefore he saith, Awake thou that sleepest (katheudō, G2518), and arise from the dead (nekros, G3498), and Christ (Christos, G5547) shall give thee light (epiphauō, G2017). See then that ye walk (peripateō, G4043) circumspectly (akribōs, G199), not as fools, but as wise (sophos, G4680), redeeming (exagorazō, G1805) the time (kairos, G2540), because the days are evil (ponēros, G4190). Wherefore be ye not unwise, but understanding (suniēmī, G4920) what the will (thelēma, G2307) of the Lord (kurios, G2962) is. And be not drunk with wine, wherein is excess (asōtia, G810); but be filled (plēroō, G4137) with the Spirit; speaking to yourselves in psalms and hymns and spiritual songs, singing and making melody in your heart to the Lord; giving thanks (eucharisteō, G2168) always for all things unto God and the Father in the name (onoma, G3686) of our Lord Jesus Christ; submitting yourselves (hupotassō, G5293) one to another in the fear (phobos, G5401) of God.”

Ephesians 5:1-21 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/eph.5.1-21.KJV>

62. Jesus’s current reign will put down all the rule, authority and power of enemies under His feet, death included, then deliver the kingdom (with all associated rule, authority and power) to the Father, that the Father may be all in all.

"Then comes the end, when he delivers the kingdom to God the Father after destroying every rule and every authority and power. For he must reign until he has put all his enemies under his feet. The last enemy to be destroyed is death. For "God has put all things in subjection under his feet." But when it says, "all things are put in subjection," it is plain that he is excepted who put all things in subjection under him. When all things are subjected to him, then the Son himself will also be subjected to him who put all things in subjection under him, that God may be all in all."

1 Corinthians 15:24-28 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/1co.15.24-28.ESV>

"Then cometh the end, when he shall have delivered up (paradidōmi, G3860) the kingdom (basileia, G932) to God, even the Father; when he shall have put down (katargeō, G2673) all rule and all authority (exousia, G1849) and power (dunamis, G1411). For he must reign (basileuō, G936), till he hath put all enemies under his feet. The last enemy that shall be destroyed (katargeō, G2673) is death (thanatos, G2288). For he hath put (hupotassō, G5293) all things under his feet. But when he saith all things are put under him, it is manifest that he is excepted, which did put all things under him. And when all things shall be subdued unto him, then shall the Son also himself be subject unto him that put all things under him, that God may be all in all."

1 Corinthians 15:24-28 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/1co.15.24-28.KJV>

63. We will bear the image of the heavenly, putting on incorruption and immortality, when we inherit God's kingdom. For now, we are to be steadfast and abound in the work of the Lord.

"Just as we have borne the image of the man of dust, we shall also bear the image of the man of heaven. I tell you this, brothers: flesh and blood cannot inherit the kingdom of God, nor does the perishable inherit the imperishable. Behold! I tell you a mystery. We shall not all sleep, but we shall all be changed, in a moment, in the twinkling of an eye, at the last trumpet. For the trumpet will sound, and the dead will be raised imperishable, and we shall be changed. For this perishable body must put on the imperishable, and this mortal body must put on immortality. When the perishable puts on the imperishable, and the mortal puts on immortality, then shall come to pass the saying that is written: "Death is swallowed up in victory." "O death, where is your victory? O death, where is your sting?" The sting of death is sin, and the power of sin is the law. But thanks be to God, who gives us the victory through our Lord Jesus Christ. Therefore, my beloved brothers, be steadfast, immovable, always abounding in the work of the Lord, knowing that in the Lord your labor is not in vain."

1 Corinthians 15:49-58 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/1co.15.49-58.ESV>

"And as we have borne the image of the earthy, we shall also bear the image of the heavenly. Now this I say, brethren, that flesh and blood cannot inherit (klēronomeō, G2816) the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God; neither doth corruption inherit incorruption. Behold, I shew you a

mystery; We shall not all sleep, but we shall all be changed, in a moment, in the twinkling of an eye, at the last trump: for the trumpet shall sound, and the dead shall be raised incorruptible, and we shall be changed. For this corruptible must put on (enduō, G1746) incorruption, and this mortal must put on immortality. So when this corruptible shall have put on incorruption, and this mortal shall have put on immortality, then shall be brought to pass the saying that is written, Death is swallowed up in victory (nikos, G3534). O death, where is thy sting? O grave, where is thy victory? The sting of death is sin; and the strength of sin is the law. But thanks (charis, G5485) be to God, which giveth us the victory (nikos, G3534) through our Lord Jesus Christ. Therefore, my beloved brethren, be ye steadfast, unmoveable, always abounding (perisseuō, G4052) in the work of the Lord, forasmuch as ye know that your labour is not in vain in the Lord.“

1 Corinthians 15:49-58 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/1co.15.49-58.KJV>

64. Those who follow Jesus Christ have been delivered from the domain, authority and power of darkness. They have been translated into the kingdom (rule and government) of the benevolent, beloved Son of God, wherein they have been made saints of light and partakers of the inheritance of the Son. This inheritance includes the nature and character of the Spirit of God that enables them to know God's will, walk as Christ walked, and continue His ministry of overcoming the darkness.

”And so, from the day we heard, we have not ceased to pray for you, asking that you may be filled with the knowledge of his will in all spiritual wisdom and understanding, so as to walk in a manner worthy of the Lord, fully pleasing to him: bearing fruit in every good work and increasing in the knowledge of God; being strengthened with all power, according to his glorious might, for all endurance and patience with joy; giving thanks to the Father, who has qualified you to share in the inheritance of the saints in light. He has delivered us from the domain of darkness and transferred us to the kingdom of his beloved Son, in whom we have redemption, the forgiveness of sins.“

Colossians 1:9-14 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/col.1.9-14.ESV>

”For this cause we also, since the day we heard it, do not cease to pray for you, and to desire (aiteō, G154) that ye might be filled (plēroō, G4137) with the knowledge (epignōsis, G1922) of his will (thelēma, G2307) in all wisdom (sophia, G4678) and spiritual (pneumatikos, G4152) understanding (sunesis, G4907); that ye might walk (peripateō, G4043) worthy of the Lord unto all pleasing (areskeia, G699), being fruitful (karpophoreō, G2592) in every good (agathos, G18) work (ergon, G2041), and increasing (auxanō, G837) in the knowledge (epignōsis, G1922) of God; strengthened (dunamoō, G1412) with all might (dunamis, G1411), according to his glorious (doxa, G1391) power (kratos, G2904), unto all patience (hupomonē, G5281) and longsuffering (makrothumia, G3115) with joyfulness (chara, G5479); giving thanks (eucharisteō, G2168) unto the Father, which hath made us meet (hikanoō, G2427) to be partakers (meris, G3310) of the inheritance (klēros, G2819) of the saints (hagios, G40) in light (phōs, G5457): who hath delivered (rhuomai, G4506) us from the power (exousia, G1849) of darkness (skotos, G4655),

and hath translated (methistēmi, G3179) us into the kingdom (basileia, G932) of his dear (agapē, G26) Son: in whom we have redemption (apolutrōsis, G629) through his blood, even the forgiveness (aphesis, G859) of sins:“

Colossians 1:9-14 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/col.1.9-14.KJV>

65. Obedient followers of Jesus Christ are our fellow workers in God's kingdom's work. They are to be thought of, prayed for, and treated as beloved brothers and sisters. In this life, we are to come alongside God's co-workers to help them to stand mature and complete in all the will of God.

“Tychicus will tell you all about my activities. He is a beloved brother and faithful minister and fellow servant in the Lord. I have sent him to you for this very purpose, that you may know how we are and that he may encourage your hearts, and with him Onesimus, our faithful and beloved brother, who is one of you. They will tell you of everything that has taken place here. Aristarchus my fellow prisoner greets you, and Mark the cousin of Barnabas (concerning whom you have received instructions—if he comes to you, welcome him), and Jesus who is called Justus. These are the only men of the circumcision among my fellow workers for the kingdom of God, and they have been a comfort to me. Epaphras, who is one of you, a servant of Christ Jesus, greets you, always struggling on your behalf in his prayers, that you may stand mature and fully assured in all the will of God. For I bear him witness that he has worked hard for you and for those in Laodicea and in Hierapolis. Luke the beloved physician greets you, as does Demas. Give my greetings to the brothers at Laodicea, and to Nympha and the church in her house. And when this letter has been read among you, have it also read in the church of the Laodiceans; and see that you also read the letter from Laodicea. And say to Archippus, “See that you fulfill the ministry that you have received in the Lord.”“

Colossians 4:7-17 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/col.4.7-17.ESV>

“All my state shall Tychicus declare unto you, who is a beloved brother, and a faithful (pistos, G4103) minister (diakonos, G1249) and fellow servant (sundoulos, G4889) in the Lord: whom I have sent unto you for the same purpose, that he might know your estate, and comfort (parakaleō, G3870) your hearts; with Onesimus, a faithful (pistos, G4103) and beloved brother, who is one of you. They shall make known unto you all things which are done here. Aristarchus my fellow prisoner saluteth you, and Marcus, sister's son to Barnabas, (touching whom ye received commandments: if he come unto you, receive him;) and Jesus, which is called Justus, who are of the circumcision. These only are my fellowworkers (sunergos, G4904) unto the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God, which have been a comfort unto me. Epaphras, who is one of you, a servant (doulos, G1401) of Christ, saluteth you, always labouring fervently (agōnizomai, G75) for you in prayers, that ye may stand (histēmi, G2476) perfect (teleios, G5046) and complete (plēroō, G4137) in all the will (thelēma, G2307) of God. For I bear him record, that he hath a great zeal (zēlos, G2205) for you, and them that are in Laodicea, and them in Hierapolis. Luke, the beloved physician, and Demas, greet you. Salute the brethren which are in Laodicea, and Nymphas, and the church (ekklēsia, G1577) which is in his house. And when this epistle is

read among you, cause that it be read also in the church (ekklēsia, G1577) of the Laodiceans; and that ye likewise read the epistle from Laodicea. And say to Archippus, Take heed to the ministry (diakonia, G1248) which thou hast received (paralambanō, G3880) in the Lord, that thou fulfil (plēroō, G4137) it.“

Colossians 4:7-17 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/col.4.7-17.KJV>

66. We should walk in a manner worthy of God who called us unto His kingdom and glory. We are to live righteously and proclaim the gospel.

”For you know how, like a father with his children, we exhorted each one of you and encouraged you and charged you to walk in a manner worthy of God, who calls you into his own kingdom and glory.“

1 Thessalonians 2:11-12 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/1th.2.11-12.ESV>

”as ye know how we exhorted and comforted and charged every one of you, as a father doth his children, that ye would walk (peripateō, G4043) worthy of God, who hath called (kaleō, G2564) you unto his kingdom (basileia, G932) and glory (doxa, G1391).“

1 Thessalonians 2:11-12 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/1th.2.11-12.KJV>

67. We can expect to suffer persecution for the sake of God’s kingdom due to the opposition we will experience from those aligned with the realm of darkness. Jesus said that those who are persecuted for righteousness’ sake are blessed, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven.

”Therefore we ourselves boast about you in the churches of God for your steadfastness and faith in all your persecutions and in the afflictions that you are enduring. This is evidence of the righteous judgment of God, that you may be considered worthy of the kingdom of God, for which you are also suffering—“

2 Thessalonians 1:4-5 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/2th.1.4-5.ESV>

”so that we ourselves glory in you in the churches of God for your patience (hupomonē, G5281) and faith (pistis, G4102) in all your persecutions and tribulations that ye endure: which is a manifest token of the righteous (dikaios, G1342) judgment (krisis, G2920) of God, that ye may be counted worthy of the kingdom (basileia, G932) of God, for which ye also suffer:“

2 Thessalonians 1:4-5 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/2th.1.4-5.KJV>

68. Since Jesus Christ shall judge the living and the dead at His appearing and His kingdom, be ready and get others ready for kingdom citizenship by way of the indwelling word and Spirit.

"I charge you in the presence of God and of Christ Jesus, who is to judge the living and the dead, and by his appearing and his kingdom: preach the word; be ready in season and out of season; reprove, rebuke, and exhort, with complete patience and teaching."

2 Timothy 4:1-2 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/2ti.4.1-2.ESV>

"I charge thee therefore before God, and the Lord Jesus Christ, who shall judge the quick and the dead at his appearing and his kingdom (basileia, G932); preach (kērussō, G2784) the word; be instant (ephistēmi, G2186) in season (eukairōs, G2122), out of season; reprove (elegchō, G1651), rebuke (epitmaō, G2008), exhort (parakaleō, G3870) with all longsuffering (makrothumia, G3115) and doctrine."

2 Timothy 4:1-2 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/2ti.4.1-2.KJV>

69. The Lord, standing with Paul as he did God's word, delivered him every evil work, working out salvation in and for him unto the heavenly kingdom. We can expect this strengthening, delivering, and salvation too so long as we are willing to serve Him with our lives.

"But the Lord stood by me and strengthened me, so that through me the message might be fully proclaimed and all the Gentiles might hear it. So I was rescued from the lion's mouth. The Lord will rescue me from every evil deed and bring me safely into his heavenly kingdom. To him be the glory forever and ever. Amen."

2 Timothy 4:17-18 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/2ti.4.17-18.ESV>

"Notwithstanding the Lord stood with me (paristēmi, G3936), and strengthened (endunamoō, G1743) me; that by me the preaching (kērugma, G2782) might be fully known (plērophoreō, G4135), and that all the Gentiles might hear: and I was delivered (rhuomai, G4506) out of the mouth of the lion. And the Lord shall deliver (rhuomai, G4506) me from every evil (ponēros, G4190) work, and will preserve (sōzō, G4982) me unto his heavenly kingdom (basileia, G932): to whom be glory (doxa, G1391) for ever and ever. Amen."

2 Timothy 4:17-18 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/2ti.4.17-18.KJV>

70. One of the main characteristics of God's kingdom is righteousness. The Lord Jesus Christ is the righteousness of God; He is elevated as high priest above all else in God's kingdom; and He has canceled Satan's dominion over death, comprising all the miseries of sin. Everything in heaven, on earth and under the earth will be put in submission to Him. The salvation given to His kingdom citizens is great, and God joins together with its citizens to bear witness to it, by way of miracles including healing and deliverance, and by way of gifts of His Spirit, or the sharing of His own supernatural nature, including gifts of revelation, power and inspiration. Further, God holds His kingdom citizens in such honor that He has put us in dominion over all the works of His hands. We have great authority and responsibility.

"Long ago, at many times and in many ways, God spoke to our fathers by the prophets, but in these last days he has spoken to us by his Son, whom he appointed the heir of all things, through whom also he created the world. He is the radiance of the glory of God and the exact imprint of his nature, and he upholds the universe by the word of his power. After making purification for sins, he sat down at the right hand of the Majesty on high, having become as much superior to angels as the name he has inherited is more excellent than theirs. For to which of the angels did God ever say, "You are my Son, today I have begotten you"? Or again, "I will be to him a father, and he shall be to me a son"? And again, when he brings the firstborn into the world, he says, "Let all God's angels worship him." Of the angels he says, "He makes his angels winds, and his ministers a flame of fire." But of the Son he says, "Your throne, O God, is forever and ever, the scepter of uprightness is the scepter of your kingdom. You have loved righteousness and hated wickedness; therefore God, your God, has anointed you with the oil of gladness beyond your companions." And, "You, Lord, laid the foundation of the earth in the beginning, and the heavens are the work of your hands; they will perish, but you remain; they will all wear out like a garment, like a robe you will roll them up, like a garment they will be changed. But you are the same, and your years will have no end." And to which of the angels has he ever said, "Sit at my right hand until I make your enemies a footstool for your feet"? Are they not all ministering spirits sent out to serve for the sake of those who are to inherit salvation?"

Hebrews 1:1-14 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/heb.1.1-14.ESV>

"Therefore we must pay much closer attention to what we have heard, lest we drift away from it. For since the message declared by angels proved to be reliable, and every transgression or disobedience received a just retribution, how shall we escape if we neglect such a great salvation? It was declared at first by the Lord, and it was attested to us by those who heard, while God also bore witness by signs and wonders and various miracles and by gifts of the Holy Spirit distributed according to his will. For it was not to angels that God subjected the world to come, of which we are speaking. It has been testified somewhere, "What is man, that you are mindful of him, or the son of man, that you care for him? You made him for a little while lower than the angels; you have crowned him with glory and honor, putting everything in subjection under his feet." Now in putting everything in subjection to him, he left nothing outside his control. At present, we do not yet see everything in subjection to him. But we see him who for a little while was made lower than the angels, namely Jesus, crowned with glory and honor because of the suffering of death, so that by the grace of God he might taste death for everyone. For it was fitting that he, for whom and by whom all things exist, in bringing many sons to glory, should make the founder of their salvation perfect through suffering. For he who sanctifies and those who are sanctified all have one source. That is why he is not ashamed to call them brothers, saying, "I will tell of your name to my brothers; in the midst of the congregation I will sing your praise." And again, "I will put my trust in him." And again, "Behold, I and the children God has given me." Since therefore the children share in flesh and blood, he himself likewise partook of the same things, that through death he might destroy the one who has the power of death, that is, the devil, and deliver all those who through fear of death were subject to lifelong slavery. For surely it is not angels that he helps, but he helps the offspring of Abraham. Therefore he had to

be made like his brothers in every respect, so that he might become a merciful and faithful high priest in the service of God, to make propitiation for the sins of the people. For because he himself has suffered when tempted, he is able to help those who are being tempted.”

Hebrews 2:1-18 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/heb.2.1-18.ESV>

”God, who at sundry times and in divers manners spake in time past unto the fathers by the prophets, hath in these last days spoken unto us by his Son, whom he hath appointed heir (klēronomos, G2818) of all things, by whom also he made the worlds; who being the brightness (apaugasma, G541) of his glory (doxa, G1391), and the express image (charaktēr, G5481) of his person (hupostasis, G5287), and upholding all things by the word (rhēma, G4487) of his power (dunamis, G1411), when he had by himself purged (poieō katharismos, G4160+G2512) our sins, sat down on the right hand of the Majesty on high; being made so much better than the angels, as he hath by inheritance (klēronomeō, G2816) obtained a more excellent (diaphoros, G1313) name (onoma, G3686) than they. For unto which of the angels said he at any time, Thou art my Son, This day have I begotten (gennaō, G1080) thee? And again, I will be to him a Father, And he shall be to me a Son? And again, when he bringeth in the firstbegotten into the world, he saith, And let all the angels of God worship (proskuneō, G4352) him. And of the angels he saith, Who maketh his angels spirits, And his ministers a flame of fire. But unto the Son he saith, Thy throne (thronos, G2362), O God, is for ever and ever: A sceptre of righteousness (euthutēs, G2118) is the sceptre of thy kingdom (basileus, G932). Thou hast loved (agapaō, G25) righteousness (dikaïosunē, G1343), and hated iniquity; Therefore God, even thy God, hath anointed (chriō, G5548) thee With the oil (elaion, G1637) of gladness (agalliasis, G20) above thy fellows. And, Thou, Lord (kurios, G2962), in the beginning hast laid the foundation of the earth; And the heavens are the works (ergon, G2041) of thine hands (cheir, G5495): They shall perish; but thou remainest: And they all shall wax old as doth a garment; And as a vesture shalt thou fold them up, And they shall be changed: But thou art the same, And thy years shall not fail. But to which of the angels said he at any time, Sit on my right hand, Until I make thine enemies thy footstool (hupopodion pous, G5286+G4228)? Are they not all ministering (leitourgikos, G3010) spirits, sent forth (apostellō, G649) to minister (diakonia, G1248) for them who shall be heirs of salvation (sōtēria, G4991)?“

Hebrews 1:1-14 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/heb.1.1-14.KJV>

”Therefore we ought to give the more earnest heed to the things which we have heard, lest at any time we should let them slip. For if the word spoken by angels was stedfast, and every transgression and disobedience received a just (endikos, G1738) recompence of reward; how shall we escape, if we neglect so great salvation (sōtēria, G4991); which at the first began to be spoken by the Lord, and was confirmed (bebaioō, G950) unto us by them that heard him; God also bearing them witness (sunepimartureō, G4901), both with signs (sēmeion, G4592) and wonders (teras, G5059), and with divers miracles (dunamis, G1411), and gifts (merismos, G3311) of the Holy (hagios, G40) Ghost, according to his own will (thelēsis, G2308)? For unto the angels hath he not put in subjection the world to come, whereof we speak. But one in a certain place testified, saying, What is man (anthrōpos, G444), that thou art mindful of him? Or

the son of man, that thou visitest (episkeptomai, G1980) him? Thou madest him a little lower than the angels; Thou crownedst him with glory (doxa, G1391) and honour (timē, G5092), And didst set (kathistēmi, G2525) him over the works (ergon, G2041) of thy hands (cheir, G5495): Thou hast put all things in subjection (hupotassō, G5293) under his feet. For in that he put all in subjection under him, he left nothing that is not put under (anupotaktos, G506) him. But now we see (horaō, G3708) not yet all things put under him. But we see Jesus, who was made a little lower than the angels for the suffering of death, crowned with glory and honour; that he by the grace (charis, G5485) of God should taste death for every man. For it became him, for whom are all things, and by whom are all things, in bringing many sons unto glory (doxa, G1391), to make the captain of their salvation (sōtēria, G4991) perfect (teleioō, G5048) through sufferings (pathēma, G3804). For both he that sanctifieth (hagiazō, G37) and they who are sanctified (hagiazō, G37) are all of one: for which cause he is not ashamed to call them brethren (adelphos, G80), saying, I will declare thy name unto my brethren, In the midst of the church (ekklēsia, G1577) will I sing praise (humneō, G5214) unto thee. And again, I will put my trust (peithō, G3982) in him. And again, Behold I and the children which God hath given me. Forasmuch then as the children are partakers (koinōneō, G2841) of flesh and blood, he also himself likewise took part of the same; that through death he might destroy (katargeō, G2673) him that had the power (kratos, G2904) of death (thanatos, G2288), that is, the devil (diabolos, G1228); and deliver (apallassō, G525) them who through fear (phobos, G5401) of death (thanatos, G2288) were all their lifetime subject to bondage (douleia, G1397). For verily he took not on him the nature of angels; but he took on (epilambanomai, G1949) him the seed of Abraham (Abraam, G11). Wherefore in all things it behoved him to be made like unto his brethren, that he might be a merciful (eleēmōn, G1655) and faithful (pistos, G4103) high priest in things pertaining to God, to make reconciliation for (hilaskomai, G2433) the sins of the people. For in that he himself hath suffered being tempted, he is able to succour (boētheō, G997) them that are tempted.“

Hebrews 2:1-18 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/heb.2.1-18.KJV>

71. The eternal kingdom of God cannot be moved, unlike other things that have been made, including those which cause distraction and agitation, which will pass away. We are joined to that eternal kingdom when we receive it as intended, and in it we serve and please God with reverence and godly fear, for He is worthy of utmost respect.

”This phrase, “Yet once more,” indicates the removal of things that are shaken—that is, things that have been made—in order that the things that cannot be shaken may remain. Therefore let us be grateful for receiving a kingdom that cannot be shaken, and thus let us offer to God acceptable worship, with reverence and awe, for our God is a consuming fire.“

Hebrews 12:27-29 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/heb.12.27-29.ESV>

”And this word, Yet once more, signifieth the removing (metathesis, G3331) of those things that are shaken (saleuō, H4531), as of things that are made (poieō, G4160), that those things which cannot be shaken (saleuō, H4531) may remain (menō, G3306). Wherefore we receiving

(paralambanō, G3880) a kingdom (basileia, G932) which cannot be moved (asaleutos, G761), let us have (echō, G2192) grace (charis, G5485), whereby we may serve (latreuō, G3000) God acceptably (euaireōs, G2102) with reverence (aidōs, G127) and godly fear (eulabeia, G2124): for our God is a consuming fire.”

Hebrews 12:27-29 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/heb.12.27-29.KJV>

72. God has chosen many who are poor and those without position in worldly affairs to be abounding in faithfulness to God and heirs of the kingdom, which is for those who love Him on His terms. One cannot pursue both God and the world. The choice to follow Christ requires everything of us.

”Listen, my beloved brothers, has not God chosen those who are poor in the world to be rich in faith and heirs of the kingdom, which he has promised to those who love him?”

James 2:5 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/jas.2.5.ESV>

”Hearken, my beloved brethren, Hath not God chosen the poor of this world (kosmos, G2889) rich (plousios, G4145) in faith (pistis, G4102), and heirs of the kingdom (basileia, G932) which he hath promised to them that love (agapaō, G25) him?”

James 2:5 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/jas.2.5.KJV>

73. Christlike character and nature that manifest themselves in action make one’s calling, election, and entrance into the kingdom sure, for His divine power has given those who are His all things that pertain to life and godliness.

”May grace and peace be multiplied to you in the knowledge of God and of Jesus our Lord. His divine power has granted to us all things that pertain to life and godliness, through the knowledge of him who called us to his own glory and excellence, by which he has granted to us his precious and very great promises, so that through them you may become partakers of the divine nature, having escaped from the corruption that is in the world because of sinful desire. For this very reason, make every effort to supplement your faith with virtue, and virtue with knowledge, and knowledge with self-control, and self-control with steadfastness, and steadfastness with godliness, and godliness with brotherly affection, and brotherly affection with love. For if these qualities are yours and are increasing, they keep you from being ineffective or unfruitful in the knowledge of our Lord Jesus Christ. For whoever lacks these qualities is so nearsighted that he is blind, having forgotten that he was cleansed from his former sins. Therefore, brothers, be all the more diligent to confirm your calling and election, for if you practice these qualities you will never fall. For in this way there will be richly provided for you an entrance into the eternal kingdom of our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ. Therefore I intend always to remind you of these qualities, though you know them and are established in the truth that you have. I think it right, as long as I am in this body, to stir you up by way of reminder,”

2 Peter 1:2-13 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/2pe.1.2-13.ESV>

"Grace (charis, G5485) and peace (eirēnē, G1515) be multiplied (plēthunō, G4129) unto you through the knowledge (epignōsis, G1922) of God, and of Jesus (Iēsous, G2424) our Lord (kurios, G2962), according as his divine power (dunamis, G1411) hath given (dōreomai, G1433) unto us all things that pertain unto life (zōē, G2222) and godliness (eusebeia, G2150), through the knowledge (epignōsis, G1922) of him that hath called (kaleō, G2564) us to glory (doxa, G1391) and virtue (aretē, G703): whereby are given (dōreomai, G1433) unto us exceeding great (megistos, G3176) and precious (timios, G5093) promises (epaggelma, G1862): that by these ye might be partakers (koinōnos, G2844) of the divine nature (physis, G5449), having escaped the corruption (phthora, G5356) that is in the world through lust (epithumia, G1939). And beside this, giving all diligence (spoudē, G4710), add to your faith (pistis, G4102) virtue (aretē, G703); and to virtue knowledge (gnōsis, G1108); and to knowledge temperance (egkrateia, G1466); and to temperance patience (hupomonē, G5281); and to patience godliness (eusebeia, G2150); and to godliness brotherly kindness (philadelphia, G5360); and to brotherly kindness charity (agapē, G26). For if these things be (huparchō, G5225) in you, and abound (pleonazō, G4121), they make you that ye shall neither be barren (argos, G692) nor unfruitful (akarpōs, G175) in the knowledge (epignōsis, G1922) of our Lord (kurios, G2962) Jesus (Iēsous, G2424) Christ (Christos, G5547). But he that lacketh these things is blind, and cannot see afar off (muōpazō, G3467), and hath forgotten that he was purged from his old sins. Wherefore the rather, brethren, give diligence (spoudazō, G4704) to make your calling (klēsis, G2821) and election (eklogē, G1589) sure (bebaios, G949): for if ye do (poieō, G4160) these things, ye shall never fall: for so an entrance (eisodos, G1529) shall be ministered (epichorēgeō, G2023) unto you abundantly (plousiōs, G4146) into the everlasting kingdom (basileia, G932) of our Lord and Saviour (sōtēr, G4990) Jesus Christ. Wherefore I will not be negligent to put you always in remembrance of these things, though ye know them, and be established (stērizō, G4741) in the present (pareimi, G3918) truth (alētheia, G225). Yea, I think it meet (dikaio, G1342), as long as I am in this tabernacle (skēnōma, G4638), to stir you up (diegeirō, G1326) by putting you in remembrance;"

2 Peter 1:2-13 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/2pe.1.2-13.KJV>

74. Jesus Christ has made us kings and priests unto God in His kingdom. Priests are servants to all men on behalf of God. As kings, we will be given some measure of responsibility and authority in His kingdom as a reward for our faithfulness to God, His word, and His kingdom work. As priests and kings, we are subject to the great high priest and the King of kings, our Lord Jesus Christ.

"The revelation of Jesus Christ, which God gave him to show to his servants the things that must soon take place. He made it known by sending his angel to his servant John, who bore witness to the word, of God and to the testimony of Jesus Christ, even to all that he saw. Blessed is the one who reads aloud the words of this prophecy, and blessed are those who hear, and who keep what is written in it, for the time is near. John to the seven churches that are in Asia: Grace to you and peace from him who is and who was and who is to come, and from

the seven spirits who are before his throne, and from Jesus Christ the faithful witness, the firstborn of the dead, and the ruler of kings on earth. To him who loves us and has freed us from our sins by his blood and made us a kingdom, priests to his God and Father, to him be glory and dominion forever and ever. Amen. Behold, he is coming with the clouds, and every eye will see him, even those who pierced him, and all tribes of the earth will wail on account of him. Even so. Amen. "I am the Alpha and the Omega," says the Lord God, "who is and who was and who is to come, the Almighty." I, John, your brother and partner in the tribulation and the kingdom and the patient endurance that are in Jesus, was on the island called Patmos on account of the word of God and the testimony of Jesus. I was in the Spirit on the Lord's day, and I heard behind me a loud voice like a trumpet saying, "Write what you see in a book and send it to the seven churches, to Ephesus and to Smyrna and to Pergamum and to Thyatira and to Sardis and to Philadelphia and to Laodicea."

Revelation 1:1-11 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/rev.1.1-11.ESV>

"The Revelation (apokalupsis, G602) of Jesus Christ, which God gave unto him, to shew unto his servants (doulos, G1401) things which must shortly come to pass; and he sent (apostellō, G649) and signified it by his angel unto his servant John: who bare record of the word of God, and of the testimony of Jesus Christ, and of all things that he saw. Blessed (makarios, G3107) is he that readeth, and they that hear (akouō, G191) the words of this prophecy, and keep (tēreō, G5083) those things which are written therein: for the time is at hand (eggus, G1451). John to the seven churches which are in Asia (G773): Grace (charis, G5485) be unto you, and peace (eirēnē, G1515), from him which is, and which was, and which is to come; and from the seven Spirits which are before his throne (thronos, G2362); and from Jesus Christ, who is the faithful (pistos, G4103) witness (martus, G3144), and the first begotten of the dead, and the prince (archōn, G758) of the kings (basileus, G935) of the earth. Unto him that loved us, and washed (louō, G3068) us from our sins in his own blood, and hath made (poieō, G4160) us kings (basileus, G935) and priests (hiereus, G2409) unto God and his Father; to him be glory (doxa, G1391) and dominion (kratos, G2904) for ever and ever. Amen. Behold, he cometh with clouds; and every eye shall see him, and they also which pierced him: and all kindreds of the earth shall wail because of him. Even so, Amen. I am Alpha and Omega, the beginning and the ending, saith the Lord, which is, and which was, and which is to come, the Almighty (pantokratōr, G3841). I John, who also am your brother, and companion (sugkoinōnos, G4791) in tribulation, and in the kingdom (basileia, G932) and patience (hupomonē, G5281) of Jesus Christ, was in the isle that is called Patmos, for the word of God, and for the testimony of Jesus Christ. I was in the Spirit on the Lord's day, and heard behind me a great voice, as of a trumpet, saying, I am Alpha and Omega, the first and the last: and, What thou seest, write in a book, and send it unto the seven churches (ekklēsia, G1577) which are in Asia; unto Ephesus, and unto Smyrna, and unto Pergamos, and unto Thyatira, and unto Sardis, and unto Philadelphia, and unto Laodicea."

Revelation 1:1-11 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/rev.1.1-11.KJV>

75. At the judgment, the kingdoms of this world will become the kingdoms of our Lord, He will take back all power, and he shall reign forever. He will reward the faithful and destroy the unfaithful.

"Then the seventh angel blew his trumpet, and there were loud voices in heaven, saying, "The kingdom of the world has become the kingdom of our Lord and of his Christ, and he shall reign forever and ever." And the twenty-four elders who sit on their thrones before God fell on their faces and worshiped God, saying, "We give thanks to you, Lord God Almighty, who is and who was, for you have taken your great power and begun to reign. The nations raged, but your wrath came, and the time for the dead to be judged, and for rewarding your servants, the prophets and saints, and those who fear your name, both small and great, and for destroying the destroyers of the earth." Then God's temple in heaven was opened, and the ark of his covenant was seen within his temple. There were flashes of lightning, rumblings, peals of thunder, an earthquake, and heavy hail."

Revelation 11:15-19 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/rev.11.15-19.ESV>

"And the seventh angel sounded; and there were great voices in heaven, saying, The kingdoms (basileia, G932) of this world are become the kingdoms of our Lord (kurios, G2962), and of his Christ (Christos, G5547); and he shall reign (basileuō, G936) for ever and ever. And the four and twenty elders (presbuteros, G4245), which sat before God on their seats (thronos, G2362), fell upon their faces, and worshipped (proskuneō, G4352) God, saying, We give thee thanks (eucharisteō, G2168), O Lord God Almighty (pantokratōr, G3841), which art, and wast, and art to come; because thou hast taken to thee thy great power (dunamis, G1411), and hast reigned (basileuō, G936). And the nations were angry, and thy wrath is come, and the time of the dead, that they should be judged, and that thou shouldest give reward unto thy servants the prophets, and to the saints, and them that fear thy name, small and great; and shouldest destroy them which destroy (diaptheirō, G1311) the earth. And the temple (naos, G3485) of God was opened in heaven, and there was seen in his temple the ark of his testament: and there were lightnings, and voices, and thunderings, and an earthquake, and great hail."

Revelation 11:15-19 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/rev.11.15-19.KJV>

76. Satan's schemes include deception and accusation. He speaks out of his own character as the father of lies. Satan takes every possible advantage of God's legal system. Satan also deceives in order to take any advantage possible to defame God or to lead people willingly away from the narrow path of following Christ. In Christ's victory at the cross, Satan and his angels were defeated and cast out of heaven to earth. They have no authority anymore over those who belong to Christ. Christ's victory at the cross was Satan's defeat, bringing salvation, strength, the kingdom (rule, dominion, government) of God, and the power of Christ. In Christ, the kingdom of God is now at hand. Christ came to destroy the works of the devil. Christ is now Lord over everything that has a name in heaven, on earth and under the earth; all authority is His. Christ's followers overcome Satan by the blood of the Lamb, for His blood has set them free from the law of sin and death, including sin and all of its miseries. Christ's followers overcome

Satan by their direct connection to God in Christ and by their faith. Christ's followers overcome Satan and his works by the word of their testimony, for the words spoken in faith by God's children are powerful. In Christ, they have been given dominion on earth by way of their words spoken in faith; the gates of hell shall not prevail against them. Further, Christ's followers gain victory by dying to themselves to live for Christ and the accomplishment of all of God's will; there will be victory in this. They often give their lives throughout the world as martyrs as well. Nevertheless, Satan and devils still have ability on earth until the time of the judgment. His realm expresses wrath all of the time toward God's image bearers (all of mankind), seeking ways to steal (because they have no authority), kill and destroy. His realm persecutes obedient Christ followers, i.e., those who obey God's word and openly testify to the finished work of Jesus Christ. They persecute by working through the will of men and women under their influence, the children of disobedience who carry out Satan's desires. Those who have put Christ's words into practice (i.e., disciples) are the ones that actively threaten Satan's realm and its ability to steal, kill, and destroy.

"Now war arose in heaven, Michael and his angels fighting against the dragon. And the dragon and his angels fought back, but he was defeated, and there was no longer any place for them in heaven. And the great dragon was thrown down, that ancient serpent, who is called the devil and Satan, the deceiver of the whole world—he was thrown down to the earth, and his angels were thrown down with him. And I heard a loud voice in heaven, saying, "Now the salvation and the power and the kingdom of our God and the authority of his Christ have come, for the accuser of our brothers has been thrown down, who accuses them day and night before our God. And they have conquered him by the blood of the Lamb and by the word of their testimony, for they loved not their lives even unto death. Therefore, rejoice, O heavens and you who dwell in them! But woe to you, O earth and sea, for the devil has come down to you in great wrath, because he knows that his time is short!" And when the dragon saw that he had been thrown down to the earth, he pursued the woman who had given birth to the male child. But the woman was given the two wings of the great eagle so that she might fly from the serpent into the wilderness, to the place where she is to be nourished for a time, and times, and half a time. The serpent poured water like a river out of his mouth after the woman, to sweep her away with a flood. But the earth came to the help of the woman, and the earth opened its mouth and swallowed the river that the dragon had poured from his mouth. Then the dragon became furious with the woman and went off to make war on the rest of her offspring, on those who keep the commandments of God and hold to the testimony of Jesus. And he stood on the sand of the sea."

Revelation 12:7-17 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/rev.12.7-17.ESV>

"And there was war in heaven: Michael (G3413) and his angels fought against the dragon (drakōn, G1404); and the dragon fought and his angels, and prevailed not; neither was their place found any more in heaven. And the great dragon was cast out, that old serpent (ophis, G3789), called the Devil (diabolos, G1228), and Satan (Satanas, G4567), which deceiveth (planaō, G4105) the whole world: he was cast out (ballō, G906) into the earth, and his angels were cast out (ballō, G906) with him. And I heard a loud voice saying in heaven, Now is come

salvation (sōtēria, G4991), and strength (dunamis, G1411), and the kingdom (basileia, G932) of our God, and the power (exousia, G1849) of his Christ (Christos, G5547): for the accuser (katēgoreō, G2723) of our brethren (adelphos, G80) is cast down (kataballō, G2598), which accused (katēgoros, G2725) them before our God day and night. And they overcame (nikaō, G3528) him by the blood of the Lamb, and by the word (logos, G3056) of their testimony (marturia, G3141); and they loved not their lives (psuchē, G5590) unto the death (thanatos, G2288). Therefore rejoice, ye heavens, and ye that dwell (skēnoō, G4637) in them. Woe to the inhabitants (katoikeō, G2730) of the earth and of the sea! for the devil (diabolos, G1228) is come down unto you, having great wrath (thumos, G2372), because he knoweth that he hath but a short time. And when the dragon saw that he was cast unto the earth, he persecuted (diōkō, G1377) the woman which brought forth the man child. And to the woman were given two wings of a great eagle, that she might fly into the wilderness, into her place, where she is nourished for a time, and times, and half a time, from the face of the serpent. And the serpent cast out of his mouth water as a flood after the woman, that he might cause her to be carried away of the flood. And the earth helped the woman, and the earth opened her mouth, and swallowed up the flood which the dragon cast out of his mouth. And the dragon was wroth with the woman, and went to make war with the remnant of her seed, which keep (tēreō, G5083) the commandments of God, and have (echō, G2192) the testimony (marturia, G3141) of Jesus Christ.”

Revelation 12:7-17 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/rev.12.7-17.KJV>

77. God will judge all men according to their works, as recorded by Him. Those who belong to God have their names written in the book of life. The others will be cast into a lake of fire. Death will also be destroyed.

”Then I saw a great white throne and him who was seated on it. From his presence earth and sky fled away, and no place was found for them. And I saw the dead, great and small, standing before the throne, and books were opened. Then another book was opened, which is the book of life. And the dead were judged by what was written in the books, according to what they had done. And the sea gave up the dead who were in it, Death and Hades gave up the dead who were in them, and they were judged, each one of them, according to what they had done. Then Death and Hades were thrown into the lake of fire. This is the second death, the lake of fire. And if anyone’s name was not found written in the book of life, he was thrown into the lake of fire.”

Revelation 20:11-15 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/rev.20.11-15.ESV>

”And I saw a great white (leukos, G3022) throne (thronos, G2362), and him that sat on it, from whose face the earth and the heaven fled away; and there was found no place for them. And I saw the dead, small and great, stand before God; and the books (biblion, G975) were opened: and another book was opened, which is the book of life (zōē, G2222): and the dead were judged out of those things which were written in the books, according to their works (ergon, G2041). And the sea gave up the dead which were in it; and death (thanatos, G2288) and hell (hadēs, G86) delivered up the dead which were in them: and they were judged every man according to their works (ergon, G2041). And death (thanatos, G2288) and hell (hadēs, G86)

were cast into the lake of fire. This is the second death (thanatos, G2288). And whosoever was not found written in the book of life was cast into the lake of fire.”

Revelation 20:11-15 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/rev.20.11-15.KJV>

78. The eternal kingdom for the body of Christ, the righteous whose names are written in the Lamb's book of life, is the new heaven and earth, having the new Jerusalem within it. His people will be with God there, and all corruption of the good creation in the present world that was brought about by the law of sin and death will be gone. The nearness of His kingdom makes things now on earth as they are to be in heaven, for He freely gives of the fountain of the water of life.

”Then I saw a new heaven and a new earth, for the first heaven and the first earth had passed away, and the sea was no more. And I saw the holy city, new Jerusalem, coming down out of heaven from God, prepared as a bride adorned for her husband. And I heard a loud voice from the throne saying, “Behold, the dwelling place of God is with man. He will dwell with them, and they will be his people, and God himself will be with them as their God. He will wipe away every tear from their eyes, and death shall be no more, neither shall there be mourning, nor crying, nor pain anymore, for the former things have passed away.” And he who was seated on the throne said, “Behold, I am making all things new.” Also he said, “Write this down, for these words are trustworthy and true.” And he said to me, “It is done! I am the Alpha and the Omega, the beginning and the end. To the thirsty I will give from the spring of the water of life without payment. The one who conquers will have this heritage, and I will be his God and he will be my son. But as for the cowardly, the faithless, the detestable, as for murderers, the sexually immoral, sorcerers, idolaters, and all liars, their portion will be in the lake that burns with fire and sulfur, which is the second death.” Then came one of the seven angels who had the seven bowls full of the seven last plagues and spoke to me, saying, “Come, I will show you the Bride, the wife of the Lamb.” And he carried me away in the Spirit to a great, high mountain, and showed me the holy city Jerusalem coming down out of heaven from God, having the glory of God, its radiance like a most rare jewel, like a jasper, clear as crystal. It had a great, high wall, with twelve gates, and at the gates twelve angels, and on the gates the names of the twelve tribes of the sons of Israel were inscribed— on the east three gates, on the north three gates, on the south three gates, and on the west three gates. And the wall of the city had twelve foundations, and on them were the twelve names of the twelve apostles of the Lamb. And the one who spoke with me had a measuring rod of gold to measure the city and its gates and walls. The city lies foursquare, its length the same as its width. And he measured the city with his rod, 12,000 stadia. Its length and width and height are equal. He also measured its wall, 144 cubits by human measurement, which is also an angel's measurement. The wall was built of jasper, while the city was pure gold, like clear glass. The foundations of the wall of the city were adorned with every kind of jewel. The first was jasper, the second sapphire, the third agate, the fourth emerald, the fifth onyx, the sixth carnelian, the seventh chrysolite, the eighth beryl, the ninth topaz, the tenth chrysoprase, the eleventh jacinth, the twelfth amethyst. And the twelve gates were twelve pearls, each of the gates made of a single pearl, and the street of the city was pure gold, like transparent glass. And I saw no temple in the city, for its temple is the Lord God the Almighty and the Lamb. And the city has no need of sun or moon to shine on it, for the glory of God gives it light, and its lamp is the Lamb. By its light will the nations walk, and the kings of the earth will bring their glory into it, and its gates will never be shut by day—and there will be no night there. They will bring into it the glory and the honor of the nations. But nothing

unclean will ever enter it, nor anyone who does what is detestable or false, but only those who are written in the Lamb's book of life."

Revelation 21:1-27 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/rev.21.1-27.ESV>

"And I saw a new (kainos, G2537) heaven and a new earth: for the first heaven and the first earth were passed away; and there was no more sea. And I John saw the holy (hagios, G40) city, new Jerusalem (Hierousalēm, G2419), coming down from God out of heaven, prepared as a bride (numphē, G3565) adorned (kosmeō, G2885) for her husband. And I heard a great voice out of heaven saying, Behold, the tabernacle (skēnē, G4633) of God is with men, and he will dwell (skēnoō, G4637) with them, and they shall be his people, and God himself shall be with them, and be their God. And God shall wipe away (exaleiphō, G1813) all tears from their eyes; and there shall be no more death (thanatos, G2288), neither sorrow, nor crying, neither shall there be any more pain (ponos, G4192): for the former things are passed away (aperchomai, G565). And he that sat upon the throne (thronos, G2362) said, Behold, I make all things new (kainos, G2537). And he said unto me, Write: for these words are true (alēthinos, G228) and faithful (pistos, G4103). And he said unto me, It is done. I am Alpha and Omega, the beginning and the end. I will give unto him that is athirst of the fountain (pēgē, G4077) of the water of life (zōē, G2222) freely (dōrean, G1432). He that overcometh (nikaō, G3528) shall inherit (klēronomeō, G2816) all things; and I will be his God, and he shall be my son (uihos, G5207). But the fearful (deilos, G1169), and unbelieving (apistos, G571), and the abominable (bdelussō, G948), and murderers, and whoremongers (pornos, G4205), and sorcerers (pharmakeus, G5332), and idolaters (eidōlatrēs, G1496), and all liars (pseudēs, G5571), shall have their part in the lake which burneth with fire and brimstone (theion, G2303): which is the second death (thanatos, G2288). And there came unto me one of the seven angels which had the seven vials full of the seven last plagues, and talked with me, saying, Come hither, I will shew thee the bride, the Lamb's wife. And he carried me away in the spirit to a great and high mountain, and shewed me that great city (polis, G4172), the holy (hagios, G40) Jerusalem (Hierousalēm, G2419), descending out of heaven from God, having the glory (doxa, G1391) of God: and her light (phōstēr, G5458) was like unto a stone most precious, even like a jasper (iaspis, G2393) stone, clear as crystal (krystalizō, G2929); and had a wall great and high, and had twelve gates, and at the gates twelve angels, and names written thereon, which are the names of the twelve tribes of the children of Israel: on the east three gates; on the north three gates; on the south three gates; and on the west three gates. And the wall of the city had twelve foundations, and in them the names of the twelve apostles (apostolos, G652) of the Lamb. And he that talked with me had a golden reed to measure the city, and the gates thereof, and the wall thereof. And the city lieth foursquare, and the length is as large as the breadth: and he measured the city with the reed, twelve thousand furlongs (stadion, G4712). The length and the breadth and the height of it are equal. And he measured the wall thereof, an hundred and forty and four cubits (pēchus, G4083), according to the measure of a man, that is, of the angel. And the building of the wall of it was of jasper (iaspis, G2393): and the city was pure gold, like unto clear (katharos, G2513) glass (hualos, G5194). And the foundations of the wall of the city were garnished with all manner of precious stones. The first foundation was jasper (iaspis, G2393); the second, sapphire (sappheiros, G4552); the third, a chalcedony (chalkēdōn, G5472); the fourth, an emerald (smaragdōs, G4665); the fifth, sardonyx (sardonux, G4557); the sixth, sardius (sardios, G4556); the seventh, chrysolyte (chrusolithos, G5555); the eighth, beryl (bērullos, G969); the ninth, a topaz (topazion, G5116); the tenth, a chrysoprasus (chrusoprasos, G5556); the eleventh, a jacinth (huakinthos, G5192); the twelfth, an amethyst (amethystos, G271). And the twelve gates were twelve pearls (margaritēs, G3135); every several gate was of one pearl: and the street of the city was pure gold, as it were transparent glass. And I saw no temple therein: for the Lord God Almighty (pantokratōr, G3841) and the Lamb are the temple (naos, G3485) of

it. And the city had no need of the sun, neither of the moon, to shine (phainō, G5316) in it: for the glory (doxa, G1391) of God did lighten (phōtizō, G5461) it, and the Lamb is the light (luchnos, G3088) thereof. And the nations of them which are saved (sōzō, G4982) shall walk (peripateō, G4043) in the light (phōs, G5457) of it: and the kings (basileus, G935) of the earth do bring their glory (doxa, G1391) and honour (timē, G5092) into it. And the gates of it shall not be shut at all by day: for there shall be no night there. And they shall bring the glory (doxa, G1391) and honour (timē, G5092) of the nations into it. And there shall in no wise enter into it any thing that defileth (koinōō, G2840), neither whatsoever worketh abomination (bdelugma, G946), or maketh a lie (pseudos, G5579): but they which are written in the Lamb's book of life (zōē, G2222).“

Revelation 21:1-27 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/rev.21.1-27.KJV>

Kingdom in the Old Testament

Kingdom

H4467

Transliteration: mamlâkâh

Pronunciation: mam-law-kaw'

BDB Lexicon:

1. kingdom , dominion, reign, sovereignty
 - a. Kingdom, realm
 - b. Sovereignty, dominion
 - c. reign

Also translated: royal, reign, king's

Kingdom

H4437

Transliteration: malkû

Pronunciation: mal-koo'

BDB Lexicon:

1. Royalty, reign, kingdom
 - a. Royalty, kingship, kingly authority
 - b. Kingdom
 - c. Realm (of territory)
 - d. Reign (of time)

Also translated: reign, realm, kingly

79. Under the old covenant, if God's people obey His voice and keep His covenant, then they shall be a peculiar treasure, a kingdom of priests, a holy nation. Under the new covenant, all are invited to follow Jesus Christ to be God's people. Obedience to God's word is still expected.
80. God took Saul's kingdom from him because of disobedience to Him in order to please people. He seeks those after His own heart, mind and will.
81. It is David's descendent, Jesus Christ, that has a house, a kingdom, and a throne , being a son to God — the Son of God. The house is the body of Christ, the church, made of Israelites and Gentiles, made of all the nations of the earth. And so it is a blessing to all nations, as promised to Abraham. The kingdom is the one that Jesus preached as being near, the one that has come with His resurrection and glorification. The kingdom has come with Jesus' demonstration of the power and authority of God to bring freedom, healing and salvation through the Holy Spirit, now given to the body of Christ, the church. This kingdom that Jesus brought allowed the church to possess the gate of God's enemies. The throne is the one Jesus received with authority over all of heaven and earth until the time that all evil is put under His feet. It is Christ's throne and, therefore, it belongs also to the body of Christ, the church, to accomplish the will of God and bring Him glory. It is the throne of grace, and *in Christ* we are seated with Him.

82. God desires for His kingdom citizens to walk before Him with integrity, completeness, simplicity, and righteousness of heart, as David did. God desires for our will aligned with His, as David's was. He desires for us to do all that He has commissioned us to do. He desires for our purpose to be focused on His.
83. The kingdom is given to those who, like David, keep God's commandments, follow God with all of their soul (mind, will, emotion), and do only that which is right in God's eyes. Kingdom citizens follow behind God in the way they live their lives rather than casting God behind them.
84. David showed the right attitude of a kingdom citizen as he glorified God as the righteous King before Solomon was anointed king. God expects His kingdom citizens to submit to His government, rule, and will.
85. David showed the character and thoughts of one who was aligned with God's thinking and will. The benefits of being kingdom citizens include freedom from sin, death, and its effects, sickness included. They include life and strength from the Spirit of God. Kingdom citizens are the handiwork of God, clay in the hands of the potter. Angels the handiwork of God, messengers with power to carry out God's word. We are made for the glory of God; His nature and character are beautiful and praiseworthy.
86. God's love plan has always been to put God's kingdom government on the shoulders of Jesus Christ, for He bore the burden to bring it into the world. As such, His name is exalted as Ruler of rulers, having authority above every other name in heaven, on earth and under the earth. He is the one that showed what it is to have the Holy Spirit living in Him, giving Him counsel to carry out the plan and purposes of God on earth, and He sent that Spirit to His obedient followers. He showed what it is to be directly connected to God and His power, and He gave this intimate union to His obedient followers by way of the same indwelling Spirit. His kingdom government brings the peace and wholeness of God to those it touches, especially its kingdom citizens. His kingdom government, rule, and dominion will continue to come into the world through His church of Spirit-filled followers until His kingdom is fully established at His second coming. He has given dominion to His ambassadors to bring His rule and His peace into the world until then. The kingdom God built through Abraham and through David is a kingdom of the faith-filled and the faithful to God, for God credits righteousness through faith, and His eternal kingdom is for those made righteous like God by the finished work of Jesus Christ.
87. The Creator's people are like clay in a potter's hand. He seeks repentance and obedience, for which His people will be blessed. By way of His law, cursing comes from disobedience. Further, people are inclined to form their own purpose and plans apart from God and follow them. Yet, He formed a kingdom people that can create, and He seeks His own people of godly character that create good works as a course of life. God will establish a faithful kingdom people for Himself.
88. God is creative. He stands up a kingdom now which shall never be destroyed, that will break in pieces and consume all the other kingdoms, that shall stand forever. He is taking His time to prepare an adorned place for His people where He will dwell with them forever.
89. Jesus Christ, the Son of Man has been given everlasting dominion and glory and an eternal kingdom, that all peoples, nations and languages should serve him. The saints of the most High shall receive the kingdom and dominion on earth and possess it forever, which has already begun through the finished work of Jesus Christ. Satan and his realm of beasts had their authority taken away through Christ's victory, yet in their great wrath, they continue to seek all ways to have government and rule in all on earth who are made in God's image, causing them to do Satan's will (or the will of the old nature). Their territory, influence, and dominion will continue to be consumed and destroyed by the

force of the saints of Jesus Christ until he and his are no more. Until Satan's influence and ability are gone, his realm of beasts will continue to bring persecution to the saints on earth. God's kingdom will suffer violence, but the saints who are forceful in use of the authority and ability God gave to them will continue to take territory and influence by their force. At the end, the dominion and the greatness of the kingdoms of the new heaven and the new earth shall be given as reward to the conquering saints.

79. Under the old covenant, if God's people obey His voice and keep His covenant, then they shall be a peculiar treasure, a kingdom of priests, a holy nation. Under the new covenant, all are invited to follow Jesus Christ to be God's people. Obedience to God's word is still expected.

"You yourselves have seen what I did to the Egyptians, and how I bore you on eagles' wings and brought you to myself. Now therefore, if you will indeed obey my voice and keep my covenant, you shall be my treasured possession among all peoples, for all the earth is mine; and you shall be to me a kingdom of priests and a holy nation.' These are the words that you shall speak to the people of Israel." So Moses came and called the elders of the people and set before them all these words that the Lord had commanded him. All the people answered together and said, "All that the Lord has spoken we will do." And Moses reported the words of the people to the Lord."

Exodus 19:4-8 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/exo.19.4-8.ESV>

"ye have seen what I did unto the Egyptians, and how I bare you on eagles' wings, and brought you unto myself. Now therefore, if ye will obey my voice indeed, and keep my covenant, then ye shall be a peculiar treasure (segûllâh, H5459) unto me above all people: for all the earth is mine: and ye shall be unto me a kingdom (mamlâkâh, H4467) of priests (kôhên, H3548), and an holy (qâdôsh, H6918) nation. These are the words which thou shalt speak unto the children of Israel. And Moses came and called for the elders of the people, and laid before their faces all these words which the LORD commanded him. And all the people answered together, and said, All that the LORD hath spoken we will do ('âsâh, H6213). And Moses returned the words of the people unto the LORD."

Exodus 19:4-8 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/exo.19.4-8.KJV>

80. God took Saul's kingdom from him because of disobedience to Him in order to please people. He seeks those after His own heart, mind and will.

"And Samuel said to Saul, "You have done foolishly. You have not kept the command of the Lord your God, with which he commanded you. For then the Lord would have established your kingdom over Israel forever. But now your kingdom shall not continue. The Lord has sought out a man after his own heart, and the Lord has commanded him to be prince over his people, because you have not kept what the Lord commanded you."

1 Samuel 13:13-14 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/1sa.13.13-14.ESV>

"Saul said to Samuel, "I have sinned, for I have transgressed the commandment of the Lord and your words, because I feared the people and obeyed their voice. Now therefore, please pardon my sin and return with me that I may bow before the Lord." And Samuel said to Saul, "I will not return with you. For you have rejected the word of the Lord, and the Lord has rejected you from being king over Israel." As Samuel turned to go away, Saul seized the skirt of his robe, and it tore. And Samuel said to him, "The Lord has torn the kingdom of Israel from you this day and has given it to a neighbor of yours, who is better than you. And also the Glory of Israel will not lie or have regret, for he is not a man, that he should have regret."

1 Samuel 15:24-29 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/1sa.15.24-29.ESV>

"And Samuel said to Saul, Thou hast done foolishly: thou hast not kept the commandment of the LORD thy God, which he commanded thee: for now would the LORD have established (kûn, H3559) thy kingdom (mamlâkâh, H4467) upon Israel for ever. But now thy kingdom (mamlâkâh, Hh67) shall not continue (qûm, H6965): the LORD hath sought him a man after his own heart (lêbâb, H3824), and the LORD hath commanded him to be captain over his people, because thou hast not kept that which the LORD commanded thee."

1 Samuel 13:13-14 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/1sa.13.13-14.KJV>

"And Saul said unto Samuel, I have sinned: for I have transgressed the commandment of the LORD, and thy words: because I feared (yârê', H3372) the people, and obeyed their voice. Now therefore, I pray thee, pardon my sin, and turn again with me, that I may worship the LORD. And Samuel said unto Saul, I will not return with thee: for thou hast rejected (mâ'as, H3988) the word (dâbâr, H1697) of the LORD, and the LORD hath rejected thee from being king over Israel. And as Samuel turned about to go away, he laid hold upon the skirt of his mantle, and it rent. And Samuel said unto him, The LORD hath rent the kingdom (mamlâkûth, H4468) of Israel from thee this day, and hath given it to a neighbour of thine, that is better (tôb, H2896) than thou. And also the Strength of Israel will not lie nor repent: for he is not a man, that he should repent."

1 Samuel 15:24-29 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/1sa.15.24-29.KJV>

81. It is David's descendent, Jesus Christ, that has a house, a kingdom, and a throne, being a son to God — the Son of God. The house is the body of Christ, the church, made of Israelites and Gentiles, made of all the nations of the earth. And so it is a blessing to all nations, as promised to Abraham. The kingdom is the one that Jesus preached as being near, the one that has come with His resurrection and glorification. The kingdom has come with Jesus' demonstration of the power and authority of God to bring freedom, healing and salvation through the Holy Spirit, now given to the body of Christ, the church. This kingdom that Jesus brought allowed the church to possess the gate of God's enemies. The throne is the one Jesus received with authority over all of heaven and earth until the time that all evil is put under His feet. It is Christ's throne and, therefore, it belongs also to the body of Christ, the church, to accomplish the will of God and bring Him glory. It is the throne of grace, and *in Christ* we are

seated with Him. (This passage was also described in [God's Love Plan in Jesus and the Church: 40 Days in the Old Testament](#).)

"Now, therefore, thus you shall say to my servant David, 'Thus says the Lord of hosts, I took you from the pasture, from following the sheep, that you should be prince over my people Israel. And I have been with you wherever you went and have cut off all your enemies from before you. And I will make for you a great name, like the name of the great ones of the earth. And I will appoint a place for my people Israel and will plant them, so that they may dwell in their own place and be disturbed no more. And violent men shall afflict them no more, as formerly, from the time that I appointed judges over my people Israel. And I will give you rest from all your enemies. Moreover, the Lord declares to you that the Lord will make you a house. When your days are fulfilled and you lie down with your fathers, I will raise up your offspring after you, who shall come from your body, and I will establish his kingdom. He shall build a house for my name, and I will establish the throne of his kingdom forever. I will be to him a father, and he shall be to me a son. When he commits iniquity, I will discipline him with the rod of men, with the stripes of the sons of men, but my steadfast love will not depart from him, as I took it from Saul, whom I put away from before you. And your house and your kingdom shall be made sure forever before me. Your throne shall be established forever.'"

2 Samuel 7:8-16 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/2sa.7.8-16.ESV>

"Now therefore so shalt thou say unto my servant ('ebed, H5650) David (dâvid, H1732), Thus saith the LORD of hosts, I took thee from the sheepcote, from following the sheep, to be ruler (nâgîyd, H5057) over my people, over Israel: and I was with thee whithersoever thou wentest, and have cut off all thine enemies out of thy sight, and have made thee a great name (shêm, H8034), like unto the name of the great men that are in the earth. Moreover I will appoint a place for my people Israel, and will plant them, that they may dwell in a place of their own, and move no more; neither shall the children of wickedness afflict them any more, as beforetime, and as since the time that I commanded judges to be over my people Israel, and have caused thee to rest from all thine enemies. Also the LORD telleth thee that he will make thee an house. And when thy days be fulfilled, and thou shalt sleep with thy fathers, I will set up thy seed after thee, which shall proceed out of thy bowels, and I will establish (kûn, H3559) his kingdom (mamlâkâh, H4467). He shall build an house for my name (shêm, H3034), and I will stablish (kûn, H3559) the throne (kissê', H3678) of his kingdom (mamlâkâh, H4467) for ever. I will be his father, and he shall be my son. If he commit iniquity, I will chasten him with the rod (shêbet, H7626) of men, and with the stripes (nega', H5061) of the children of men: but my mercy (chêsêd, H2617) shall not depart away (sûr, H5493) from him, as I took (sûr, H5493) it from Saul, whom I put away (sûr, H5493) before thee. And thine house (bayith, H1004) and thy kingdom (mamlâkâh, H4467) shall be established (kûn, H3559) for ever before thee: thy throne (kissê', H3678) shall be established (kûn, H3559) for ever."

2 Samuel 7:8-16 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/2sa.7.8-16.KJV>

82. God desires for His kingdom citizens to walk before Him with integrity, completeness, simplicity, and righteousness of heart, as David did. God desires for our will aligned with His, as David's was. He desires for us to do all that He has commissioned us to do. He desires for our purpose to be focused on His.

"As soon as Solomon had finished building the house of the Lord and the king's house and all that Solomon desired to build, the Lord appeared to Solomon a second time, as he had appeared to him at Gibeon. And the Lord said to him, "I have heard your prayer and your plea, which you have made before me. I have consecrated this house that you have built, by putting my name there forever. My eyes and my heart will be there for all time. And as for you, if you will walk before me, as David your father walked, with integrity of heart and uprightness, doing according to all that I have commanded you, and keeping my statutes and my rules, then I will establish your royal throne over Israel forever, as I promised David your father, saying, 'You shall not lack a man on the throne of Israel.'"

1 Kings 9:1-5 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/1ki.9.1-5.ESV>

"And it came to pass, when Solomon had finished the building of the house of the LORD, and the king's house, and all Solomon's desire which he was pleased to do, that the LORD appeared to Solomon the second time, as he had appeared unto him at Gibeon. And the LORD said unto him, I have heard thy prayer and thy supplication (techinnâh, H8467), that thou hast made (chânan, H2603) before me: I have hallowed (qâdash, H6942) this house (bayith, H1004), which thou hast built (bânâh, H1129), to put my name (shêm, H8034) there for ever; and mine eyes ('ayin, H5869) and mine heart (lêb, H3820) shall be there perpetually. And if thou wilt walk (yâlak, H3212) before me, as David thy father walked (hâlak, H1980), in integrity (tôm, H8537) of heart (lêbâb, H3824), and in uprightness (yôsher, H3476), to do ('âsâh, H6213) according to all that I have commanded (tsâvâh, H6680) thee, and wilt keep (shâmar, H8104) my statutes and my judgments (mishpât, H4941): then I will establish (qûm, H6965) the throne (kissê', H3678) of thy kingdom (mamlâkâh, H4467) upon Israel (yiśrâ'êl, H3478) for ever, as I promised (dâbar, H1696) to David thy father, saying, There shall not fail thee a man upon the throne (kissê', H3678) of Israel."

1 Kings 9:1-5 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/1ki.9.1-5.KJV>

83. The kingdom is given to those who, like David, keep God's commandments, follow God with all of their soul (mind, will, emotion), and do only that which is right in God's eyes. Kingdom citizens follow behind God in the way they live their lives rather than casting God behind them.

"Go, tell Jeroboam, 'Thus says the Lord, the God of Israel: "Because I exalted you from among the people and made you leader over my people Israel and tore the kingdom away from the house of David and gave it to you, and yet you have not been like my servant David, who kept my commandments and followed me with all his heart, doing only that which was right in my eyes, but you have done evil above all who were before you and have gone and made for yourself other gods and metal images, provoking me to anger, and have cast me behind your back,"

1 Kings 14:7-9 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/1ki.14.7-9.ESV>

"Go, tell Jeroboam, Thus saith the LORD God of Israel, Forasmuch as I exalted thee from among the people, and made thee prince over my people Israel, and rent the kingdom (mamlâkâh H4467) away from the house of David, and gave it thee: and yet thou hast not been as my servant ('ebed, H5650) David, who kept (shâmar, H8104) my commandments (mitsvâh, H4687), and who followed (hâlak 'achar, H1980+H310) me with all his heart (lêbâb, H3824), to do that only which was right (yâshâr, H3477) in mine eyes; but hast done evil above all that were before thee: for thou hast gone and made thee other gods, and molten images, to provoke me to anger, and hast cast (shâlak, H7993) me behind ('achar, H310) thy back:"

1 Kings 14:7-9 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/1ki.14.7-9.KJV>

84. David showed the right attitude of a kingdom citizen as he glorified God as the righteous King before Solomon was anointed king. God expects His kingdom citizens to submit to His government, rule, and will.

"Therefore David blessed the Lord in the presence of all the assembly. And David said: "Blessed are you, O Lord, the God of Israel our father, forever and ever. Yours, O Lord, is the greatness and the power and the glory and the victory and the majesty, for all that is in the heavens and in the earth is yours. Yours is the kingdom, O Lord, and you are exalted as head above all. Both riches and honor come from you, and you rule over all. In your hand are power and might, and in your hand it is to make great and to give strength to all. And now we thank you, our God, and praise your glorious name. "But who am I, and what is my people, that we should be able thus to offer willingly? For all things come from you, and of your own have we given you. For we are strangers before you and sojourners, as all our fathers were. Our days on the earth are like a shadow, and there is no abiding. O Lord our God, all this abundance that we have provided for building you a house for your holy name comes from your hand and is all your own. I know, my God, that you test the heart and have pleasure in uprightness. In the uprightness of my heart I have freely offered all these things, and now I have seen your people, who are present here, offering freely and joyously to you. O Lord, the God of Abraham, Isaac, and Israel, our fathers, keep forever such purposes and thoughts in the hearts of your people, and direct their hearts toward you. Grant to Solomon my son a whole heart that he may keep your commandments, your testimonies, and your statutes, performing all, and that he may build the palace for which I have made provision." Then David said to all the assembly, "Bless the Lord your God." And all the assembly blessed the Lord, the God of their fathers, and bowed their heads and paid homage to the Lord and to the king."

1 Chronicles 29:10-20 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/1ch.29.10-20.ESV>

"Wherefore David blessed (bârak, H1288) the LORD before all the congregation: and David said, Blessed (bârak, H1288) be thou, LORD God of Israel our father, for ever and ever. Thine, O LORD, is the greatness, and the power (gebûrâh, H1369), and the glory (tiph'ârâh, H8597), and the victory (netsach, H5331), and the majesty (hôd, H1935): for all that is in the heaven and in the earth is thine; thine is the kingdom (mamlâkâh, H4467), O LORD, and thou art exalted as head (rô'sh, H7218) above all. Both riches and honour (kâbôd, H3519) come of thee, and thou reignest (mâshal, H4910) over all; and in thine hand (yâd, H3027) is power (kôach, H3581) and might (gebûrâh, H1369); and in thine hand it is to make great (gâdal, H1431), and to give strength (châzaq, H2388) unto all. Now therefore, our God, we thank thee, and praise (hâlal, H1984) thy glorious (tiph'ârâh, H8597) name (shêm, H8034). But who am I, and what is my people, that we should be able to offer so willingly after this sort? for all things come of thee, and of thine own have we given thee. For we are strangers before thee, and sojourners, as were all our fathers: our days on the earth are as a shadow, and there is none abiding. O LORD our God, all this store that we have prepared to build thee an house for thine holy (qôdesh, H6944) name (shêm, H8034) cometh of thine hand, and is all thine own. I know also, my God, that thou triest (bâchan, H974) the heart (lêbâb, H3824), and hast pleasure in uprightness (yôsher, H3476). As for me, in the uprightness (mêyshâr, H4339) of mine heart (lêbâb, H3824) I have willingly offered all these things: and now have I seen with joy thy people, which are present here, to offer willingly unto thee. O LORD God of Abraham, Isaac, and of Israel, our fathers, keep this for ever in the imagination (yêtser, H3336) of the thoughts (machashâbâh, H4284) of the heart (lêbâb, H3824) of thy people, and prepare (kûn, H3559) their heart (lêbâb, H3824)

unto thee: and give unto Solomon my son a perfect (shâlêm, H8003) heart (lêbâb, H3824), to keep thy commandments (mitsvâh, H4687), thy testimonies, and thy statutes (chôq, H2706), and to do all these things, and to build the palace, for the which I have made provision. And David said to all the congregation, Now bless (bârak, H1288) the LORD your God. And all the congregation blessed (bârak, H1288) the LORD God of their fathers, and bowed down their heads, and worshipped the LORD, and the king (melek, H4428).“

1 Chronicles 29:10-20 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/1ch.29.10-20.KJV>

85. David showed the character and thoughts of one who was aligned with God's thinking and will. The benefits of being kingdom citizens include freedom from sin, death, and its effects, sickness included. They include life and strength from the Spirit of God. Kingdom citizens are the handiwork of God, clay in the hands of the potter. Angels the handiwork of God, messengers with power to carry out God's word. We are made for the glory of God; His nature and character are beautiful and praiseworthy.

”Bless the Lord, O my soul, and all that is within me, bless his holy name! Bless the Lord, O my soul, and forget not all his benefits, who forgives all your iniquity, who heals all your diseases, who redeems your life from the pit, who crowns you with steadfast love and mercy, who satisfies you with good so that your youth is renewed like the eagle's. The Lord works righteousness and justice for all who are oppressed. He made known his ways to Moses, his acts to the people of Israel. The Lord is merciful and gracious, slow to anger and abounding in steadfast love. He will not always chide, nor will he keep his anger forever. He does not deal with us according to our sins, nor repay us according to our iniquities. For as high as the heavens are above the earth, so great is his steadfast love toward those who fear him; as far as the east is from the west, so far does he remove our transgressions from us. As a father shows compassion to his children, so the Lord shows compassion to those who fear him. For he knows our frame; he remembers that we are dust. As for man, his days are like grass; he flourishes like a flower of the field; for the wind passes over it, and it is gone, and its place knows it no more. But the steadfast love of the Lord is from everlasting to everlasting on those who fear him, and his righteousness to children's children, to those who keep his covenant and remember to do his commandments. The Lord has established his throne in the heavens, and his kingdom rules over all. Bless the Lord, O you his angels, you mighty ones who do his word, obeying the voice of his word! Bless the Lord, all his hosts, his ministers, who do his will! Bless the Lord, all his works, in all places of his dominion. Bless the Lord, O my soul!“

Psalms 103:1-22 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/psa.103.1-22.ESV>

”Bless (bârak, H1288) the LORD, O my soul: And all that is within me, bless his holy (qôdesh, H6944) name (shêm, H8034). Bless (bârak, H1288) the LORD, O my soul, And forget not all his benefits: Who forgiveth all thine iniquities; Who healeth (râphâ', H7495) all thy diseases (tachâlû', H8463); Who redeemeth (gâ'al, H1350) thy life (chay, H2416) from destruction (shachath, H7845); Who crowneth ('âtar, H5849) thee with lovingkindness (chêsêd, H2617) and tender mercies (racham, H7356); Who satisfieth (sâba', H7646) thy mouth with good things (tôb, H2896); So that thy youth (nâ'ûr, H5271) is renewed (châdash, H2318) like the eagle's. The LORD executeth ('âsâh, H6213) righteousness (tsedâqâh, H6666) and judgment (mishpât, H4941) For all that are oppressed ('âshaq, H6231). He made known his ways (derech, H1870) unto Moses, His acts unto the children of Israel. The LORD is merciful (rachûm, H7349) and gracious (channûn, H2587), Slow ('ârêk, H750) to anger, and plenteous (rab, H7227) in mercy (chêsêd, H2617). He will not always chide (rîyb, H7378): Neither will he keep his anger for ever. He hath not dealt with us after our sins; Nor rewarded us according to our iniquities. For as the

heaven is high above the earth, So great (gâbar, H1396) is his mercy (chêsêd, H2617) toward them that fear (yârê', H3373) him. As far as the east is from the west, So far hath he removed (râchaq, H7368) our transgressions from us. Like as a father pitieth (râcham, H7355) his children, So the LORD pitieth (râcham, H7355) them that fear (yârê', H3373) him. For he knoweth our frame (yêtser, H3336); He remembereth that we are dust ('âphâr, H6083). As for man, his days are as grass: As a flower of the field, so he flourisheth (tsûts, H6692). For the wind (rûach, H7307) passeth over it, and it is gone; And the place thereof shall know it no more. But the mercy (chêsêd, H2617) of the LORD (yehôvâh, H3068) is from everlasting to everlasting upon them that fear (yârê', H3373) him, And his righteousness (tsedâqâh, H6666) unto children's children; To such as keep (shâmar, H8104) his covenant (berîyth, H1285), And to those that remember his commandments (piqqûd, H6490) to do ('âsâh, H6213) them. The LORD hath prepared (kûn, H3559) his throne (kissê', H3678) in the heavens; And his kingdom (malkûth, H4438) ruleth (mâshal, H4910) over all. Bless (bârak, H1288) the LORD, ye his angels, that excel (gibbôr, H1368) in strength (kôach, H3581), That do ('âsâh, H6213) his commandments (dâbâr, H1697), hearkening unto the voice of his word (dâbâr, H1697). Bless (bârak, H1288) ye the LORD, all ye his hosts (tsâbâ', H6635); Ye ministers (shârath, H8334) of his, that do ('âsâh, H6213) his pleasure (râtsôn, H7522). Bless (bârak, H1288) the LORD, all his works (ma'âseh, H4639) in all places of his dominion (memshâlâh, H4475): Bless (bârak, H1288) the LORD, O my soul (nephesh, H5315)."

Psalm 103:1-22 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/psa.103.1-22.KJV>

86. God's love plan has always been to put God's kingdom government on the shoulders of Jesus Christ, for He bore the burden to bring it into the world. As such, His name is exalted as Ruler of rulers, having authority above every other name in heaven, on earth and under the earth. He is the one that showed what it is to have the Holy Spirit living in Him, giving Him counsel to carry out the plan and purposes of God on earth, and He sent that Spirit to His obedient followers. He showed what it is to be directly connected to God and His power, and He gave this intimate union to His obedient followers by way of the same indwelling Spirit. His kingdom government brings the peace and wholeness of God to those it touches, especially its kingdom citizens. His kingdom government, rule, and dominion will continue to come into the world through His church of Spirit-filled followers until His kingdom is fully established at His second coming. He has given dominion to His ambassadors to bring His rule and His peace into the world until then. The kingdom God built through Abraham and through David is a kingdom of the faith-filled and the faithful to God, for God credits righteousness through faith, and His eternal kingdom is for those made righteous like God by the finished work of Jesus Christ.

"For to us a child is born, to us a son is given; and the government shall be upon his shoulder, and his name shall be called Wonderful Counselor, Mighty God, Everlasting Father, Prince of Peace. Of the increase of his government and of peace there will be no end, on the throne of David and over his kingdom, to establish it and to uphold it with justice and with righteousness from this time forth and forevermore. The zeal of the Lord of hosts will do this."

Isaiah 9:6-7 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/isa.9.6-7.ESV>

"For unto us a child is born, unto us a son is given: and the government (miśrah, H4951) shall be upon his shoulder (shekem, H7926): and his name (shêm, H8034) shall be called Wonderful (pele', H8382), Counsellor (yâ'ats, H3289), The mighty (gibbôr, H1368) God ('êl, H410), The everlasting Father, The Prince (śar, H8269) of Peace (shâlôm, H7965). Of the increase (marbeh, H4766) of his government (miśrah, H4951) and peace (shâlôm, H7965) there shall be no end, upon the throne (kissê', H3678) of David, and upon his kingdom (mamlâkâh, H4467), to

order (kûn, H3559) it, and to establish (sâ'ad, H5582) it with judgment (mishpât, H4941) and with justice (tsedâqâh, H6666) from henceforth even for ever. The zeal (qin'âh, H7068) of the LORD of hosts (tsâbâ', H6635) will perform ('âśâh, H6213) this."

Isaiah 9:6-7 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/isa.9.6-7.KJV>

87. The Creator's people are like clay in a potter's hand. He seeks repentance and obedience, for which His people will be blessed. By way of His law, cursing comes from disobedience. Further, people are inclined to form their own purpose and plans apart from God and follow them. Yet, He formed a kingdom people that can create, and He seeks His own people of godly character that create good works as a course of life. God will establish a faithful kingdom people for Himself.

"The word that came to Jeremiah from the Lord: "Arise, and go down to the potter's house, and there I will let you hear my words." So I went down to the potter's house, and there he was working at his wheel. And the vessel he was making of clay was spoiled in the potter's hand, and he reworked it into another vessel, as it seemed good to the potter to do. Then the word of the Lord came to me: "O house of Israel, can I not do with you as this potter has done? declares the Lord. Behold, like the clay in the potter's hand, so are you in my hand, O house of Israel. If at any time I declare concerning a nation or a kingdom, that I will pluck up and break down and destroy it, and if that nation, concerning which I have spoken, turns from its evil, I will relent of the disaster that I intended to do to it. And if at any time I declare concerning a nation or a kingdom that I will build and plant it, and if it does evil in my sight, not listening to my voice, then I will relent of the good that I had intended to do to it. Now, therefore, say to the men of Judah and the inhabitants of Jerusalem: 'Thus says the Lord, Behold, I am shaping disaster against you and devising a plan against you. Return, every one from his evil way, and amend your ways and your deeds.' "But they say, 'That is in vain! We will follow our own plans, and will every one act according to the stubbornness of his evil heart.'"

Jeremiah 18:1-12 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/jer.18.1-12.ESV>

"The word which came to Jeremiah (yirmeyâh, H3414) from the LORD, saying, Arise, and go down to the potter's (yâtsar, H3335) house, and there I will cause thee to hear my words. Then I went down to the potter's (yâtsar, H3335) house, and, behold, he wrought ('âśâh, H6213) a work (melâ'kâh, H4399) on the wheels ('ôben, H70). And the vessel (kelîy, H3627) that he made ('âśâh, H6213) of clay was marred in the hand of the potter: so he made ('âśâh, H6213) it again another vessel (kelîy, H3627), as seemed good (yâshar, H3474) to the potter (yâtsar, H3335) to make ('âśâh, H6213) it. Then the word of the LORD came to me, saying, O house (bayith, H1004) of Israel, cannot (yâkôl, H3201) I do with you as this potter (yâtsar, H3335)? saith the LORD. Behold, as the clay (chômer, H2536) is in the potter's (yâtsar, H3335) hand (yâd, H3027), so are ye in mine hand, O house of Israel. At what instant I shall speak (dâbar, H1696) concerning a nation (gôy, H1471), and concerning a kingdom (mamlâkâh, H4467), to pluck up (nâthash, H5428), and to pull down (nâthats, H5422), and to destroy it ('âbad, H6); if that nation, against whom I have pronounced (dâbar, H1696), turn (shûb, H7725) from their evil (ra', H7451), I will repent (nâcham, H5162) of the evil (ra', H7451) that I thought (châshab, H2803) to do ('âśâh, H6213) unto them. And at what instant I shall speak concerning a nation, and concerning a kingdom (mamlâkâh, H4467), to build (bânâh, H1129) and to plant (nâta', H5193) it; if it do ('âśâh, H6213) evil (ra', H7451) in my sight, that it obey (shâma', H8085) not my voice, then I will repent (nâcham, H5162) of the good (tôb, H2896), wherewith I said I would benefit (yâtab, H3190) them. Now therefore go to, speak to the men of Judah, and to the inhabitants of Jerusalem, saying, Thus saith the LORD; Behold, I frame (yâtsar, H3335) evil (ra', H7451)

against you, and devise (châshab, H2803) a device (machăshâbâh, H4284) against you: return (shûb, H7725) ye now every one from his evil way (derek, H1870), and make your ways (derek, H1870) and your doings (ma'ălâl, H4611) good (yâtab, H3190). And they said, There is no hope: but we will walk (yâlak, H3212) after our own devices (machăshâbâh, H4284), and we will every one do ('âśâh, H6213) the imagination (sherîyrûth, H8307) of his evil (ra', H7451) heart (lêb, H3820).“

Jeremiah 18:1-12 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/jer.18.1-12.KJV>

88. God is creative. He stands up a kingdom now which shall never be destroyed, that will break in pieces and consume all the other kingdoms, that shall stand forever. He is taking His time to prepare an adorned place for His people where He will dwell with them forever.

”And in the days of those kings the God of heaven will set up a kingdom that shall never be destroyed, nor shall the kingdom be left to another people. It shall break in pieces all these kingdoms and bring them to an end, and it shall stand forever,“

Daniel 2:44 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/dan.2.44.ESV>

”And in the days of these kings shall the God of heaven set up (qûm, H6966) a kingdom (malkû, H4437), which shall never be destroyed: and the kingdom (malkû, H4437) shall not be left to other people, but it shall break in pieces and consume (sûph, H5487) all these kingdoms (malkû, H4437), and it shall stand (qûm, H6966) for ever.“

Daniel 2:44 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/dan.2.44.KJV>

89. Jesus Christ, the Son of Man has been given everlasting dominion and glory and an eternal kingdom, that all peoples, nations and languages should serve him. The saints of the most High shall receive the kingdom and dominion on earth and possess it forever, which has already begun through the finished work of Jesus Christ. Satan and his realm of beasts had their authority taken away through Christ's victory, yet in their great wrath, they continue to seek all ways to have government and rule in all on earth who are made in God's image, causing them to do Satan's will (or the will of the old nature). Their territory, influence, and dominion will continue to be consumed and destroyed by the force of the saints of Jesus Christ until he and his are no more. Until Satan's influence and ability are gone, his realm of beasts will continue to bring persecution to the saints on earth. God's kingdom will suffer violence, but the saints who are forceful in use of the authority and ability God gave to them will continue to take territory and influence by their force. At the end, the dominion and the greatness of the kingdoms of the new heaven and the new earth shall be given as reward to the conquering saints.

”“As I looked, thrones were placed, and the Ancient of Days took his seat; his clothing was white as snow, and the hair of his head like pure wool; his throne was fiery flames; its wheels were burning fire. A stream of fire issued and came out from before him; a thousand thousands served him, and ten thousand times ten thousand stood before him; the court sat in judgment, and the books were opened. “I looked then because of the sound of the great words that the horn was speaking. And as I looked, the beast was killed, and its body destroyed and given over to be burned with fire. As for the rest of the beasts, their dominion was taken away, but their lives were prolonged for a season and a time. “I saw in the night visions, and behold, with the clouds of heaven there came one like a son of man, and he came to the Ancient of Days and was presented before him. And to him was given dominion and glory and a kingdom, that all peoples, nations, and languages should serve him; his dominion is an everlasting dominion,

which shall not pass away, and his kingdom one that shall not be destroyed. "As for me, Daniel, my spirit within me was anxious, and the visions of my head alarmed me. I approached one of those who stood there and asked him the truth concerning all this. So he told me and made known to me the interpretation of the things. 'These four great beasts are four kings who shall arise out of the earth. But the saints of the Most High shall receive the kingdom and possess the kingdom forever, forever and ever.' "Then I desired to know the truth about the fourth beast, which was different from all the rest, exceedingly terrifying, with its teeth of iron and claws of bronze, and which devoured and broke in pieces and stamped what was left with its feet, and about the ten horns that were on its head, and the other horn that came up and before which three of them fell, the horn that had eyes and a mouth that spoke great things, and that seemed greater than its companions. As I looked, this horn made war with the saints and prevailed over them, until the Ancient of Days came, and judgment was given for the saints of the Most High, and the time came when the saints possessed the kingdom. "Thus he said: 'As for the fourth beast, there shall be a fourth kingdom on earth, which shall be different from all the kingdoms, and it shall devour the whole earth, and trample it down, and break it to pieces. As for the ten horns, out of this kingdom ten kings shall arise, and another shall arise after them; he shall be different from the former ones, and shall put down three kings. He shall speak words against the Most High, and shall wear out the saints of the Most High, and shall think to change the times and the law; and they shall be given into his hand for a time, times, and half a time. But the court shall sit in judgment, and his dominion shall be taken away, to be consumed and destroyed to the end. And the kingdom and the dominion and the greatness of the kingdoms under the whole heaven shall be given to the people of the saints of the Most High; his kingdom shall be an everlasting kingdom, and all dominions shall serve and obey him.'"

Daniel 7:9-27 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/dan.7.9-27.ESV>

"I beheld till the thrones (korsê', H3764) were cast down, and the Ancient of days did sit, whose garment was white as snow, and the hair of his head like the pure wool: his throne (korsê', H3764) was like the fiery flame, and his wheels as burning fire. A fiery stream (nehar, H5103) issued and came forth from before him: thousand thousands ministered (shemash, H8120) unto him, and ten thousand times ten thousand stood before him: the judgment was set, and the books were opened. I beheld then because of the voice of the great words which the horn spake: I beheld even till the beast (chêyvâ', H2423) was slain, and his body destroyed, and given to the burning flame. As concerning the rest of the beasts (chêyvâ', H2423), they had their dominion (sholtân, H7985) taken away ('ădâ', H5709): yet their lives (chay, H2417) were prolonged for a season and time. I saw in the night visions, and, behold, one like the Son of man came with the clouds of heaven, and came to the Ancient of days, and they brought him near before him. And there was given him dominion (sholtân, H7985), and glory (yeqâr, H3367), and a kingdom (malkû, H4437), that all people, nations ('ûmmâh, H524), and languages, should serve (pelach, H6399) him: his dominion (sholtân, H7985) is an everlasting dominion (sholtân, H7985), which shall not pass away ('ădâ', H5709), and his kingdom (malkû, H4437) that which shall not be destroyed (chăbal, H2255). I Daniel was grieved in my spirit in the midst of my body, and the visions of my head troubled me. I came near unto one of them that stood by, and asked him the truth of all this. So he told me, and made me know the interpretation of the things. These great beasts, which are four, are four kings, which shall arise out of the earth. But the saints (qaddîysh, H6922) of the most High ('elyôn, H5946) shall take (qebal, H6902) the kingdom (malkû, H4437), and possess (chăsan, H2631) the kingdom (malkû, H4437) for ever, even for ever and ever. Then I would know the truth of the fourth beast (chêyvâ', H2423), which was diverse from all the others, exceeding dreadful, whose teeth were of iron, and his nails of brass; which devoured, brake in pieces, and stamped the residue with his feet; and of the ten horns that were in his head, and of the other which came up, and before whom three fell; even

of that horn that had eyes, and a mouth that spake very great things, whose look was more stout than his fellows. I beheld, and the same horn made war with the saints (qaddîysh, H6922), and prevailed against them; until the Ancient of days came, and judgment was given (yehab, H3052) to the saints (qaddîysh, H6922) of the most High; and the time came that the saints (qaddîysh, H6922) possessed (chăsan, H2631) the kingdom (malkû, H4437). Thus he said, The fourth beast shall be the fourth kingdom (malkû, H4437) upon earth, which shall be diverse from all kingdoms (malkû, H4437), and shall devour ('ăkal, H399) the whole earth, and shall tread it down, and break it in pieces. And the ten horns out of this kingdom (malkû, H4437) are ten kings that shall arise: and another shall rise after them; and he shall be diverse from the first, and he shall subdue three kings. And he shall speak great words against the most High, and shall wear out (belâ', H1080) the saints (qaddîysh, H6922) of the most High ('elyôn, H5946), and think to change times and laws: and they shall be given into his hand (yad, H3028) until a time and times and the dividing of time. But the judgment shall sit (yethib, H3488), and they shall take away ('ădâ', H5709) his dominion (sholtân, H7985), to consume (shemad, H8046) and to destroy ('ăbad, H7) it unto the end. And the kingdom (malkû, H4437) and dominion (sholtân, H7985), and the greatness (rebû, H7238) of the kingdom (malkû, H4437) under the whole heaven, shall be given to the people of the saints (qaddîysh, H6922) of the most High ('elyôn, H5946), whose kingdom (malkû, H4437) is an everlasting kingdom (malkû, H4437), and all dominions (sholtân, H7985) shall serve (pelach, H6399) and obey (shema', H8086) him."

Daniel 7:9-27 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/dan.7.9-27.KJV>